

ISSUE 09 · SEPTEMBER 2026

What's New in Microsoft 365 Copilot

94 numbered September updates — in plain English, with what they actually mean for you.

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INSIDE THIS ISSUE

- **Copilot Studio changed how you pay** — usage-based billing, whatever the licence
- **Domain exclusion came back** — announced, reversed, then restored
- **Cowork learned to build apps** — and to estimate what they are worth
- **+ 91 more numbered updates** — chat, apps, Power Platform & admin

My read on September

Every month I dig through as many of the release notes, blogs and Tech Community threads as I can — and boil it down to the version I wish someone had handed me.

I’m still that curious intern at heart — figuring this out alongside you, not lecturing from the front. If a handful of these save you an afternoon, that’s the whole job.

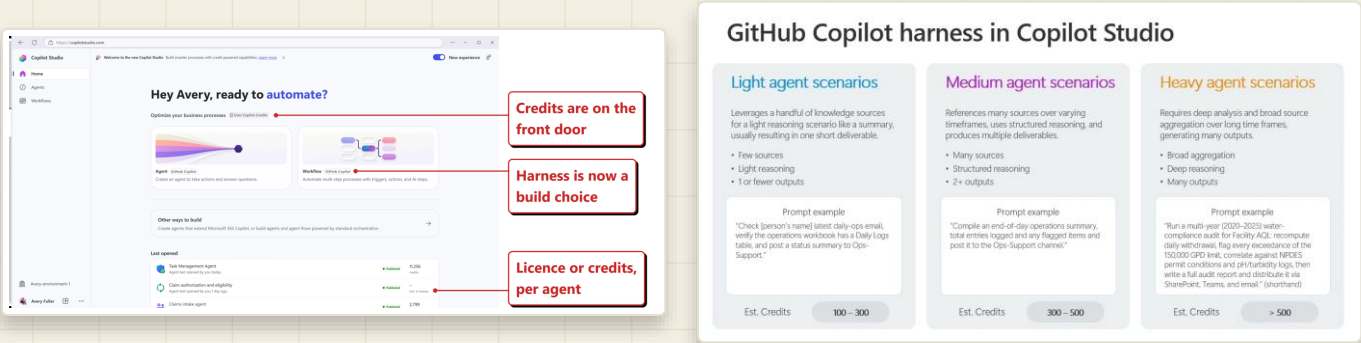
September is the month Copilot Studio stopped being only a build decision and became a **billing one**. The new harness went generally available, and agents on it are billed for all work — regardless of Microsoft 365 Copilot licensing.

the shift I noticed

Credits are spent while makers build and test, not only when an agent runs. That moves the conversation from the maker to whoever owns the budget.

— Sush

Copilot Studio and Power Platform are here because Nathan asked, and sent the sources. A first pass so far. Thank you for the notes, and the pack requests.



Copilot Studio's new home for agents. Below: what each kind of agent work costs in Copilot Credits. Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

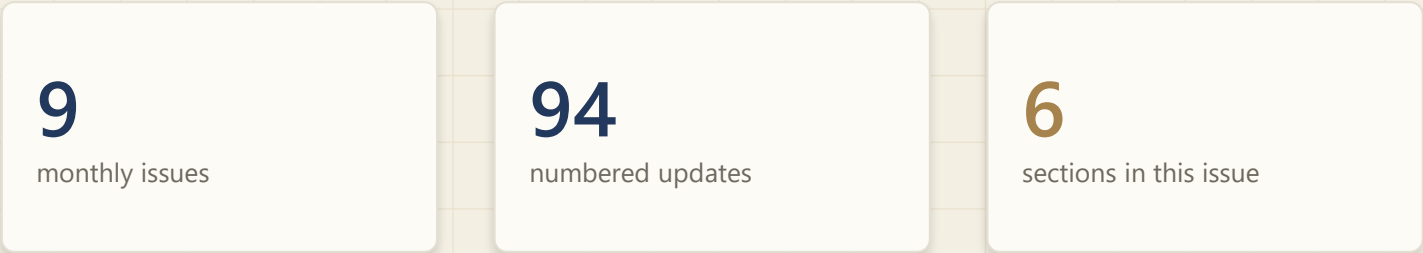
September, in numbers

A billing change in Copilot Studio, two more frontier models, and a feature that came back. Here’s the shape of **September** — and where 2026 stands so far.

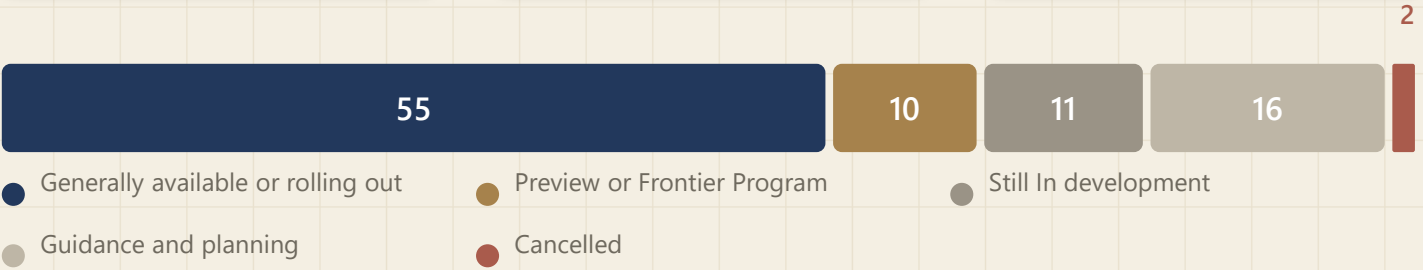
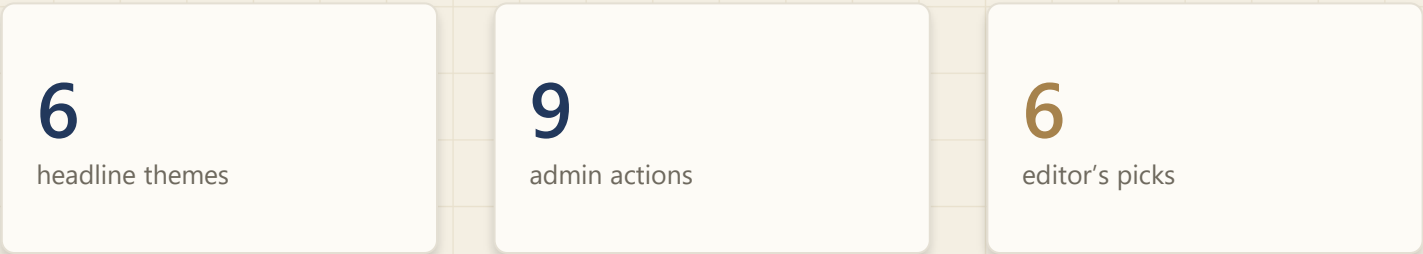
CATCH UP ON 2026

- [January recap →](#)
- [February recap →](#)
- [March recap →](#)
- [April recap →](#)
- [May recap →](#)
- [June recap →](#)
- [July recap →](#)
- [August recap →](#)

THE SERIES · SEPTEMBER



ACTION SIGNAL · SEPTEMBER



The status bar covers all 94 numbered September updates, using the blog’s own split.

What changed since last month

If you followed August's pack, here's what moved — the threads that continued, the one that came back, and the two that stopped.

Why it matters

Microsoft's cadence is steady: things land in preview, then graduate to GA a month or two later. Following along monthly means you see what's coming before it arrives — and can plan for it.

[August 2026 recap →](#)

Domain exclusion

- August's issue had it rolled back on 4 August → it was turned on again on 9 September, now with documented limits.

restored

Model choice

- August had Claude Fable 5 as an off-by-default preview → Fable 5.1 replaces it, and GPT-6 Astra and Grok join the list.

more choice

Copilot Studio

- Barely a footnote in August → 23 numbered items this issue, and a billing model that reaches beyond makers.

much bigger

Mobile notifications

- Covered in August as newly arrived → Microsoft has now marked them cancelled on the roadmap.

cancelled

Copilot Notebooks

- One experience in August → now split into two connected ones, with suggestions for what to make next.

split in two

If you only have 2 minutes

Six things explain most of **September**. Start here.

GOT 5 MORE MINUTES?

Page 3 · September, in numbers — the whole month at a glance.

Page 4 · What changed since last month — which previews are now final.

Page 6 · Admin action plan — the short list of what to do.

[Read the full September recap →](#)

1

Copilot Studio changed how you pay

Agents on the new harness are billed for all work, regardless of Microsoft 365 Copilot licensing.

2

Domain exclusion came back

Announced 28 July, rolled back 4 August, on again 9 September — now documented, with limits.

3

Two more frontier models

GPT-6 Astra and Claude Fable 5.1, scoped to Copilot Cowork and Copilot Studio.

4

Cowork learned to build apps

An App skill turns a description into a small interactive app, with no code.

5

Grok joined the list, switched off

Added as a model choice, disabled by default, and unavailable in several regions.

6

Two promises were cancelled

Proactive mobile notifications and interactive agents for Teams meetings and calls.

Admin action plan — start with these

Action	Who	When	Why it matters
Check who can spend Copilot Credits	Power Platform admin	Today	New-harness agents are billed for all work, and credits are spent while makers build and test.
Allow the whole *.cloud.microsoft domain	Network + M365 admin	Before October	The Copilot web app is being redirected; if the host stays blocked, users may lose access.
Decide about Grok before users ask	M365 admin + legal	Before enabling	Off by default, and a different contract applies depending on which route you mean.
Re-plan domain exclusion	M365 admin	Now	It is back and documented — with subdomain and web-pages-only limits worth reading first.
Look at the Cowork value reporting	Leaders + admins	This month	Hours and value are a deliberately conservative proxy, not a finance number.
Check the two dashboard data exports	Admins + analysts	When you can	Different preview labels, and identifiable export can be switched on by an administrator.

SECTION 01

Chat, Notebooks, Search & agents

01

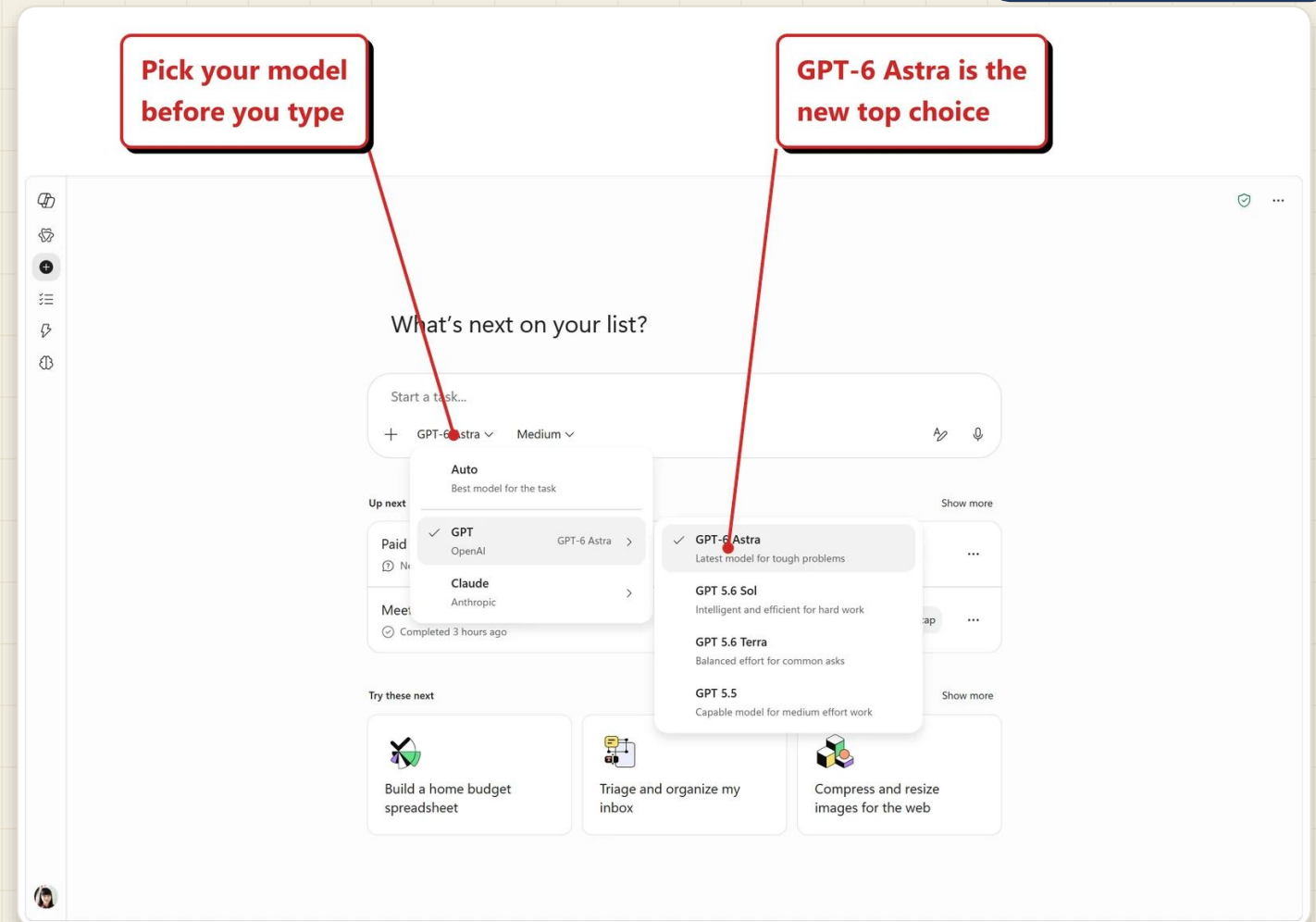
GPT-6 Astra arrives in Cowork and Studio

OpenAI's **GPT-6 Astra** joined the frontier models available in Copilot Cowork and Copilot Studio. Microsoft's framing is about delegation: rather than breaking work into small pieces and guiding each step, you hand over a larger task and spend your time reviewing the result.

Why it matters

Notice where it landed. Not Chat — Cowork and Copilot Studio, the two places where work is delegated rather than conversed with. That is a fair signal of where Microsoft thinks frontier models earn their cost.

Rolling out 4 September



Official Microsoft image from Microsoft's GPT-6 Astra announcement.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[Available today: OpenAI GPT-6 Astra in Micr... →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Claude Fable 5.1 replaced Fable 5

Claude Fable 5.1 joined the same two surfaces. Microsoft describes it as built for long-running work, financial analysis and front-end visual coding, with tighter plans at the start and more concise summaries at the end.

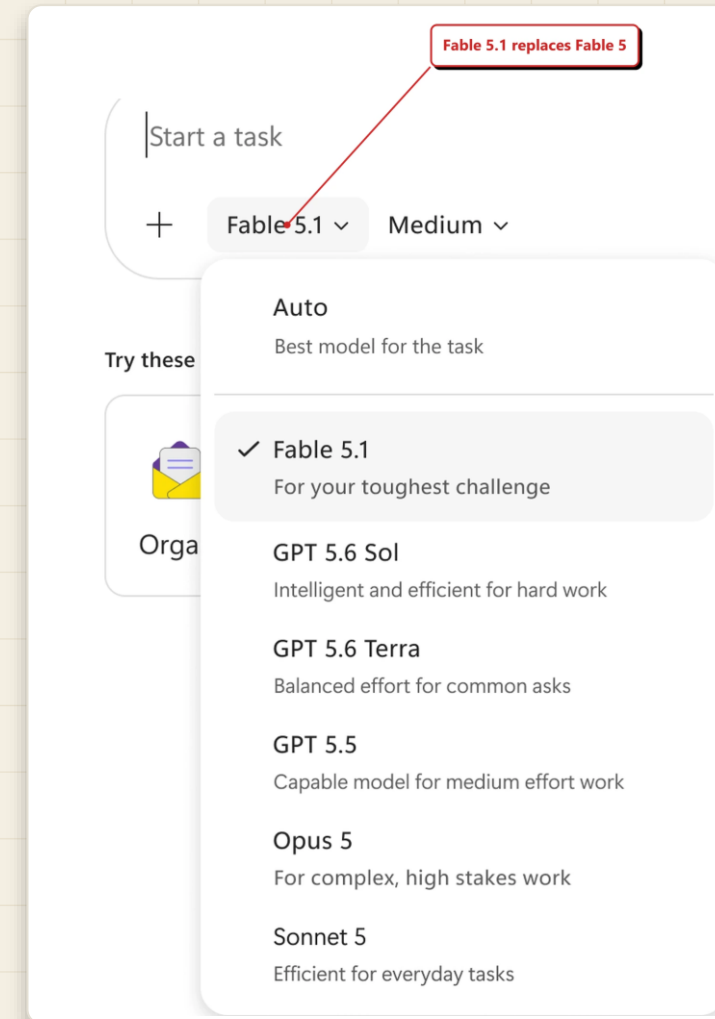
Why it matters

A model being replaced rather than added is a different kind of event. Anything you tested, documented or wrote a policy about for Fable 5 is now describing a model that is not there any more — worth a re-test rather than an assumption.

[Available today: Anthropic Claude Fable 5.1... →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Rolling out 1 September



Official Microsoft image from Microsoft's Claude Fable 5.1 announcement.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

Web and work chat merged into one

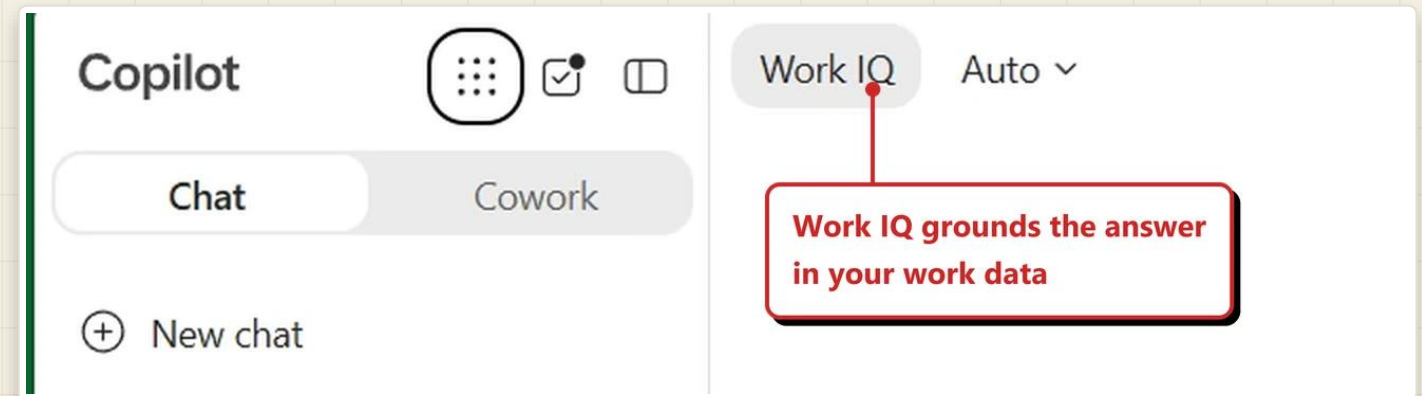
GA 25 August

Copilot Chat brought web and work into **one chat experience**, with a dedicated **Work IQ button** to bring your organisation's content into the answer rather than switching to a separate mode.

What I found on 14 September 2026. The toggle is gone.

Why it matters

The web/work toggle was the single most confusing thing about Copilot Chat for new users. People did not know which mode they were in, so they did not know why the answer was wrong. One box with an explicit control is a much easier thing to teach.



*My own tenant, 14 September 2026. One chat, a Work IQ button, and a model picker set to Auto.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.*

[Microsoft 365 Copilot release notes →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Select just part of an answer

Text selection lets you select a sentence, paragraph or table inside a Copilot response and preview the selection before acting on it.

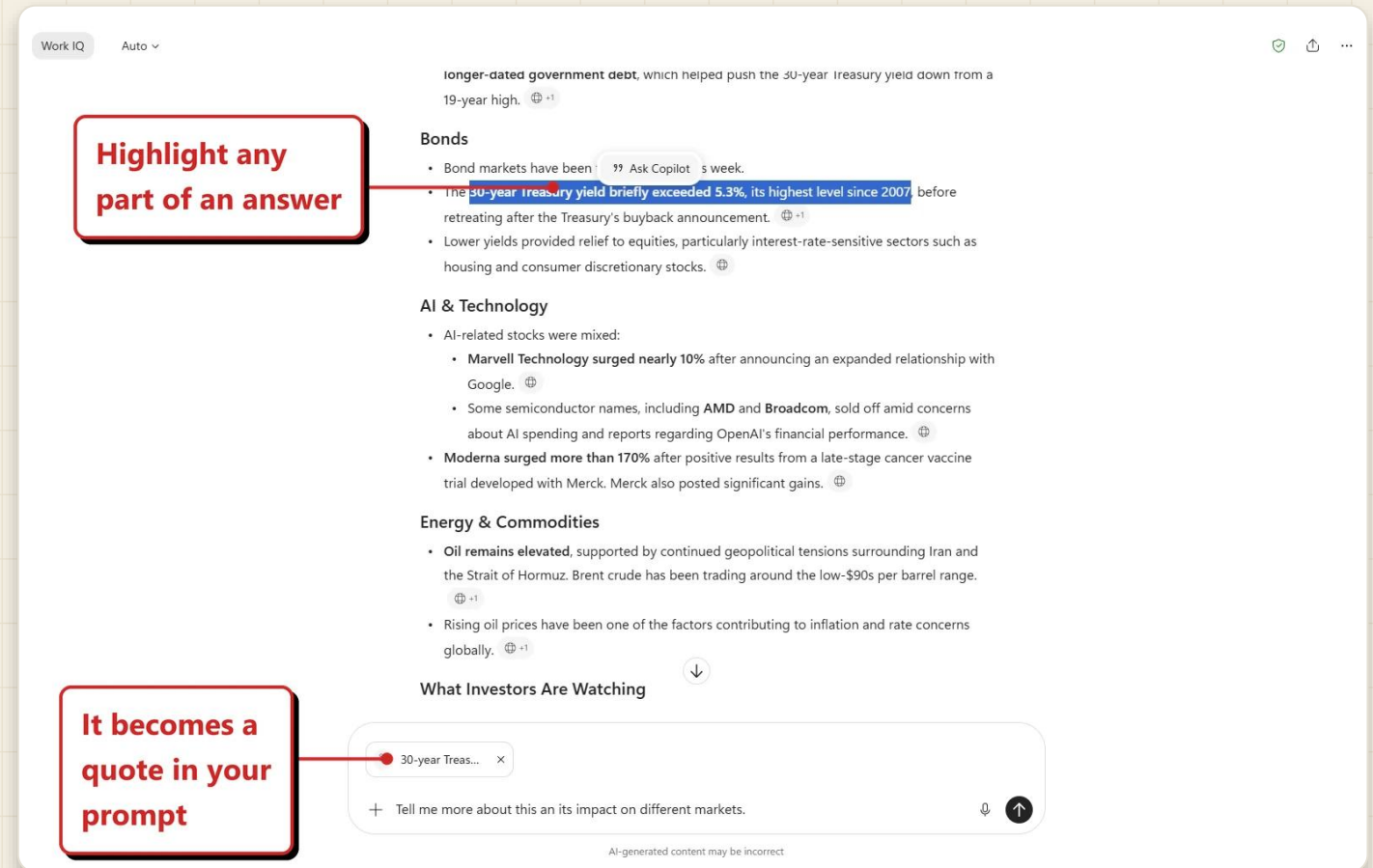
Why it matters

Most answers are partly useful. Being able to take the good paragraph without the surrounding padding is the difference between copying a response and using one.

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Rolled out August



Official Microsoft image from Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

Share a chat, and they can continue it

You can share a full chat session via a link, and the recipient opens their own copy that they can carry on from where you left it. The shared copy is a snapshot: Microsoft's share dialog warns that anyone in your company with the link can open a copy, and that it will not update as your original conversation continues.

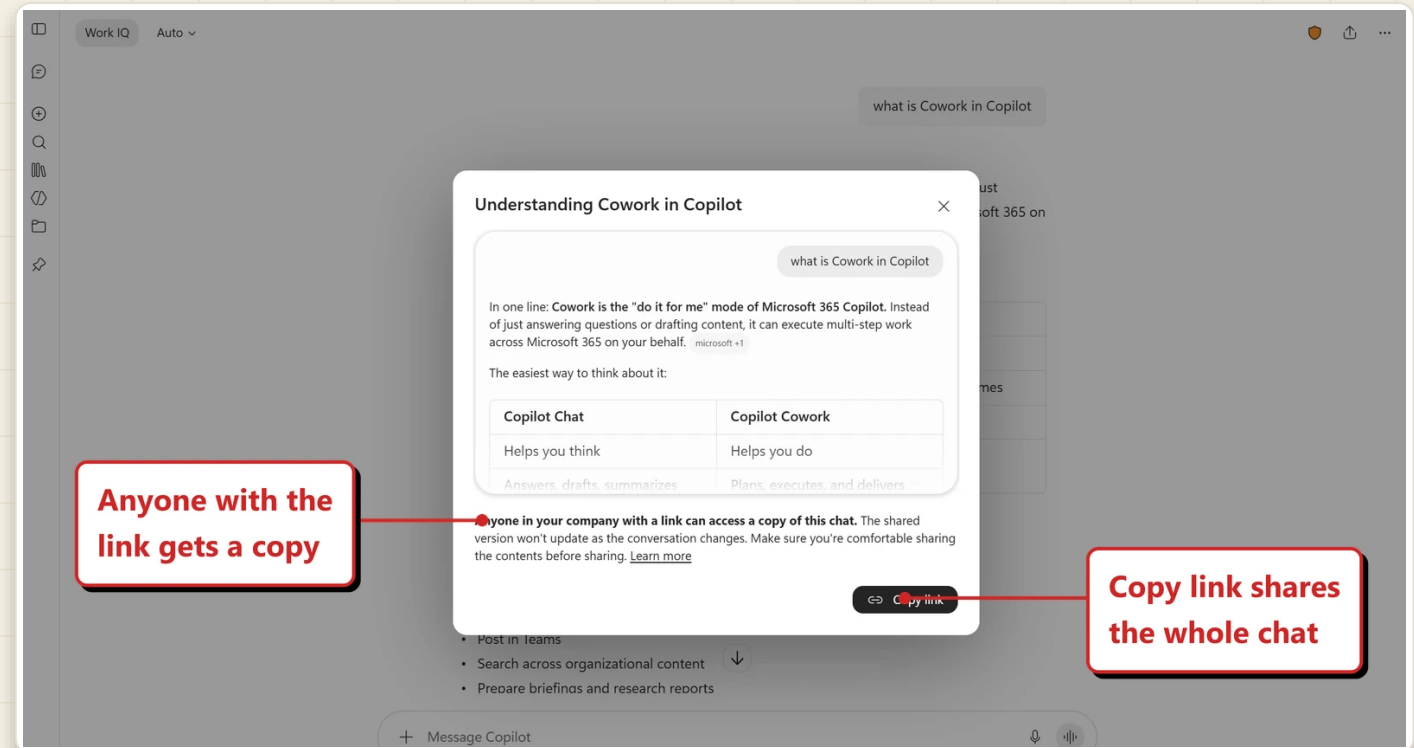
Why it matters

Until now, sharing Copilot work meant pasting the output and losing the reasoning. Passing the whole session across means the next person can see how the answer was reached and push it further, rather than starting again.

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Rolled out August



Official Microsoft image from Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

Share a single response on its own

Microsoft's description is that a single response can be shared by link from the **More options** menu, without sending the whole conversation.

What I found on 14 September 2026. It is there, and it carries a label worth noticing.

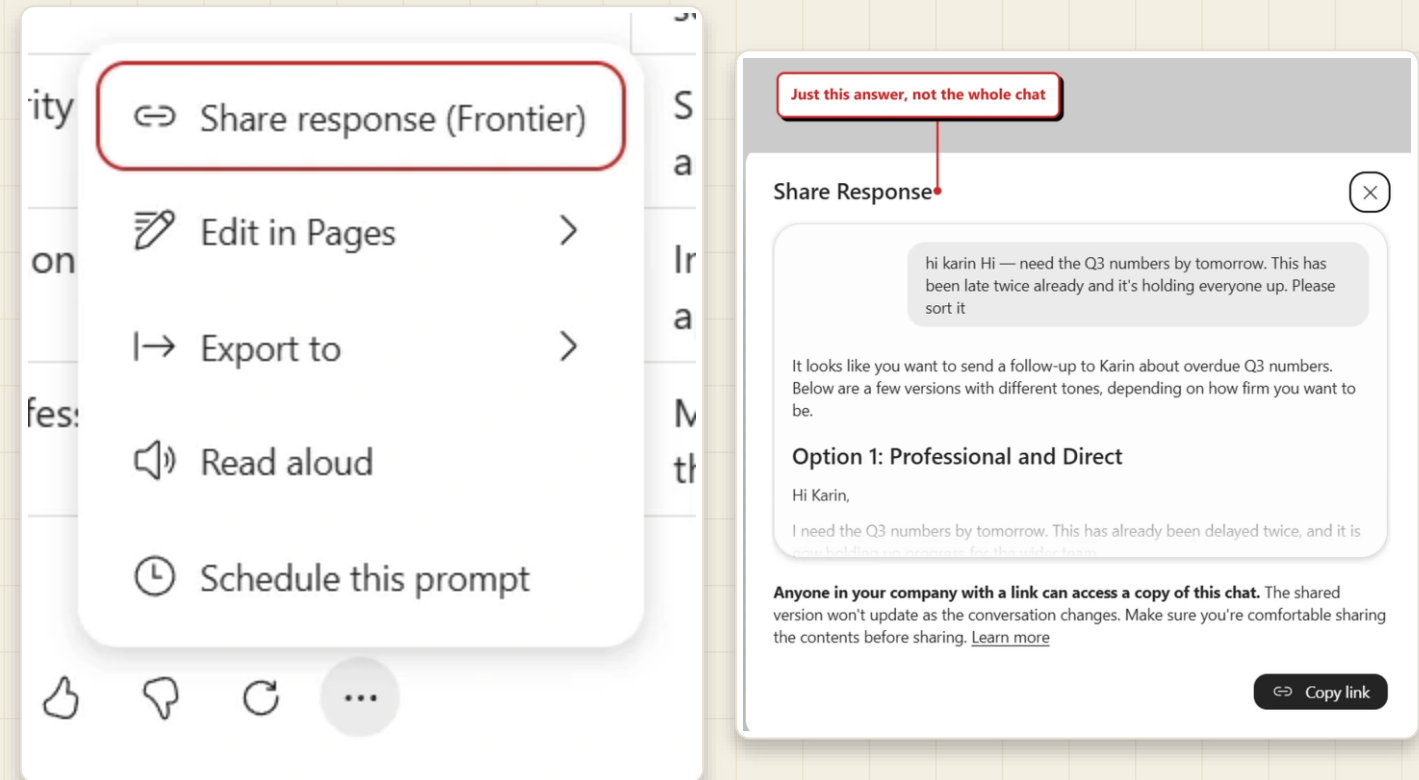
Why it matters

Conversations wander. Usually it is one answer in a long thread that is worth sending to someone, and sharing the whole lot makes them read everything else first. That is the promise being made here; whether the link really carries just the one answer is the bit I still have to confirm.

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Rolled out August



*My own tenant, 14 September 2026. The per-response menu, with the share item circled.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.*

Common questions answered with cards

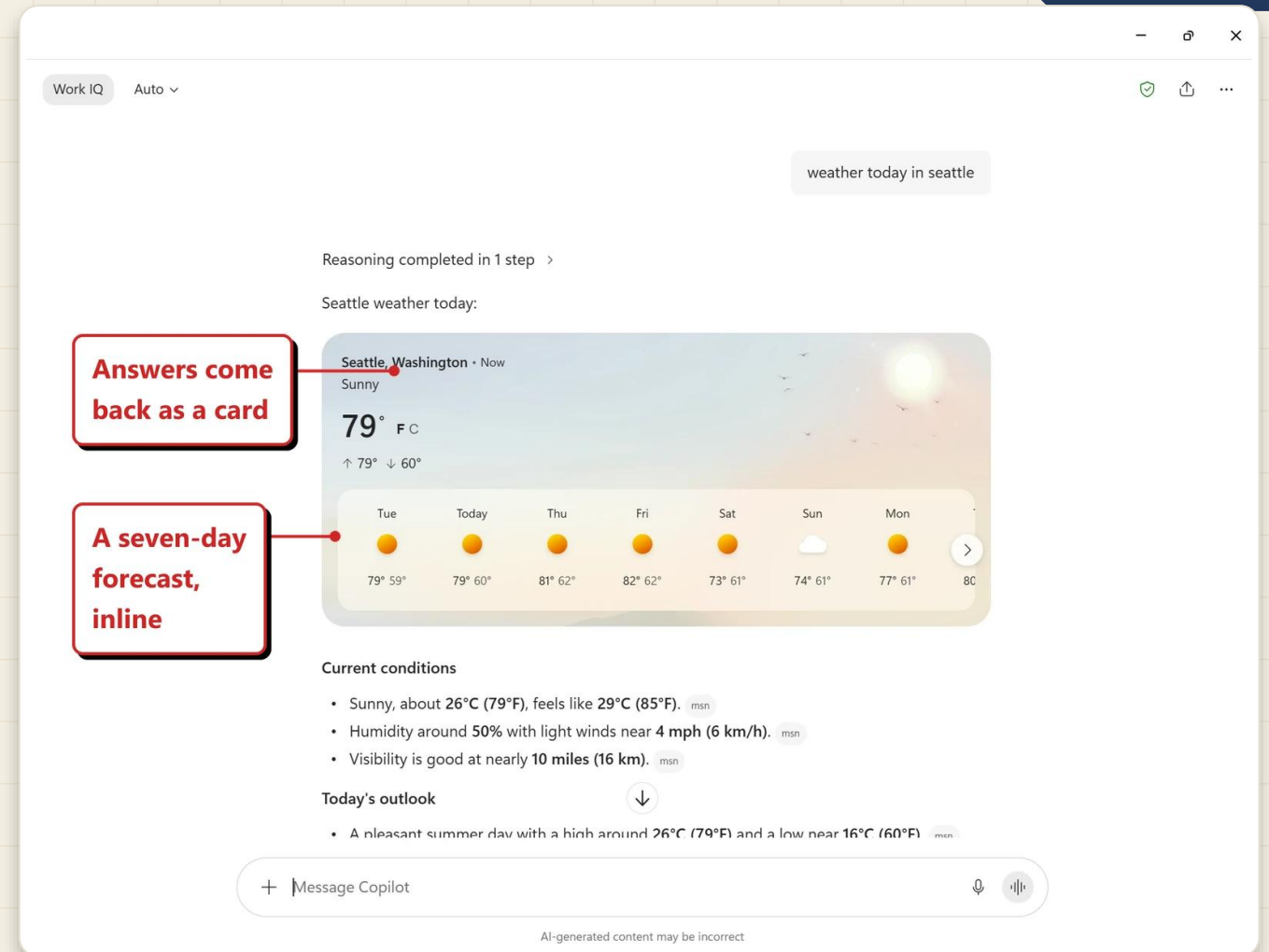
Copilot gained **model-driven answer cards** for weather, sports, finance, images, video, places and news, so those questions return a formatted card rather than a paragraph.

Why it matters

This is Copilot Chat becoming more like a place you would actually start your day. Small, but it is the kind of thing that decides whether people open Copilot first or their browser first.

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)



Official Microsoft image from Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

Mobile drafts email inside the chat

On mobile you can describe a message and Copilot creates an embedded Outlook draft inside the chat. Microsoft says you can then open it in Outlook.

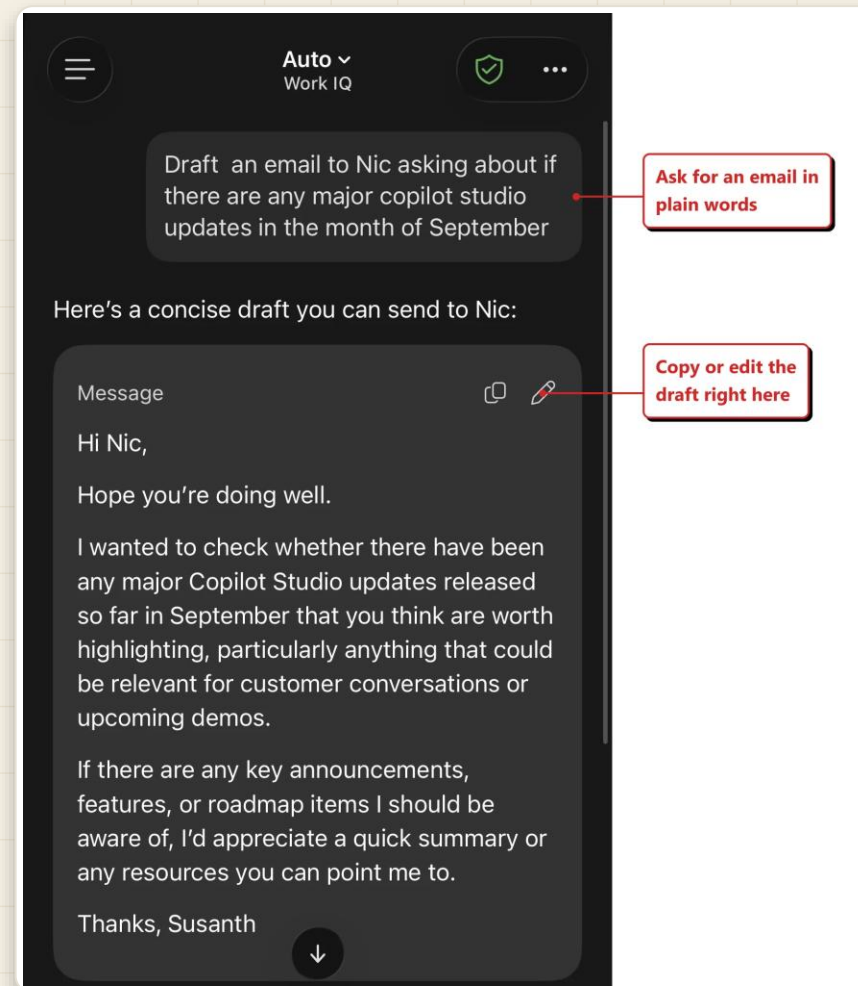
Why it matters

On a phone, switching apps is the whole cost. Drafting in place and handing the finished thing to Outlook is one of those flows that only makes sense on mobile, which is a good sign somebody designed it for mobile rather than shrinking the desktop version.

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Rolled out August



My own phone, 14 September 2026. The draft arrives as a card of its own, labelled Message, with copy and edit controls attached to it.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

Outlook emails open inside Chat

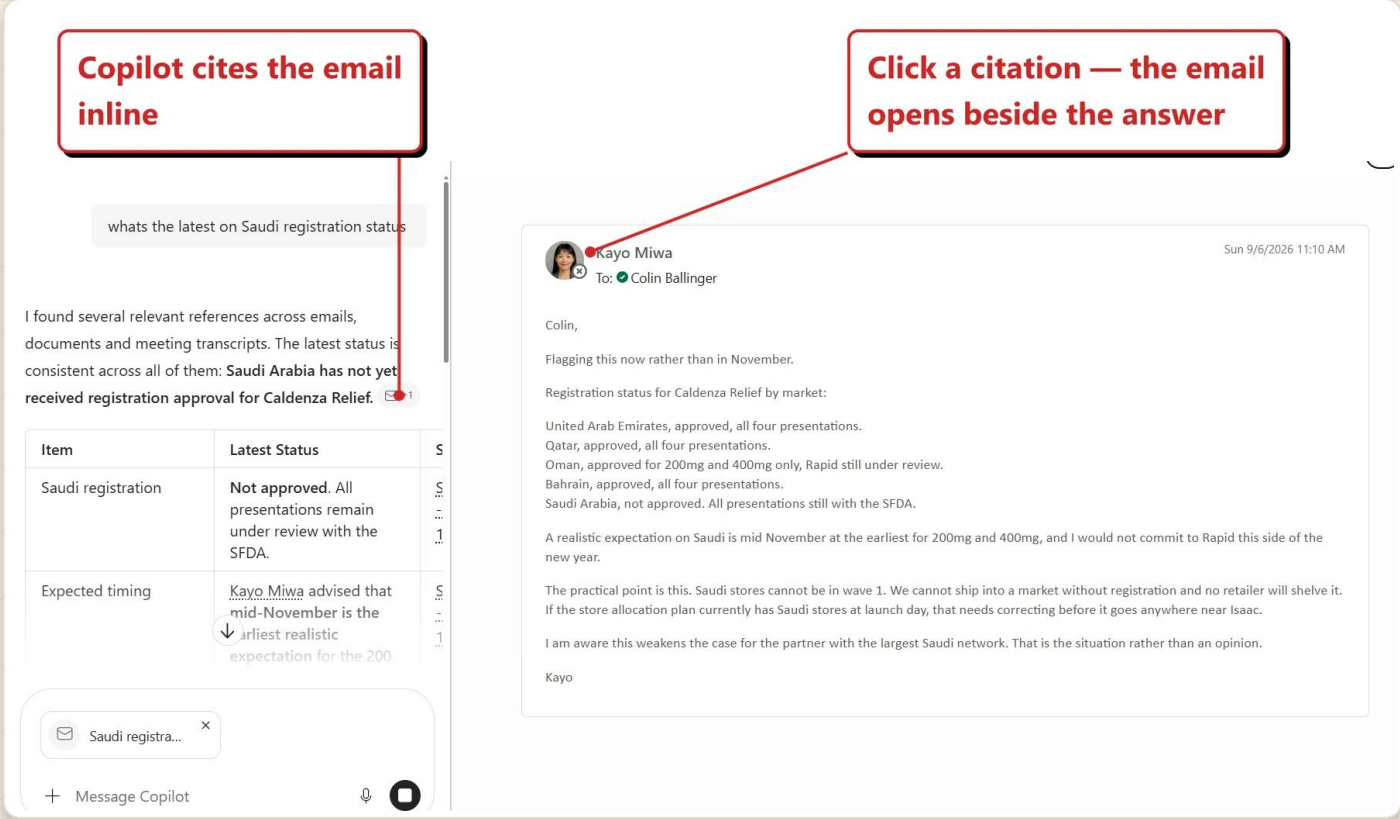
GA 25 August

You can open an Outlook email within Copilot Chat, rather than following a link out to Outlook and losing the thread of the conversation.

What I found on 14 September 2026. This works, and it does slightly more than the description suggests.

Why it matters

Copilot cites emails constantly. Every citation used to be a trapdoor out of the conversation, and people did not come back.



My own tenant, 14 September 2026. The cited email, opened beside the answer rather than in Outlook.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

Mobile can reshape or create a Page

GA 25 August

The Copilot app on mobile gained page steering and auto-triggering of pages. That phrase covers two separate things, and they are worth pulling apart.

Why it matters

Editing anything structured on a phone is awkward, so handing the fiddly part to an instruction is a sensible trade. The creation half is the more interesting one, because it lets a Page start life as a sentence in a chat rather than as a decision to go and make a Page.

On mobile, Copilot can reshape a Page — or make one

Microsoft 365 Copilot app · Android and iOS · Generally available 25 August 2026 · illustrative, not a screenshot

ONE NAME, TWO THINGS

“Page steering and auto-triggering” covers **two separate capabilities**, and the name obscures the more interesting one.

EDIT BY INSTRUCTION

Tell Copilot “**Shorten this page**” and it reworks the page — instead of you editing by hand on a phone screen.

CREATE FROM CHAT

Ask for “**Create a new page for XYZ**” in an ordinary conversation and a Page gets made, without going to Pages first.

WHAT IT IS NOT

“Auto-triggering” does **not** mean an existing Page surfaces itself at a convenient moment.

NOT TESTED I could not reproduce this in time for this issue, so the above is **Microsoft’s account rather than mine**. I will pick it up next month.

My own diagram of the two capabilities hiding behind one name — not a screenshot. I could not reproduce either in time, so this lays out Microsoft’s account rather than mine.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[Microsoft 365 Copilot release notes →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

The Copilot app is being renamed

Microsoft is moving Copilot to a single app experience across personal and work accounts, and three separate things follow from that.

Admin action required — organisations blocking the new host are redirected in early October 2026.

Why it matters

The app has absorbed Chat, Pages, Notebooks, Search, agents and Cowork in about a year, so simplification is not cosmetic at that point.

DO NEXT

Allow the whole *.cloud.microsoft domain before October.

[Deploy the unified Copilot app →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Rolling out August

The rename, the new address, and the October deadline

Microsoft 365 Copilot app · Admin action required · Rolling out August–October 2026 · illustrative, not a screenshot

WHY ONE RELEASE NOTE IS THREE JOBS

Microsoft is moving Copilot to a **single app experience** across personal and work accounts. Three separate things follow from that.

THE NAME

The app adopts “**Microsoft Copilot app**” and a new icon, plus a different background colour per account type and a **Work** label under the profile.

THE ADDRESS

The web app moves from **m365.cloud.microsoft** to **copilot.cloud.microsoft**. Users are redirected automatically.

THE DEADLINE

Notice **MC1462915**: in **early October 2026** Microsoft redirects everyone not already moved in early September. If you block that host, those users may be unable to use the web app.

EASILY MISSED A group policy that filters the former Copilot app out of Windows Recall snapshots does **not** carry over to the new one.

My own diagram of the three changes bundled into one release note — not a screenshot. The rename, the address move and the October deadline never appear together on a single screen.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

Chat sits beside Copilot Search

Copilot Chat is available in the side pane while you use Copilot Search, so you can ask a follow-up without abandoning the search results.

What I found on 14 September 2026. Search has a permanent home in the left rail, one click from the chat you are already in.

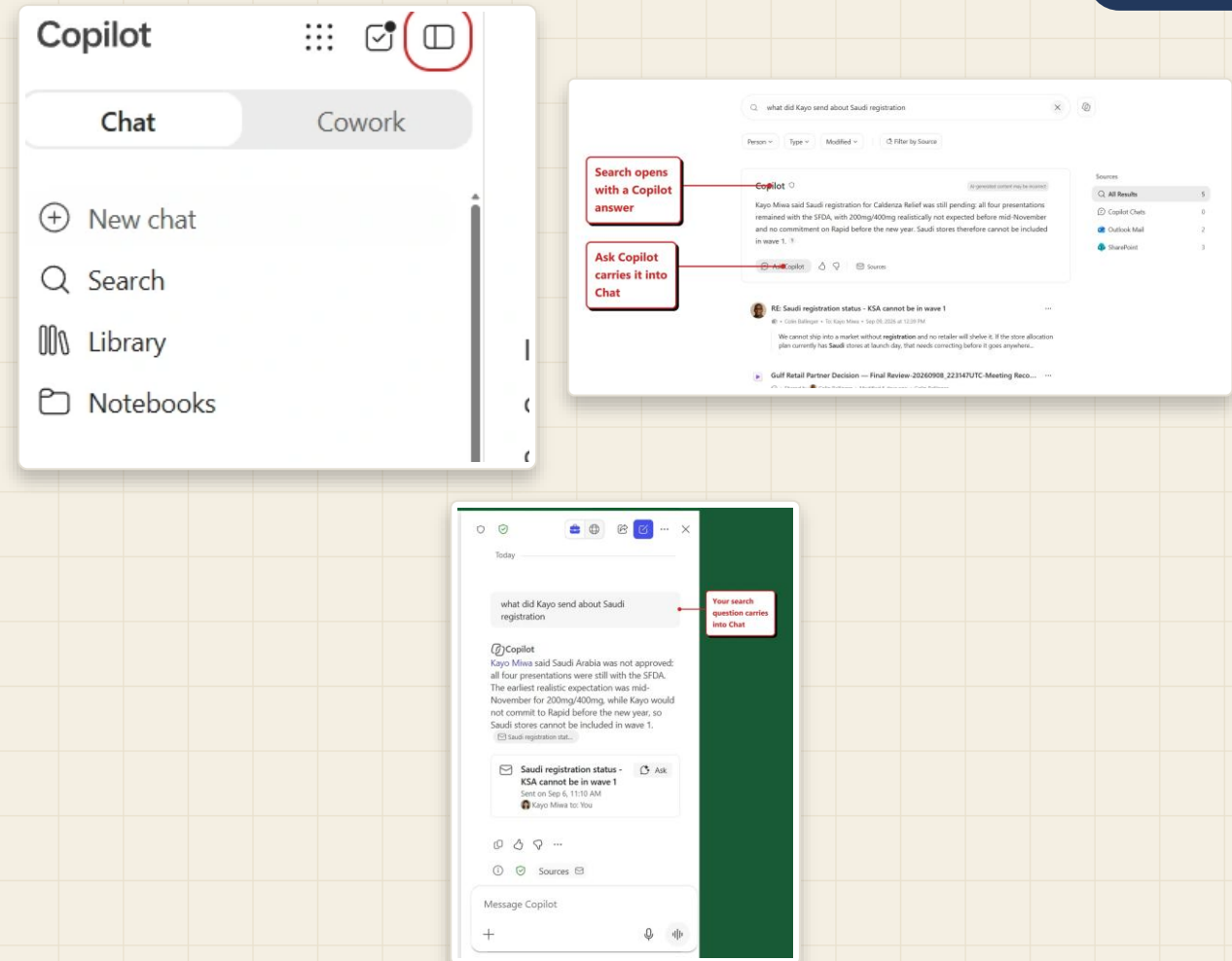
Why it matters

Search finds the document; chat explains it. Splitting those across two screens meant doing one and forgetting the other.

[AI at Work Roadmap 537281 →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

GA 25 August



My own tenant, 14 September 2026. Search sitting in the rail beside Library and Notebooks. The circled icon expands the rail so the labels appear.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

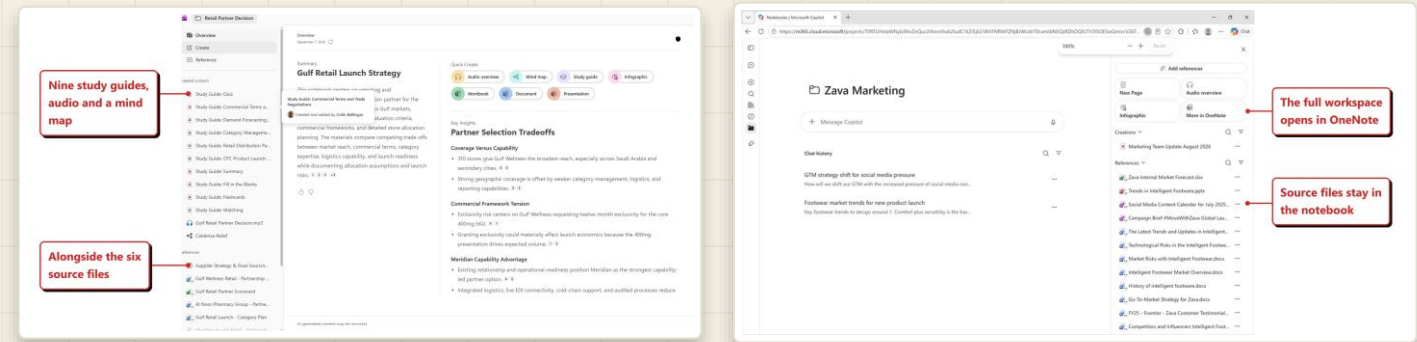
Notebooks split into two experiences

Rolled out August

Copilot Notebooks became **two connected experiences**: a lightweight one inside the Copilot app, and a full workspace in OneNote, kept in sync.

Why it matters

Notebooks were caught between being a quick scratchpad and a real workspace, and did neither well. Splitting the job while keeping one set of content is the sensible resolution — as long as the sync holds.



My own tenant, 14 September 2026. A notebook with nine generated study guides, an audio overview and a mind map sitting alongside six source files.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

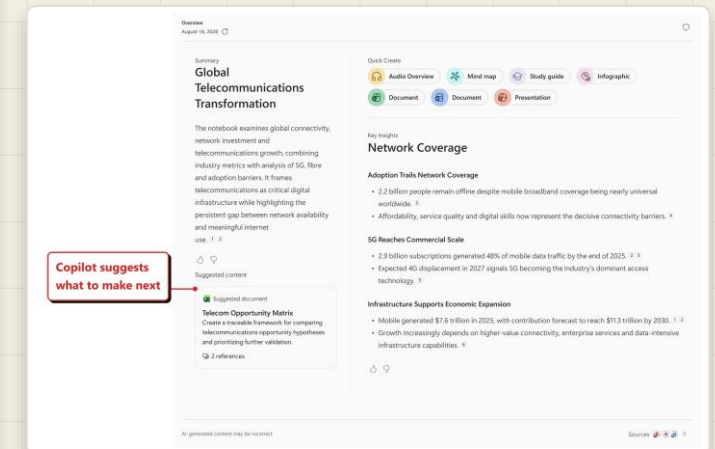
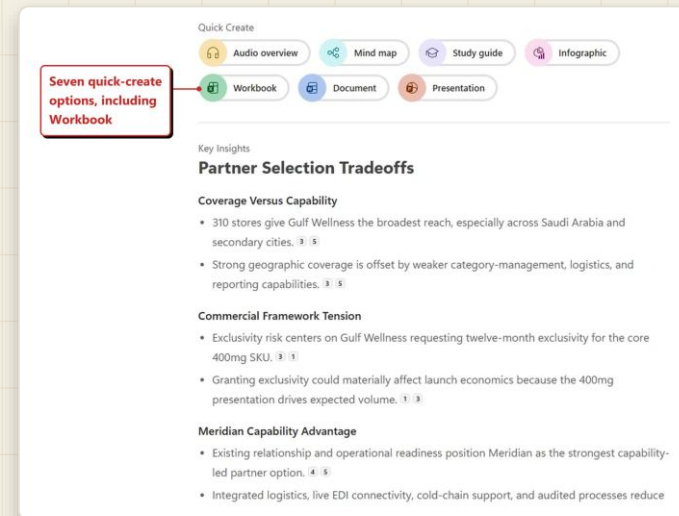
Notebooks suggest what to make next

Rolled out August

Notebooks gained **proactive artifact recommendations**. Drawing on Work IQ and what is already in the notebook, Copilot suggests generating a Word document, an Excel workbook or a PowerPoint deck from the material you have collected.

Why it matters

Research collapses at the point where notes have to become a deliverable. A prompt at that exact moment — here is what this could become — is well placed, though it will live or die on whether the suggestions are any good.



My own tenant, 14 September 2026. Quick Create — the green Excel button is named Workbook here. Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Notebooks take audio on Android

Multimodal capture brings audio, images and notes into one experience, automatically structured into notes and summaries.

Why it matters

This is the closest Microsoft has come to the way people actually capture things — a photo of a whiteboard, a voice memo walking to the car, three lines typed in a meeting. Making that one input rather than three is the useful part.

Rolling out September

Notebooks take audio, images and notes together

Copilot Notebooks on Android · Rolling out September 2026 · illustrative, not a screenshot

THE DETAIL THAT DECIDES WHETHER THIS IS NEW FOR YOU

Microsoft scopes this month's rollout to **Android**. On **iOS and iPad**, multimodal capture is already available through the OneNote app.

PRODUCE AUDIO — ALREADY WORKED

A notebook could **already** make an audio overview. That is section 14, and it works.

TAKE AUDIO IN — THE NEW HALF

Using audio as a **source** is the new part — and the half I could not reproduce.

WHAT I FOUND, 14 SEPTEMBER 2026 Adding a **meeting** as a source worked. An **.mp3** or a **.jpg** did not — the picker would not take them. The Windows entry (roadmap 566322) still read *In development*, so a desktop notebook was not yet in scope for what I was testing.

My own diagram of the produce-audio versus take-audio-in split — not a screenshot. The two are easy to confuse because the words are so nearly the same.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Power BI grounding went worldwide

Reasoning over Power BI reports and semantic models in natural language rolled out worldwide in August. The August issue covered this as a Frontier capability from June; it is now broadly available.

Why it matters

Of all the grounding sources Copilot has picked up, this is the one with the clearest business case. The semantic model already holds the agreed definitions of revenue, churn and margin — so the answer inherits governance instead of inventing its own maths.

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Public preview

Power BI grounding went worldwide

Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat and Copilot Cowork · illustrative, not a screenshot

WHAT CHANGED IN AUGUST

Nothing about the capability changed. The **audience** did.

JUNE 2026 — PUBLIC PREVIEW

Reasoning over Power BI reports and semantic models in natural language. The August issue covered this as a Frontier capability.

AUGUST 2026 — WORLDWIDE

The same capability, now rolled out broadly in Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat and Copilot Cowork.

WHY THE SOURCE MATTERS The semantic model already holds the agreed definitions of revenue, churn and margin.

My own diagram of the rollout — not a screenshot. A change in who can reach a capability has no new screen to photograph.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

Grounding in private Engage communities

GA 25 August

Copilot can use private community and event content in Viva Engage as grounding material. Microsoft's wording here is careful, and worth quoting rather than paraphrasing: private Engage content “will be used as grounding source for Microsoft 365 Copilot”, and “when a user queries in Microsoft 365 Copilot, they will only be able to see content they are privileged to access.”

Why it matters

Worth an admin conversation rather than a cheer. Private communities are private for a reason, and people post in them with an expectation about who is reading. Permissions are respected, but the set of places an answer can come from just got wider.

Viva Engage private communities can ground Copilot

Microsoft 365 Copilot + Viva Engage · Web · Generally available 25 August 2026 · illustrative, not a screenshot

MICROSOFT'S WORDING, QUOTED RATHER THAN PARAPHRASED

When a user queries, they “will only be able to see content they are **privileged to access**.”

WHAT DOES NOT CHANGE

The **permission model**. Nothing is being relaxed.

WHAT DOES CHANGE

The **size of the pool** Copilot may draw from for each person — bounded by what they could already have opened by hand.

TWO THAT ARE EASY TO MISS

Web only for now. And roadmap 515144 still shows May 2026 while the release notes place it in the 25 August batch.

WORTH AN ADMIN CONVERSATION RATHER THAN A CHEER People post in private communities with an expectation about who is reading. Permissions are respected — but the set of places an answer can come from just got wider. I do not have Viva Engage in my demo tenant, so this is Microsoft's account.

My own diagram of what does and does not change here — not a screenshot. The permission model is untouched; the size of the pool is the part that moved.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[AI at Work Roadmap 515144 →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

More connectors, some industry-specific

New connectors and plugins appeared, including Mercury, Xero, iManage Work, Boardwise, Harvey and Descrybe Legal Engine. Several are aimed at specific professions rather than general business software.

Why it matters

The pattern is more interesting than any single connector. Accounting, legal and board software are the systems where the answer people actually need lives — and where, until now, Copilot had nothing to say.

DO NEXT

Review each new connector before makers switch it on.

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

No date stated

More Copilot connectors, several industry-specific

Copilot connectors · Admin · No date stated by Microsoft · illustrative, not a screenshot

WHAT APPEARED

New connectors and plugins, aimed at specific professions rather than general business software.

THE SIX NAMED

Mercury · Xero · iManage Work · Boardwise · Harvey · Descrybe Legal Engine

THE PATTERN

Accounting, legal and board software — the systems where the answer people actually need lives, and where Copilot previously had nothing to say.

NO DATE ATTACHED Microsoft gave this list no rollout date, so treat availability as something to check in your own tenant.

My own diagram of the six named connectors — not a screenshot. Microsoft published this as a list, with no date and no image.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

The Work IQ APIs reached GA

GA 25 August

The **Work IQ APIs** — a unified REST endpoint for agents and workflows to reach work context — became generally available. The dates disagree on this one: Microsoft's release notes give 25 August 2026, while roadmap 559021 reads Launched with a June 2026 general-availability month. I am following the release notes, as everywhere else in this issue.

Why it matters

Work IQ is the grounding layer Microsoft keeps naming alongside the features in this issue — it is what Microsoft credits for grounding GPT-6 Astra in section 1.

The Work IQ APIs reached general availability

Copilot extensibility · AI at Work Roadmap 559021 · illustrative, not a screenshot

WHAT REACHED GENERAL AVAILABILITY

The **Work IQ APIs** — a unified REST endpoint for agents and workflows to reach work context.

STATUS

Generally available, 25 August 2026.

ROADMAP ENTRY

AI at Work Roadmap **559021**.

WHO CAN CALL IT

Agents and workflows — including anything your organisation builds.

*My own diagram of the release — not a screenshot. An API has no interface to photograph.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.*

[AI at Work Roadmap 559021 →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Connector crawling got faster

Content and identity crawling now run **in parallel**, improving how quickly connector content becomes current.

Why it matters

Stale connector content is one of the quietest ways Copilot loses trust — the answer is not wrong, it is just from last week. Freshness is a feature, even when nobody puts it on a slide.

[Microsoft 365 Copilot release notes →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

GA 11 August

Connector crawling got faster

Copilot connectors · Generally available 11 August 2026 · illustrative, not a screenshot

WHAT CHANGED

Content and identity crawling now run **in parallel**, improving how quickly connector content becomes current.

STATUS

Generally available, 11 August 2026.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Anyone using Copilot connectors. This is a service-side change.

WHAT THE NOTE DOES NOT SAY Microsoft gives no figure for how much faster, and I have not measured it.

My own diagram of the change — not a screenshot. A service-side speed improvement has no screen and no visible setting to photograph, and Microsoft publishes no number I could quote.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

ServiceNow connectors respect roles

GA 11 August

The **ServiceNow connectors support role-based permissions**, so what Copilot returns reflects the user's role in ServiceNow.

Why it matters

ServiceNow holds incidents, approvals and HR cases — exactly the content where "who can see this" is the whole question. Honouring the source system's roles is what makes a connector deployable rather than a risk.

[Microsoft 365 Copilot release notes →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

ServiceNow connectors respect role-based permissions

Copilot connectors · Generally available 11 August 2026 · illustrative, not a screenshot

WHAT CHANGED

The **ServiceNow connectors support role-based permissions**, so what Copilot returns reflects the user's role in ServiceNow.

STATUS

Generally available, 11 August 2026.

WHOSE RULES WIN

The source system's. Copilot honours the role ServiceNow already holds for that user.

ANNOUNCED, NOT REPRODUCED I have no ServiceNow instance connected, so this is Microsoft's description rather than something I tested.

My own diagram of the change — not a screenshot. I have no ServiceNow instance connected, so there is nothing in my tenant to photograph.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

Proactive push notifications: cancelled

In the August issue I covered proactive push notifications in the Copilot mobile app — *Your Day at a Glance* — as something Microsoft said had shipped, while noting the roadmap still said September. Microsoft has now marked that roadmap item **cancelled**.

Microsoft has marked this cancelled on the roadmap.

Why it matters

This is the first time in this series that something I covered has been cancelled outright. It is a useful reminder that a roadmap entry is a statement of intent, not a commitment — and that the gap between "announced" and "available" sometimes closes in the wrong direction.

DO NEXT

Take it out of any plan that still assumes it ships.

[AI at Work Roadmap 560339 →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Cancelled 26 August

Proactive push notifications were cancelled

Microsoft 365 Copilot mobile · AI at Work Roadmap 560339 · illustrative, not a screenshot

ROADMAP ID

~~560339~~

Cancelled

Marked cancelled 26 August 2026

MICROSOFT'S NOTE ON THE ENTRY

"Updated August 26, 2026: We have decided not to move forward with this change at this time."

The August issue covered this as something Microsoft said had shipped, while noting the roadmap still said September. The entry was marked cancelled after that issue went out.

IF YOU ACTED ON IT If *Your Day at a Glance* reached a communications plan or an adoption deck, it needs withdrawing.

My own diagram of the cancelled entry — not a screenshot. A cancelled roadmap item has no product screen to photograph; the note on the entry is the whole story.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

Interactive meeting agents: cancelled

The roadmap entry for Interactive Agents for Teams Meetings and Calls is also marked cancelled, with the note *"Updated August 17, 2026: We have decided not to move forward with this change at this time."*

Microsoft has marked this cancelled on the roadmap.

Why it matters

Two cancellations inside ten days is unusual enough to notice. Both were agent features, and both were about Copilot acting without being asked. Microsoft gives no reason for either, so I am not going to invent one — but if either was on your roadmap, they went together.

DO NEXT

Take it out of any Teams meeting-agent plan.

[AI at Work Roadmap 490564 →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Cancelled 17 August

Interactive Agents for Teams Meetings and Calls was cancelled

Microsoft Teams · AI at Work Roadmap 490564 · illustrative, not a screenshot

ROADMAP ID

~~490564~~

Cancelled

Marked cancelled 17 August 2026

MICROSOFT'S NOTE ON THE ENTRY

"Updated August 17, 2026: We have decided not to move forward with this change at this time."

This one never reached an issue of this series, so there is nothing to withdraw.

IF YOU ACTED ON IT If you were waiting for agents that take part in a meeting as it happens, that specific item is gone.

My own diagram of the cancelled entry — not a screenshot. Nothing shipped, so there is nothing to photograph.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

SECTION 02

Copilot Cowork

02

Cowork builds apps from a description

The **App skill** creates lightweight, interactive apps from a description, without writing code. Microsoft's own wording is worth quoting: you *"refine your app in chat, open it, publish it, and share it with people in your organization."*

Availability: Microsoft Frontier Program.

Why it matters

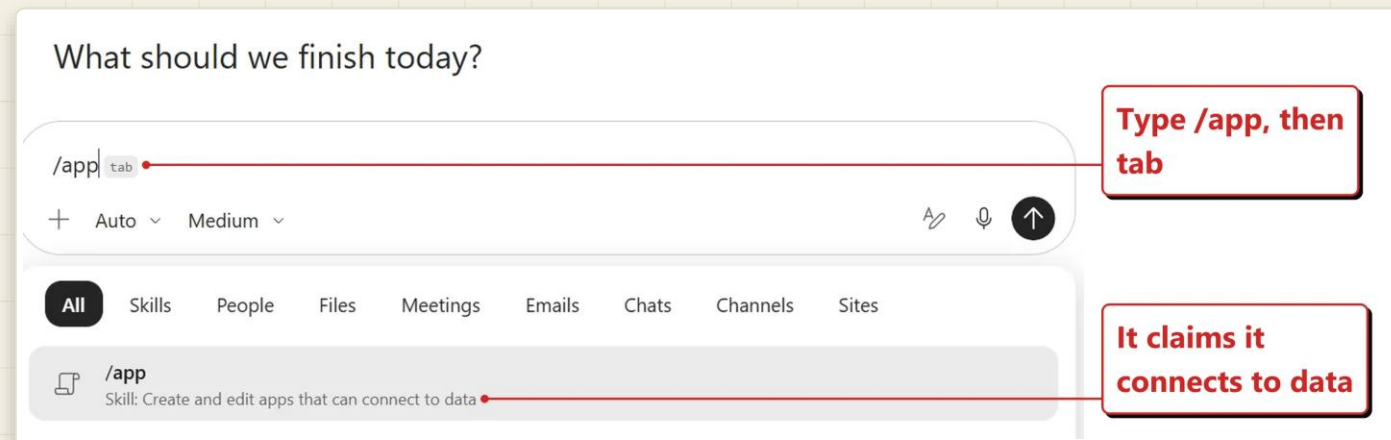
The step that usually kills a small internal tool is not building it — it is publishing and sharing it. All four steps in one chat is the claim that would make this different from the many things that have generated code and left you holding it, and it is the claim I would test first.

DO NEXT

Try one small app before writing a policy for it.

[What's new in Copilot Cowork →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)



My own tenant, 14 September 2026. Typing a slash in Cowork brings up the picker, with the App skill describing itself.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

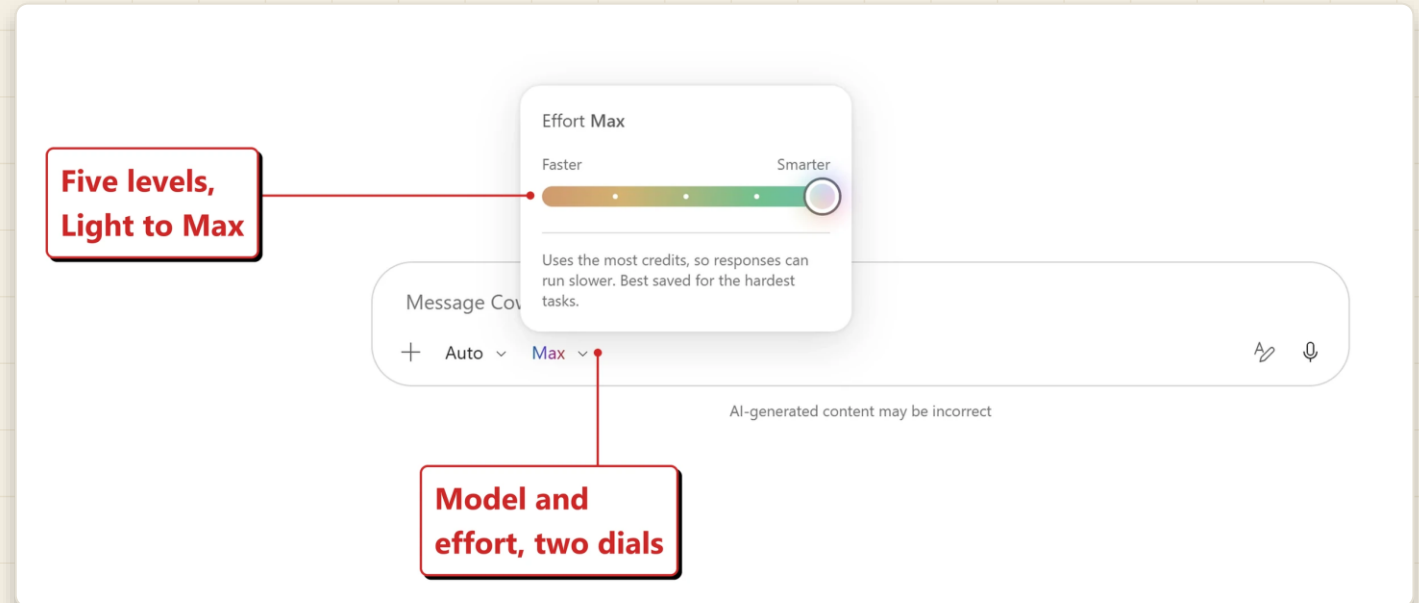
Choose how hard Cowork thinks

Cowork gained an **effort level** — Light, Medium, High, Extra High and Max — that trades quality against speed and credit usage. Medium is the default, and the control sits next to the model picker.

Why it matters

Model choice was only half the dial. Plenty of tasks need a good model thinking briefly, and plenty need a cheap one thinking hard. Exposing effort separately from model is the first time the cost and the quality levers have been honestly separated.

Rolled out August



Official Microsoft image from Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

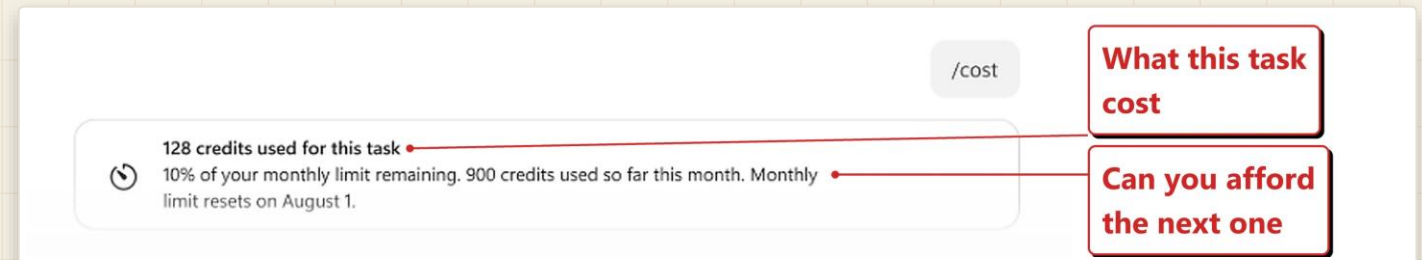
A cost skill shows your month so far

The /cost skill now reports the percentage of your monthly credit limit remaining, **credits used month to date** and the **reset date**, on top of the estimate for the task in front of you.

Why it matters

A per-task estimate tells you what one thing costs. It does not tell you whether you can afford it. Showing the month-to-date position and the reset date turns a number into a decision, and it does it in front of the user rather than in an admin report they never see.

Rolled out August



Official Microsoft image from Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

The Scheduled tab became Automations

The **Scheduled** tab was renamed **Automations**, and now holds both scheduled prompts and event-triggered tasks in one place.

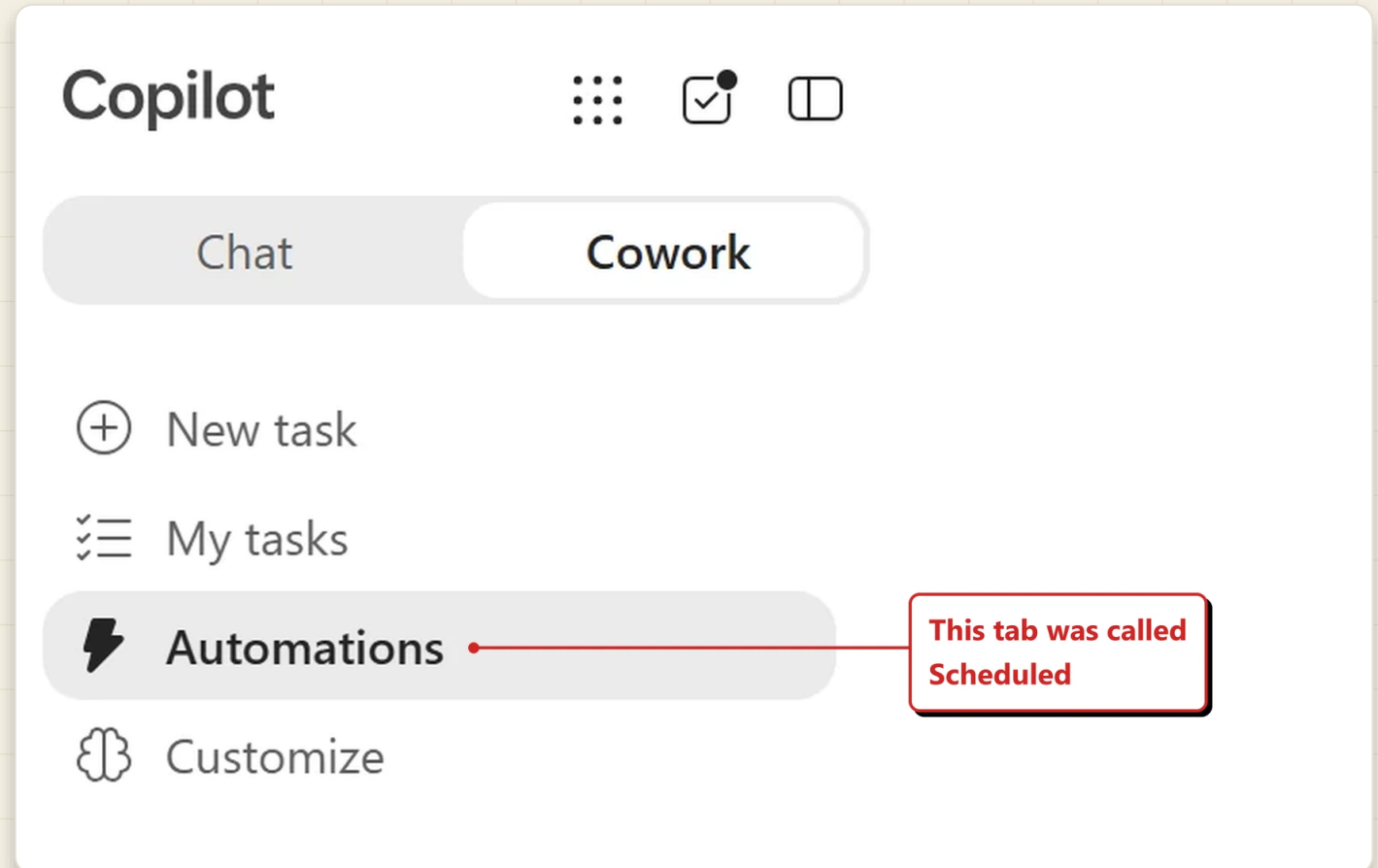
Why it matters

A rename is usually cosmetic. This one is not — once tasks can fire on an event as well as a clock, "Scheduled" was describing half the contents. It is also the page to check first if you ever wonder what Cowork is doing when you are not watching.

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Rolled out August



*Official Microsoft image from Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.*

Local browser use reached every tenant

GA August

Cowork's **local browser use** moved from the Frontier Program to general availability for all Microsoft 365 Copilot tenants. Cowork can complete web tasks in Microsoft Edge on your device, using your existing sign-ins and your organisation's policies. Edge must be installed.

Why it matters

This is the most consequential availability change in the issue. "Uses your existing sign-ins" means Cowork acts inside sessions you have already authenticated — so alongside "does it work well enough", there is a second question worth asking early: which internal sites are you comfortable with it reaching.

Local browser use reached every Copilot tenant

Copilot Cowork · Generally available August 2026 · illustrative, not a screenshot

WHAT ACTUALLY CHANGED

Not the capability — **who has it**. Local browser use moved out of the Frontier Program to all Microsoft 365 Copilot tenants.

JUNE 2026

Listed in the Cowork release notes as a **Frontier** capability.

AUGUST 2026

Moved from Frontier to **general availability**. Cowork completes web tasks in **Microsoft Edge** on your device, using your existing sign-ins and your organisation's policies. Edge must be installed.

THE SECOND QUESTION WORTH ASKING EARLY "Uses your existing sign-ins" means Cowork acts inside sessions you have **already authenticated**. So alongside "does it work well enough": **which internal sites are you comfortable with it reaching?**

My own diagram of the Frontier-to-general-availability move — not a screenshot. The capability is not new; the audience is.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[What's new in Copilot Cowork →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

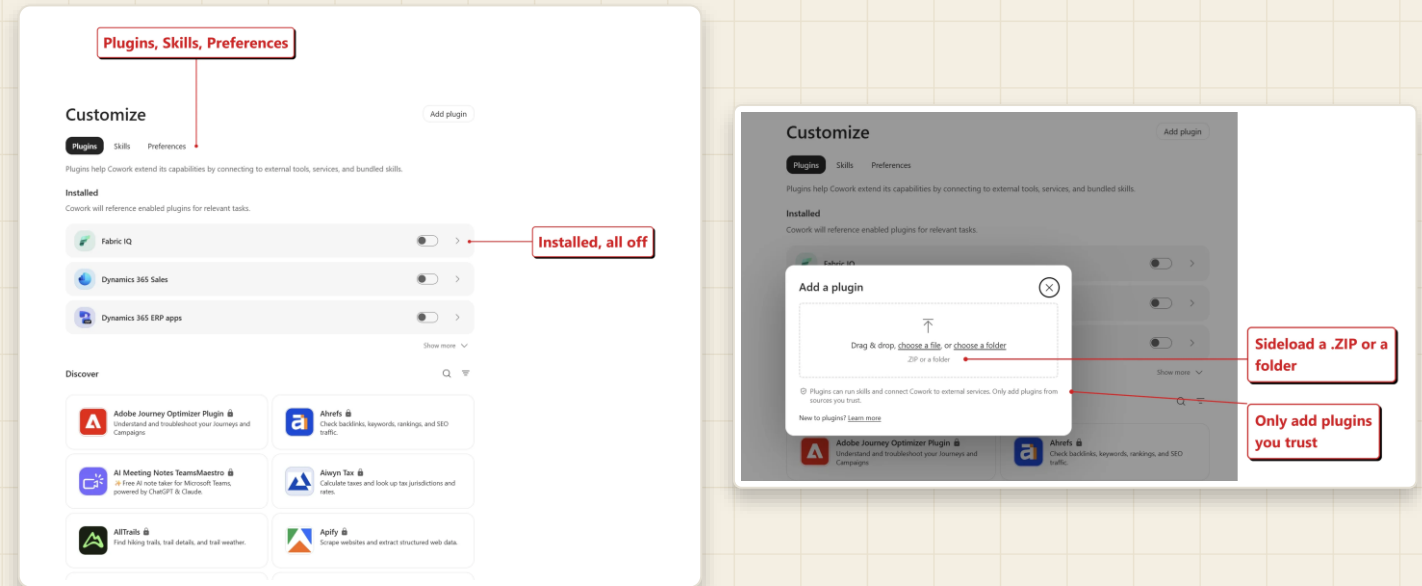
Plugins can take files from your session

GA August

Plugin connector tools can accept files from your Cowork session as input. A plugin author declares a tool parameter with `contentEncoding: base64`, and Cowork resolves the workspace file into content before calling the tool — so a plugin can convert a document, analyse an image or push a file into another system.

Why it matters

Plugins that could only exchange text were limited to fetching and returning facts. Handing a real file across is what lets an integration do the actual job — sign it, convert it, file it — instead of describing it.



*My own tenant, 14 September 2026. Cowork's plugin page: what is installed above, a catalogue below.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.*

[What's new in Copilot Cowork →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Cowork plugins set up on the phone

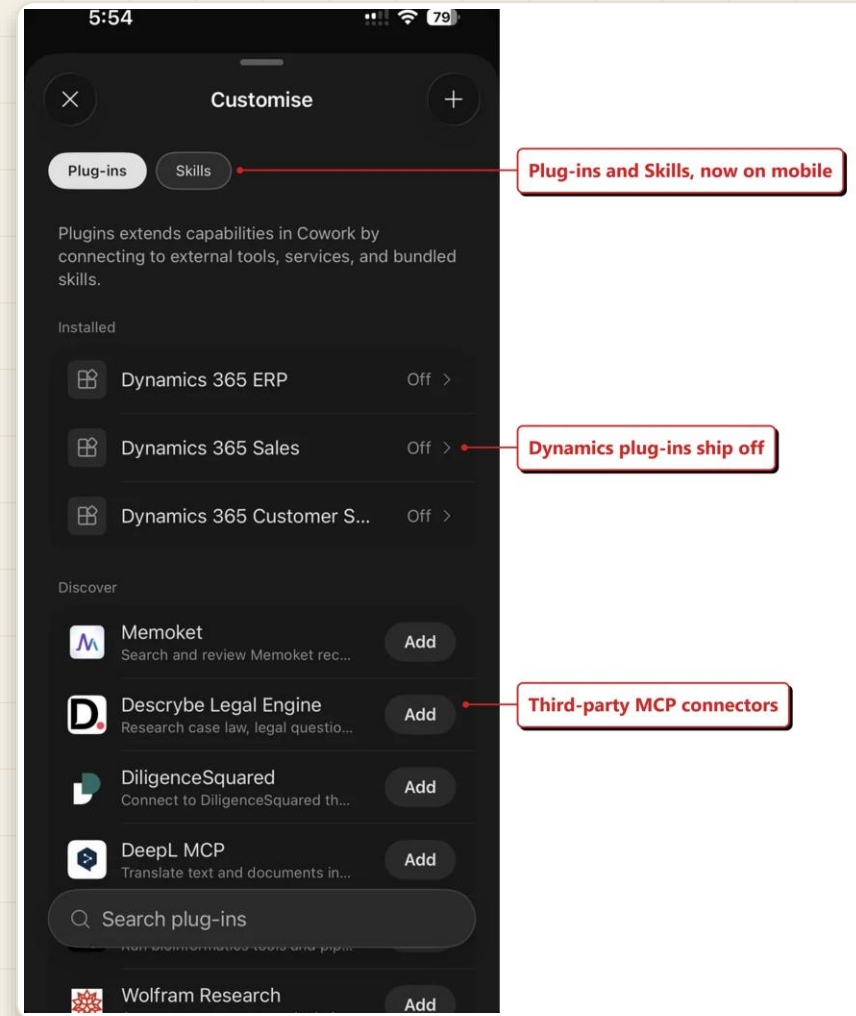
Plugins are discoverable and configurable on the mobile app. You find them through the attach menu (+) then **Skills**.

What I found on 14 September 2026. It is a genuine peer of the desktop page rather than a read-only view of it.

Why it matters

Cowork is built around handing work over and coming back later, which is exactly the shape of work people check on their phone. Plugins being desktop-only quietly meant the useful version of Cowork was desktop-only too.

September 2026



My own phone, 14 September 2026. The Customise sheet, with Plug-ins and Skills sitting side by side. Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[What's new in Copilot Cowork →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

SECTION 03

Microsoft 365 apps and everyday work

03

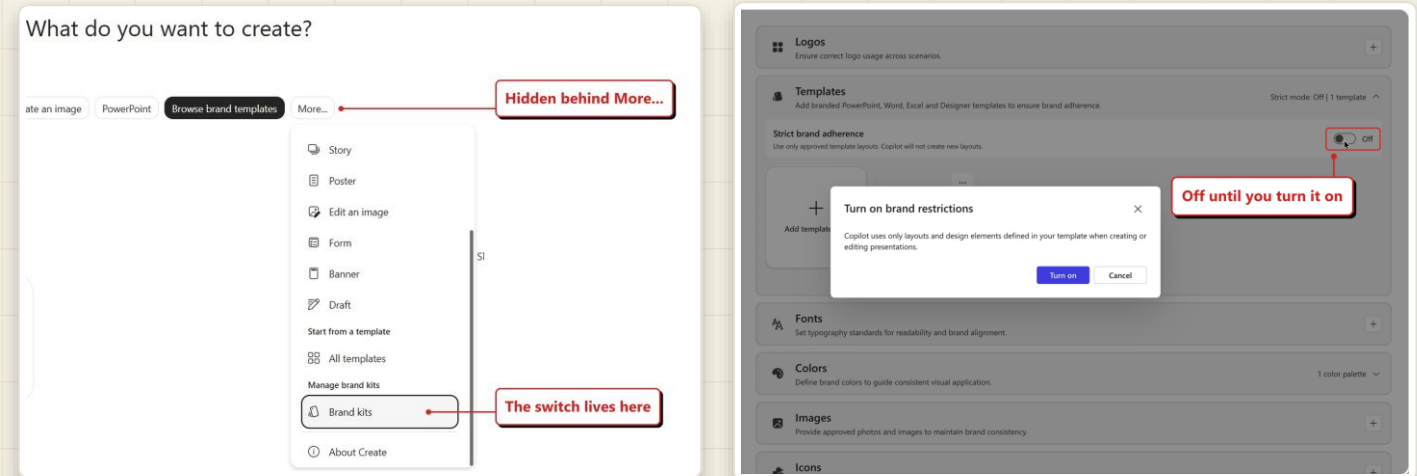
PowerPoint locked to your template

Copilot in PowerPoint gained **strict brand adherence**. Microsoft's wording is that it "*restricts Copilot to your approved template and slide master layouts*", and that when it is on "*Copilot won't add or remove placeholders or invent new layouts*". The switch itself reads "*Use only approved template layouts, Copilot will not create new layouts.*"

Why it matters

Every organisation has a deck template, and every organisation has decks that ignore it. If Copilot is the thing building the slides, the template stops being a guideline and starts being a boundary.

Rolled out August



My own tenant, 14 September 2026 — the setting is not in PowerPoint. It lives in the Copilot app under Create → More... → Brand kits.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[Manage brand kit template settings in Power... →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Slide notes steer Copilot slide by slide

Note steering lets you write plain-language instructions into a slide's notes field, and Copilot follows them for that slide. Instead of one instruction for the whole deck, you get governance at the level of the individual slide.

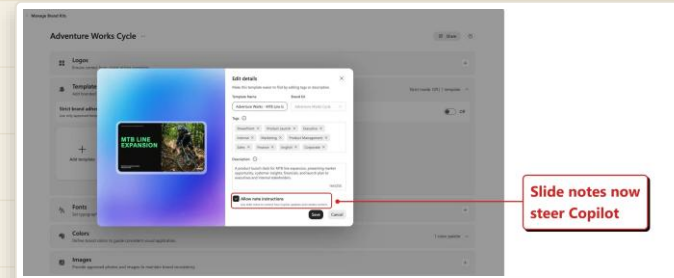
Why it matters

Long prompts try to describe a whole deck at once, and the detail gets lost. Putting the instruction next to the slide it applies to is a much more natural way to work, and it survives into the next revision because it lives in the file.

[Manage brand kit template settings in Power... →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Rolled out August



Edit details

Make this template easier to find by editing tags or description.

Template Name

Caldova Brand Template

Brand Kit

Caldova Brand Kit

Tags

PowerPoint × Internal Memo × Strategy Deck × Internal × Executive × Product Management × Engineering × English × Minimalist ×

Description

A minimalist corporate template for internal communication and strategy, providing structure for presenting research, statistics, and product development updates.

162/250

Save Cancel

No note checkbox here on 14 September 2026

Official Microsoft image from Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

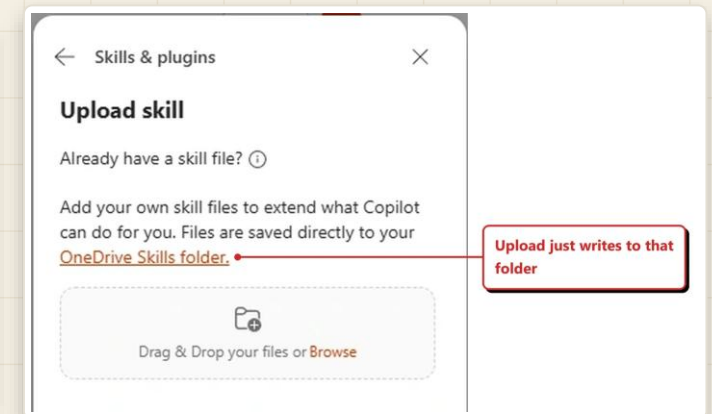
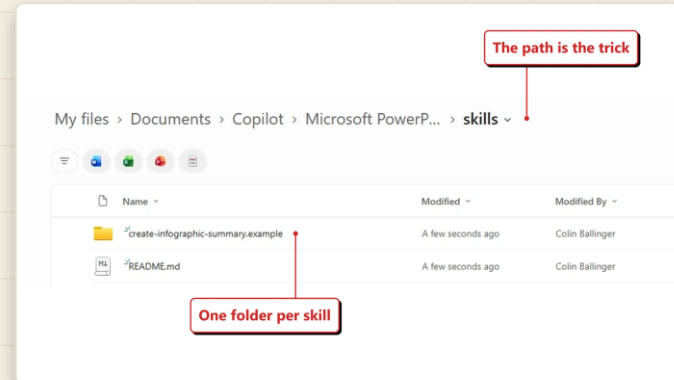
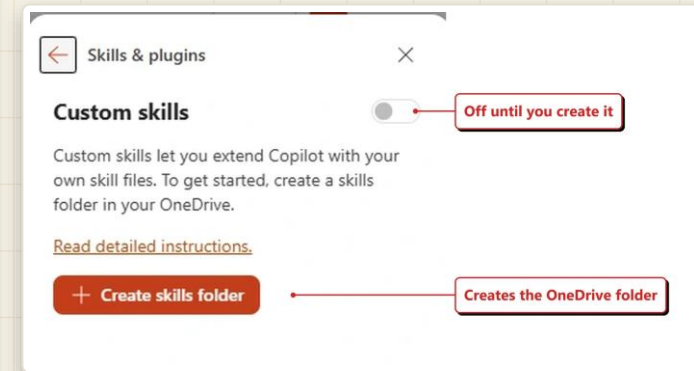
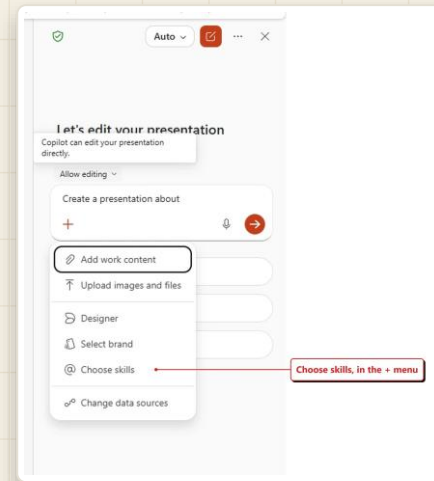
Author your own PowerPoint skills

The August issue covered PowerPoint skills arriving, with custom skill files appearing from a OneDrive folder. What changed is the authoring: you can now upload, create, edit and delete your own skills rather than only using what is already there.

Why it matters

The gap between "there are skills" and "I can write a skill" is the gap between a feature and a habit. Teams that build their own get a shared way of working; teams that only consume get whatever Microsoft shipped.

Rolled out August



My own tenant, 14 September 2026. Choose skills is the entry point, and it lives behind the plus button rather than anywhere obvious.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Translation moved into Copilot

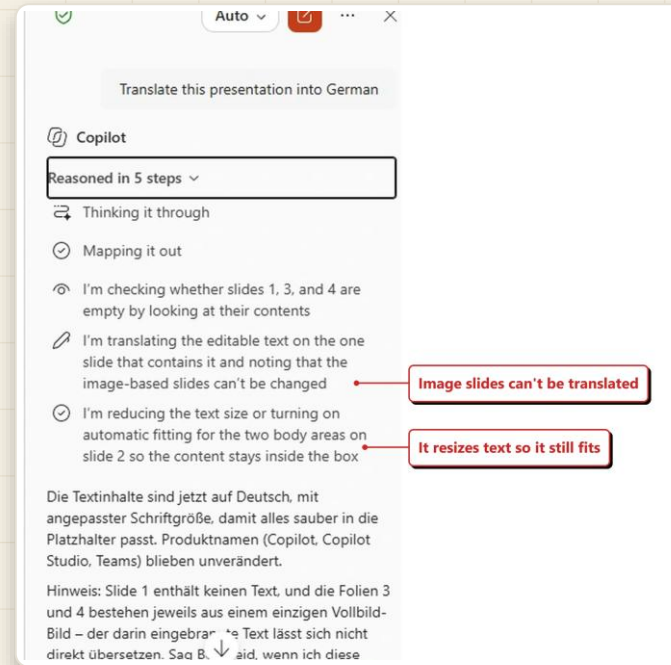
Translation moved out of the ribbon and into Copilot. It also **dynamically resizes text boxes** to fit the translated text.

Anyone who has translated a deck into German knows why that second sentence matters more than the first.

Why it matters

Translation was never the hard part. The hard part was the hour afterwards spent fixing every slide where the new text no longer fitted. Handing the reflow to Copilot removes the bit that made people avoid translating decks at all.

Rolled out August



Copilot Agents vs. Copilot Studio Agents

Copilot Agent

- Schlanker Assistent, direkt in Microsoft 365 Copilot integriert
- In Minuten von Fachanwendern erstellt – ohne Entwicklerkenntnisse
- Verankert in Ihren Dateien, Sites und Graph-Daten
- Läuft dort, wo Sie arbeiten: Chat, Teams, Word, Outlook
- Ideal für: schnelle Aufgabenhilfe und Wissenssuche

Copilot Studio Agent

- Vollständige Authoring-Umgebung für individuelle, erweiterbare Agents
- Von Makern und IT erstellt – mit Themen, Triggern und Logik
- Verbindet externe Systeme über Konnektoren und APIs
- Veröffentlichung in Teams, auf Websites und weiteren Kanälen
- Ideal für: automatisierte Workflows im gesamten Unternehmen

German runs longer, and it still fits

My own tenant, 14 September 2026. The fourth reasoning step is the feature describing itself — and note that it talks about shrinking the text and turning on autofit, rather than resizing the box.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Copilot can edit SmartArt on the canvas

Microsoft's description is that Copilot can edit SmartArt, diagrams and shapes directly on the canvas, on brand, instead of leaving you to align things by hand.

Availability: Microsoft Frontier Program.

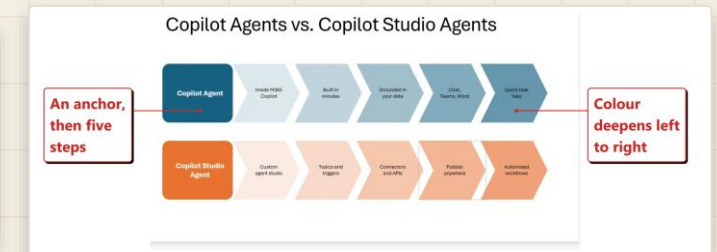
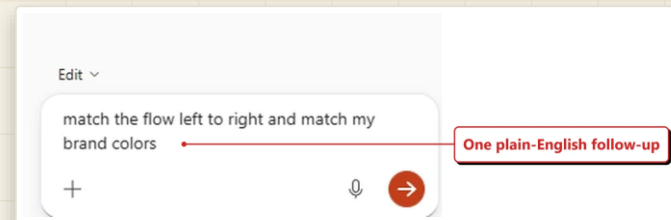
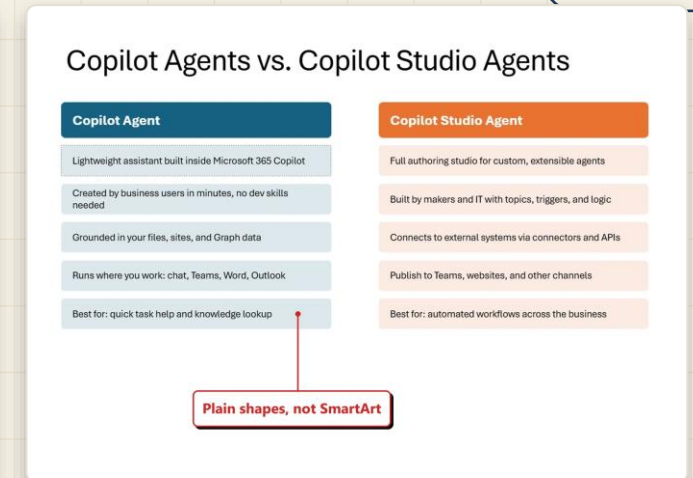
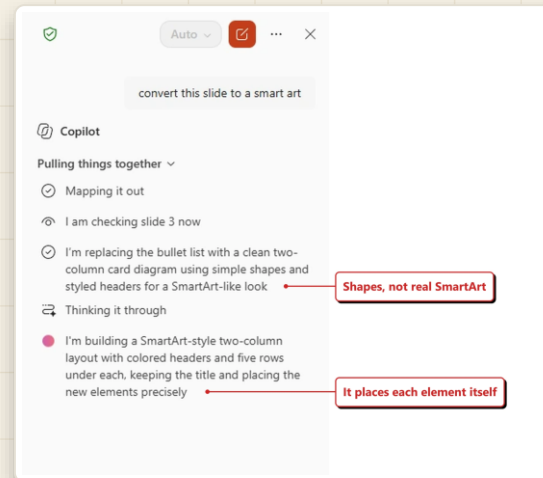
Why it matters

Diagrams are where deck work quietly loses an afternoon. Nudging boxes into alignment is not thinking, it is admin — and it is exactly the kind of fiddly, rule-based work a model is good at.

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Frontier · Aug



My own tenant, 14 September 2026. SmartArt-like, built from simple shapes — Copilot saying plainly that this is not PowerPoint's SmartArt engine.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

Build a deck from an email

You can **reference an email** when asking Copilot to create a presentation. The thread becomes the source material for the deck.

Windows desktop only.

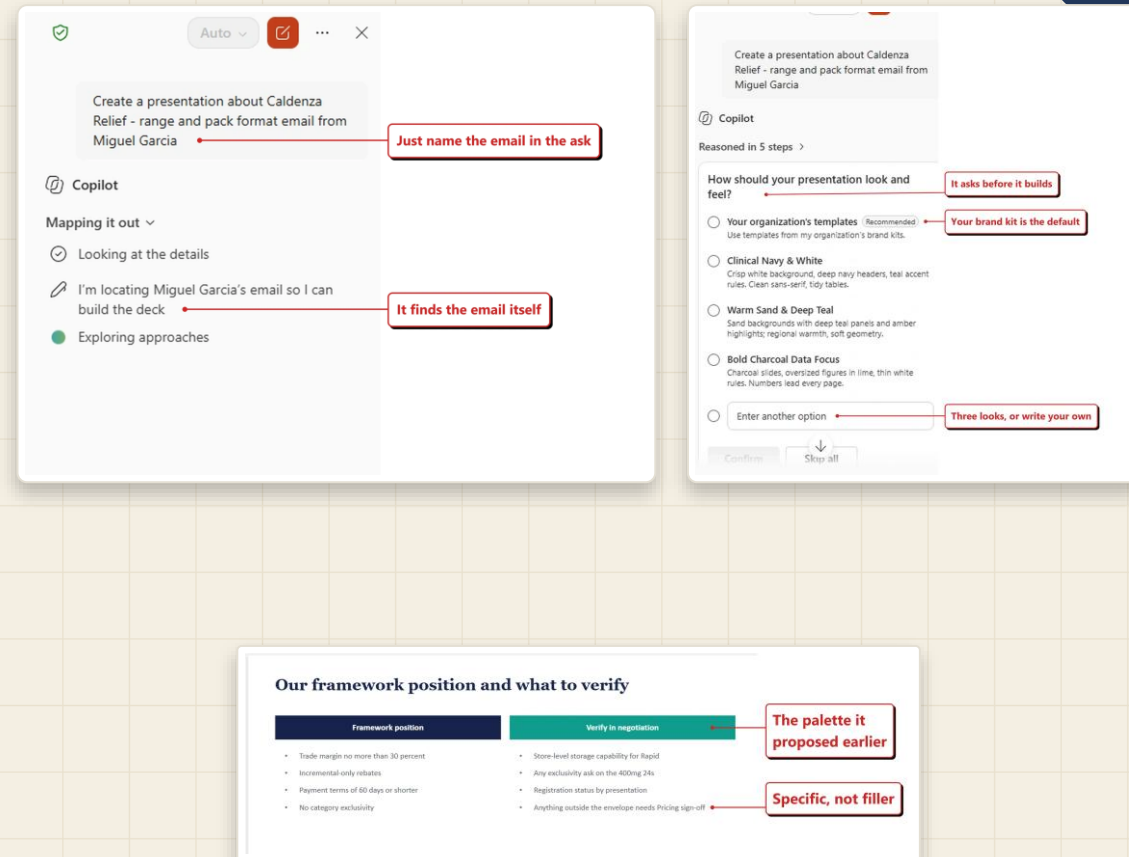
Why it matters

A surprising number of decks start life as an email that got too long. Pointing Copilot at the thread skips the step where someone copies the argument into a blank slide and loses half of it.

[AI at Work Roadmap 555888](#) →

[Read the full update on the blog](#) →

GA 25 August



My own tenant, 14 September 2026. No attachment and no picker — Copilot searched my mailbox from the description in the prompt.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

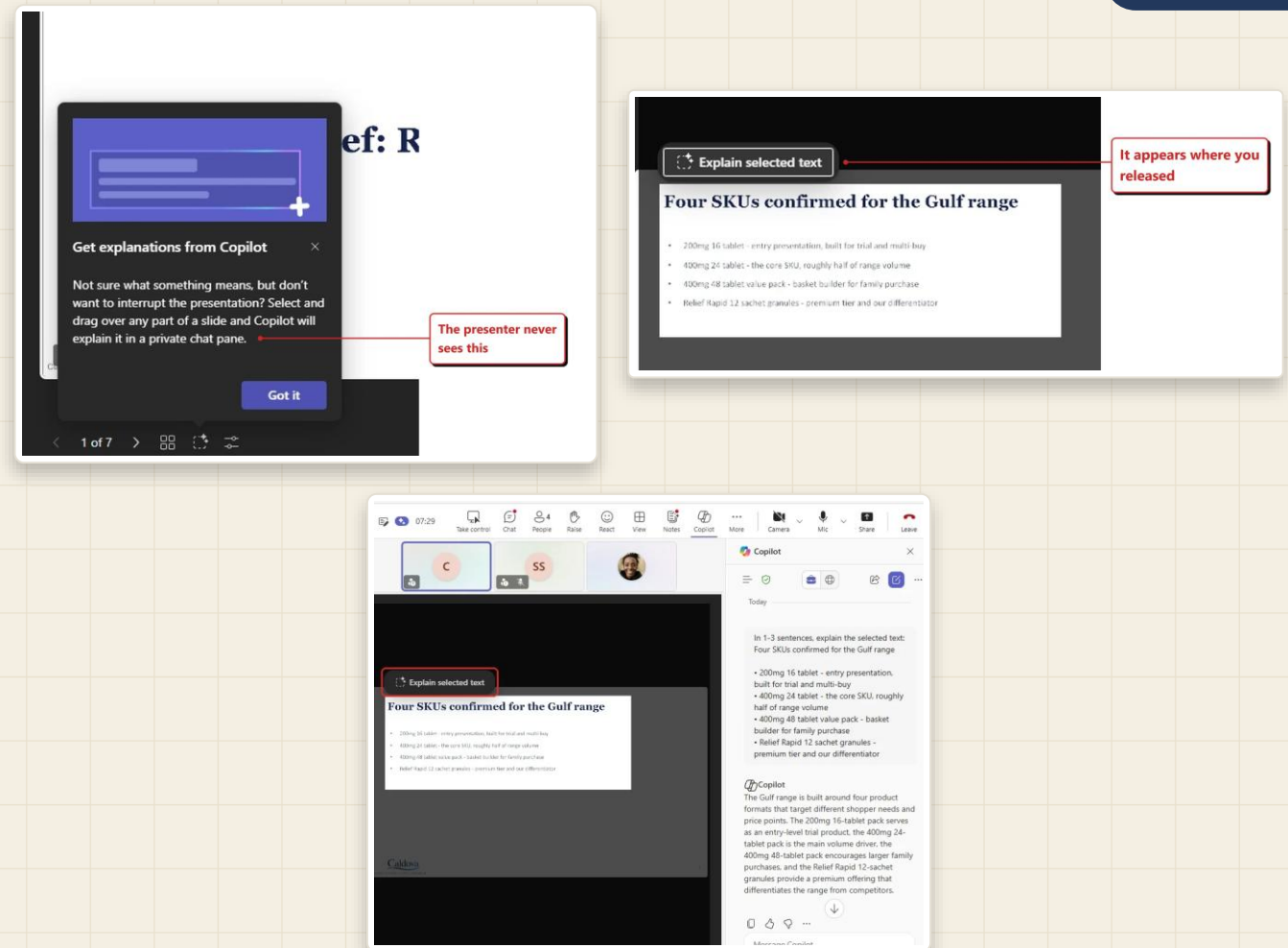
Copilot explains slides in PowerPoint Live

During a PowerPoint Live session, an attendee can select part of a slide and ask Copilot to explain it, without interrupting the presenter.

Why it matters

In any large presentation there is someone who lost the thread three slides ago and will not put their hand up. This gives them a way back in that costs the room nothing.

GA 25 August



PowerPoint Live introduces the feature itself. Note the phrase "private chat pane" — the presenter never sees this.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[AI at Work Roadmap 557256 →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Adobe Experience Manager brand assets

GA 11 August

Copilot in PowerPoint can use enterprise assets hosted in Adobe Experience Manager, so the images it reaches for are the approved ones rather than whatever it can generate.

Why it matters

Most large organisations already pay for a digital asset manager, and it tends to sit outside the tools where the work actually happens. Wiring it into the app where the deck is made is how those assets finally get used.

[AI at Work Roadmap 516038 →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

PowerPoint can use brand assets from Adobe Experience Manager

Copilot in PowerPoint (Web and Windows) · Generally available 11 August 2026 · illustrative, not a screenshot

WHAT CHANGED

Copilot in PowerPoint can use enterprise assets hosted in **Adobe Experience Manager** — so the images it reaches for are the **approved** ones.

BEFORE

Copilot reached for whatever it could **generate**.

NOW

It can reach the library your organisation has **already approved** — and already pays for.

WHY IT MATTERS Most large organisations already pay for a digital asset manager, and it tends to sit outside the tools where the work actually happens. Wiring it into the app where the deck is made is how those assets finally get used.

My own diagram of the before and after — not a screenshot. The change is which library Copilot reaches into.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

Create a presentation on the web

GA 11 August

Creating a presentation with Copilot works directly in the PowerPoint web app, not only the desktop client.

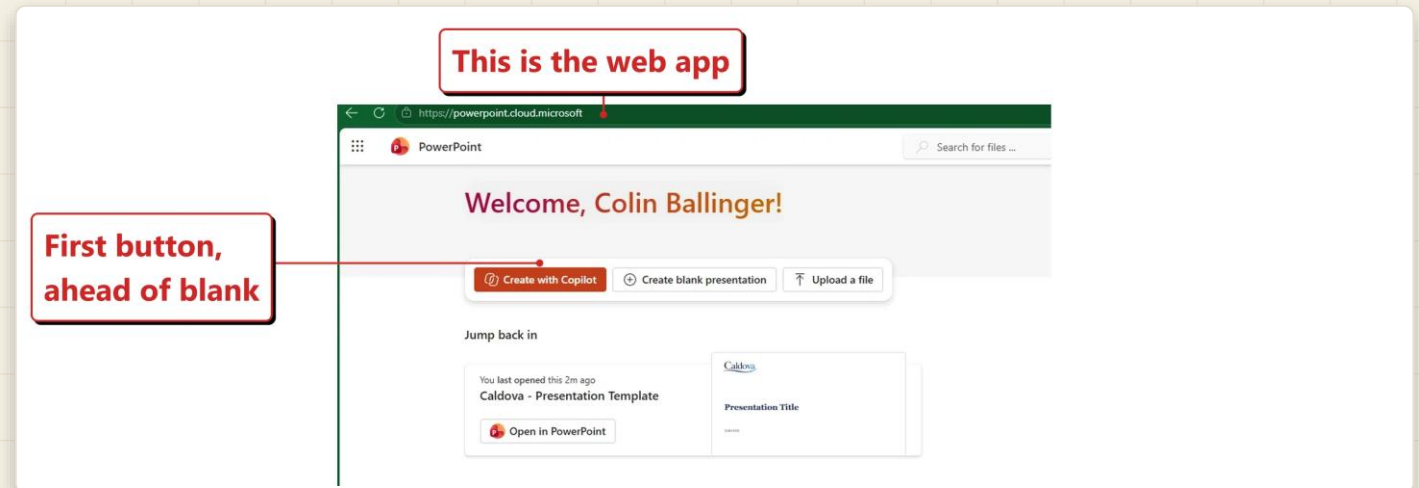
What I found on 14 September 2026. It is not tucked away either. On the PowerPoint start page on the web, **Create with Copilot** is the first button, sitting ahead of Create blank presentation.

Why it matters

Plenty of people are on the web app because of their device, their licence or their employer's policy. Features that only exist on desktop quietly split an organisation into two classes of user.

[AI at Work Roadmap 560537 →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)



The PowerPoint web app in my own tenant. Create with Copilot leads, rather than sitting in a menu.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

Presentations can use web sources

You can **reference web sources** when asking Copilot to create a presentation, so the deck can draw on material outside your tenant.

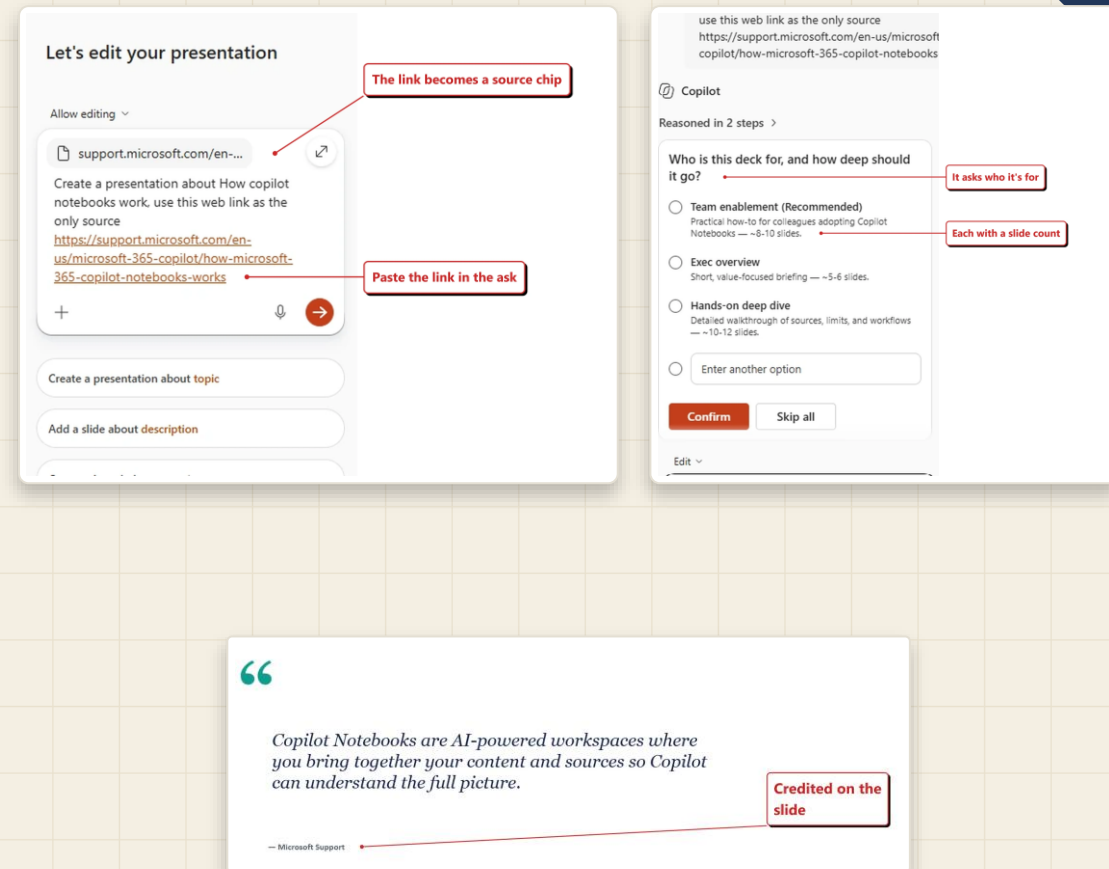
Why it matters

Useful, and worth a moment's thought. A deck grounded in the open web inherits whatever that page says, so this is a feature to brief people on rather than to enable and forget.

[AI at Work Roadmap 555898](#) →

[Read the full update on the blog](#) →

GA 11 August



My own tenant, 14 September 2026. The pasted link became an attached source, not just words in the prompt.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

Word can add hyperlinks for you

You can ask Copilot to **add a hyperlink**, and it inserts the link and formats the linked text.

Why it matters

Small, and genuinely useful. Linking is one of those jobs that breaks your concentration — not for long, but long enough to lose the sentence you were writing.

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Rolled out August

How to access Word Copilot

1. Open a document in Word and sign in with a Copilot-enabled account.
2. Select the **Copilot** button in the corner of the document. Copilot opens in the chat pane.
3. Type a prompt, choose a suggested action, or ask a question about the document.

For details, see [Welcome to Copilot in Word.](#)

It inserted the link



Reasoning completed in 3 steps >

I added a “How to access Word Copilot” section with three simple steps and a link to the official [Welcome to Copilot in Word](#) support page. microsoft

*Official Microsoft image from Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.*

Word reads pictures in your references

When you point Copilot in Word at a reference document, it now uses both the text and the visuals in that file — charts, diagrams and images, not just the words around them.

Why it matters

In a lot of documents the chart is the argument and the text is the caption. A model that only read the words was reading the less important half.

Rolled out August



explain the chart in the doc

Copilot

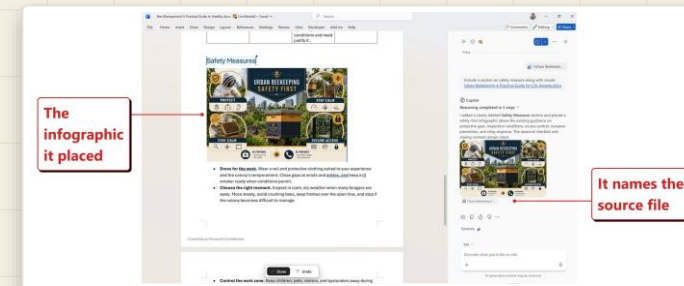
The chart appears at the end of the document, but I can only see it as an embedded image without readable chart labels, legends, or data values in the document view I received. Based on the surrounding document, it likely supports the **Allerveo additional commercial inventory RFP**, but I can't reliably explain the chart's message without the visible axis titles, legend, and data labels.

If you can zoom in, crop the chart, or paste the chart data, I can give you a clear explanation in a table like this:

What I'd explain	Why it matters
Main trend	Shows whether supplier performance, cost, capacity, or risk is improving or worsening
Highest/lowest points	Flags outliers or priority suppliers/issues
Comparison between series	Shows which option is stronger or weaker
Procurement implication	Connects the chart to the RFP decision or evaluation

Edit

It says it could not see the labels



My own tenant, 14 September 2026. Every label a reader needs is right there.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

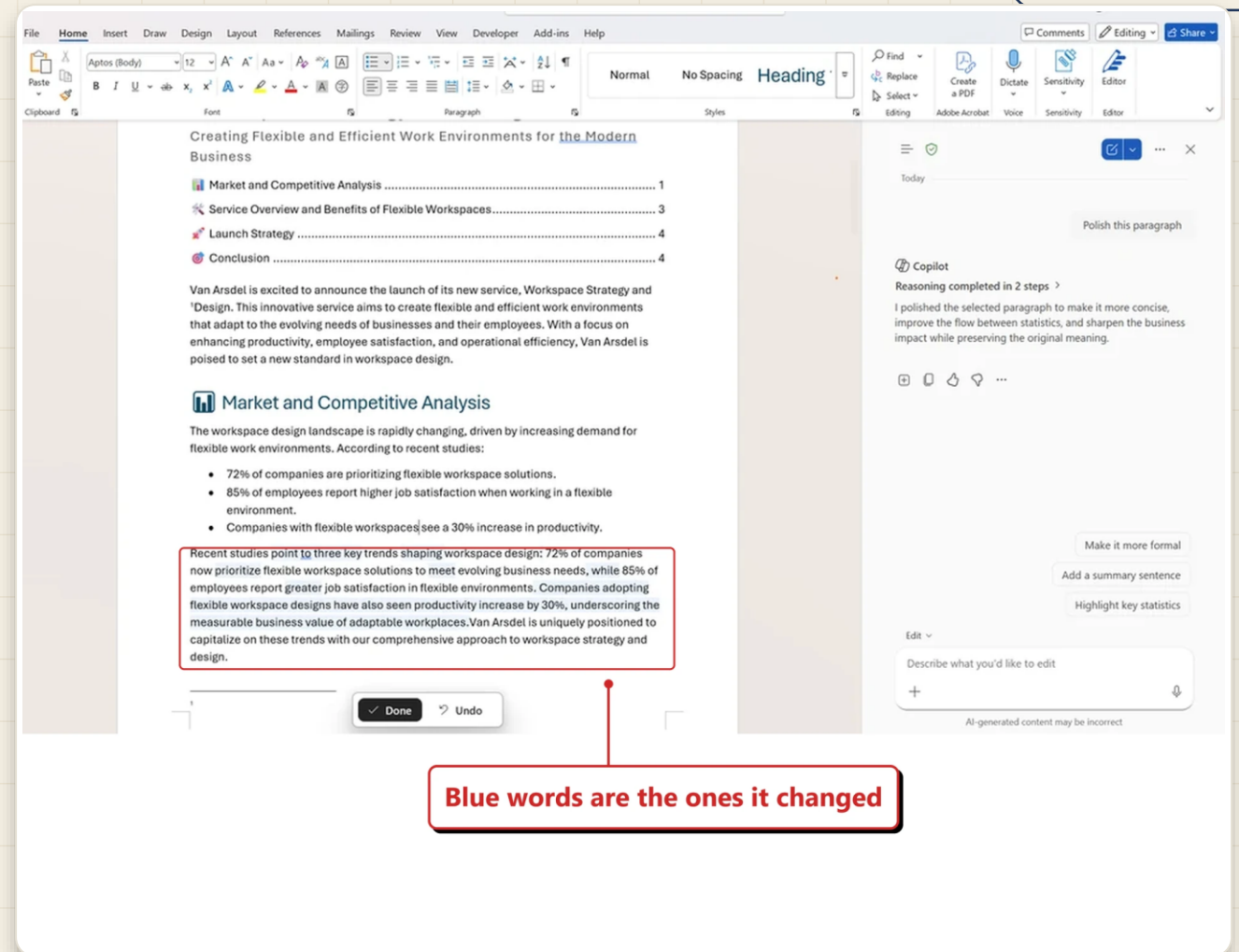
[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Word highlights what Copilot changed

Edit highlighting got **more granular**. Instead of marking a whole paragraph as changed, Word highlights the specific words Copilot touched.

Why it matters

This is a trust feature dressed as a formatting one. If reviewing an AI edit means re-reading the whole paragraph to find what moved, most people stop reviewing. Showing the actual diff is what makes checking the work realistic.



Blue words are the ones it changed

Official Microsoft image from Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Talk to Word during Read Aloud

GA 25 August

Read Aloud gained **voice questions and answers**. You can interrupt the reading to ask about what you just heard, by voice, and carry on.

Why it matters

Read Aloud is an accessibility feature that a lot of people use simply because they are walking, driving or tired. Being able to ask a question without stopping to type keeps the document usable in those moments.

You can talk to Word during Read Aloud

Copilot in Word · Generally available 25 August 2026 · illustrative, not a screenshot

WHAT WAS ADDED

Read Aloud gained **voice questions and answers**. Interrupt the reading, ask about what you just heard, and carry on.

WHY IT MATTERS

Read Aloud is an accessibility feature a lot of people use simply because they are **walking, driving or tired**. Asking a question without stopping to type keeps the document usable in those moments.

WHAT I FOUND, 14 SEPTEMBER 2026

I went looking for this in my own tenant and **could not find it**.

MOST LIKELY EXPLANATION The ordinary one — a **staged rollout** that has not reached my tenant yet, or has reached only some users inside it. I am recording that rather than guessing, and I will look again for the next issue.

My own diagram of what was added against what I could actually find — not a screenshot.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[AI at Work Roadmap 523205 →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Claude Sonnet 5 in Word's model menu

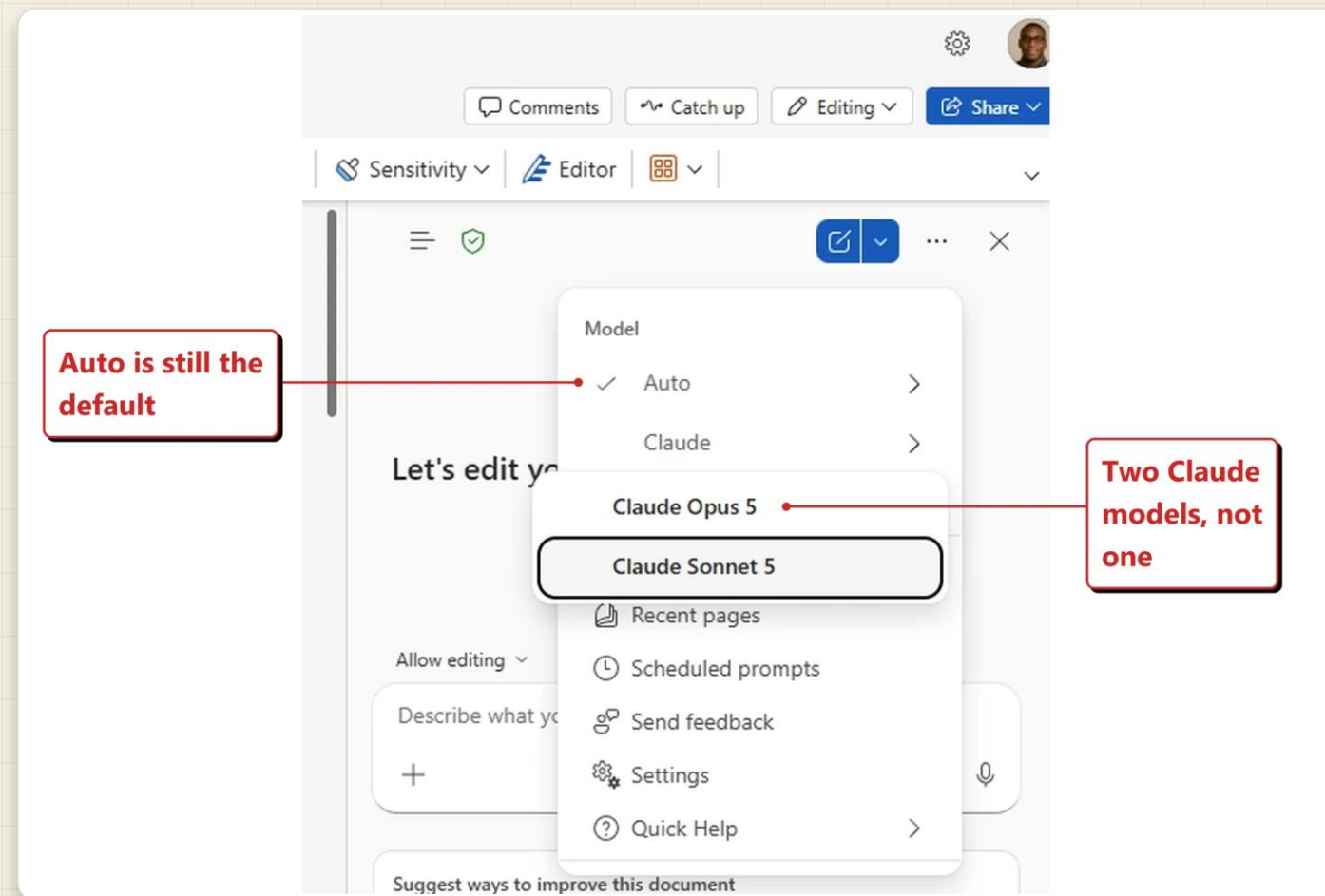
GA 25 August

Word's model menu on the web can be set to **Claude Sonnet 5**. The August issue covered Anthropic model choice arriving in Word in general terms; this is the specific model showing up in the list.

Anthropic models need admin-enabled Anthropic access, so the menu only offers what your tenant allows.

Why it matters

Model choice inside the app is becoming normal rather than notable. The thing worth tracking is not which model was added, but that the list changes often enough that a written standard about "which model we use" goes stale fast.



*My own tenant, 14 September 2026. Two Claude models, nested under a submenu, with Auto still the default.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.*

[Microsoft 365 Copilot release notes →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Excel can use Python when editing

GA 25 August

Copilot in Excel can **use Python** as part of an edit, rather than being limited to formulas and built-in functions.

What I found on 14 September 2026. I went looking for Python and could not make it appear.

Why it matters

This is the quiet ceiling-raiser, though my own test does not demonstrate it.

- 15:43 local time: Added the standard-deviation outlier audit in **Risk Chart!A18:F23**.
 - Added mean, sample standard deviation, z-score, and $\pm 3\sigma$ outlier formulas.
 - Formatted the audit table; all four results are "No".

Mean, z-score, outliers

```
=COUNTIF('01-sales-accounts'!$E$2:$E$9,"*Risk:
"&A4&"*")
=STDEV.S($B$4:$B$7)
=IF(ABS(E20)>3,"Yes","No")
```

All in Excel formulas,
no Python

*My own tenant, 14 September 2026. A statistics question, answered entirely in formulas.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.*

[Microsoft 365 Copilot release notes →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Excel explains what changed, and who

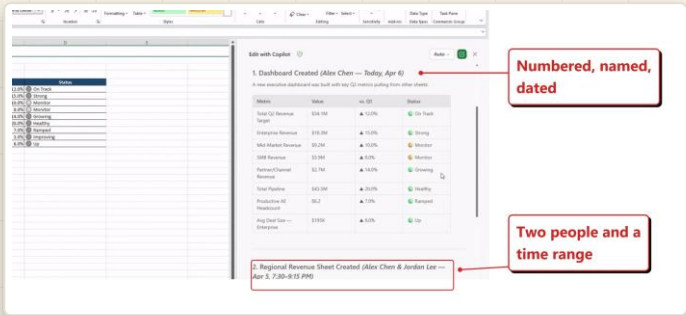
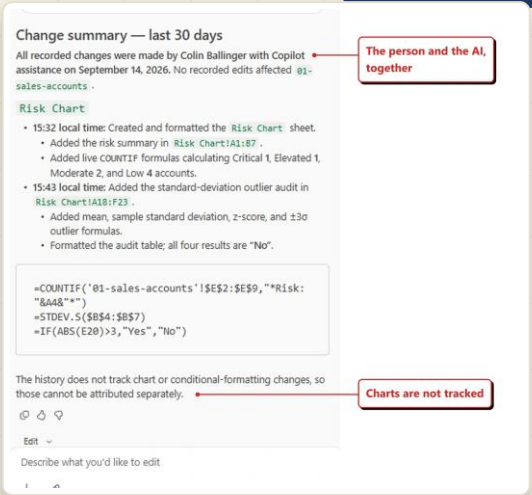
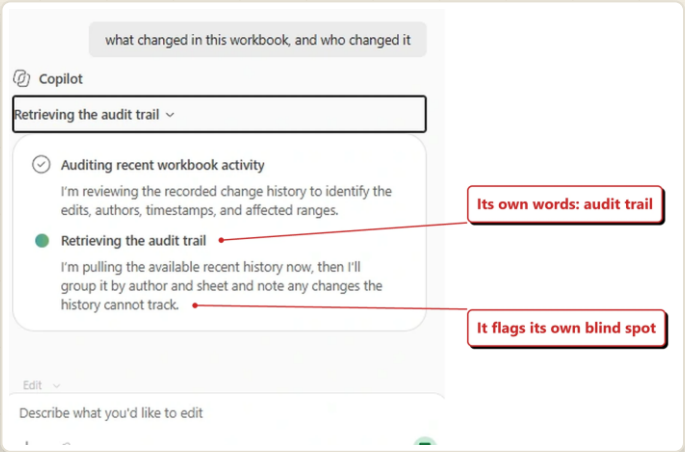
A **change history skill** lets Copilot summarise what changed in a workbook, identify who edited what, and distinguish edits made by a person from edits made by AI.

That last distinction is new, and it is the one that will matter in a year.

Why it matters

Shared workbooks accumulate changes that nobody can explain by Friday. Being able to ask "what happened to this sheet" — and get an answer that separates human edits from AI edits — is the beginning of an audit trail for AI-assisted work.

Rolled out August



Copilot describing the job before doing it — including that it will flag what the history cannot see.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

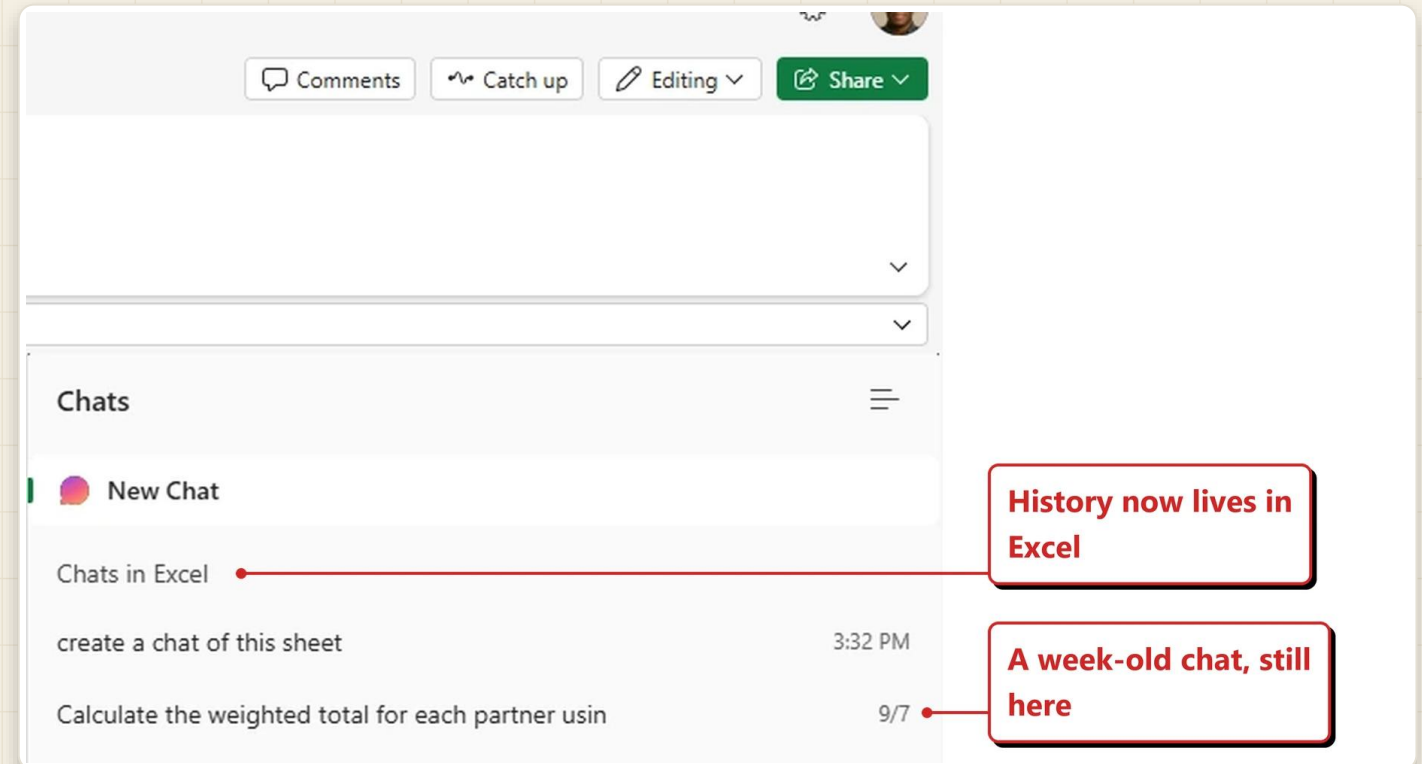
Excel keeps your Copilot chat history

Rolled out August

Past Copilot conversations are **preserved in Excel**, reachable from a menu icon in the upper left and sorted by recency.

Why it matters

Word got this in August, Excel gets it now. Losing the conversation meant losing the reasoning behind a change, which made people redo work they had already done once.



*My own tenant, 14 September 2026. A week-old conversation still sitting in the list.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.*

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Custom engine agents work in Outlook

Custom engine agents — the ones your organisation builds — are available directly in Outlook, rather than only in Copilot Chat.

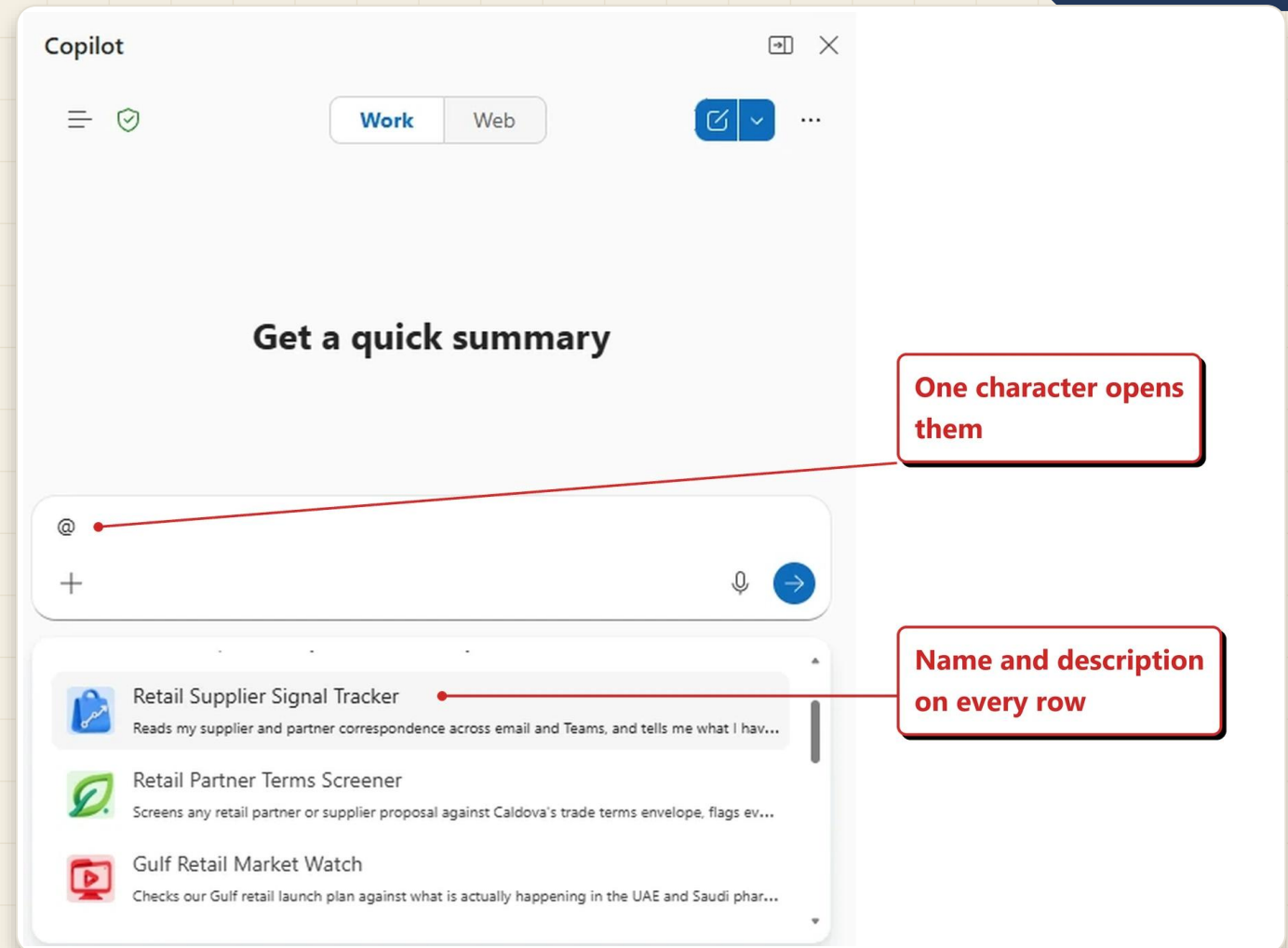
Why it matters

An agent that lives somewhere other than where the work happens gets used twice and forgotten. Email is where a lot of people spend their day, so putting the agent in the inbox is the difference between built and used.

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Rolled out August



One character opens them

Name and description on every row

My own tenant, 14 September 2026. One character, and the organisation's agents are in the inbox. Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

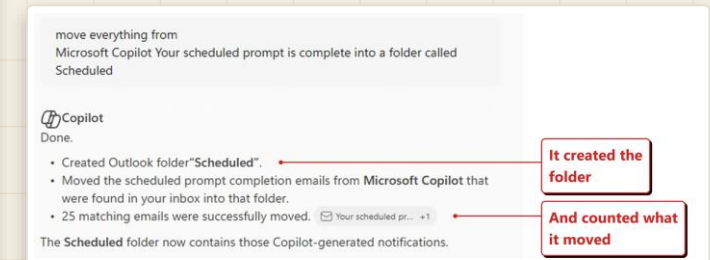
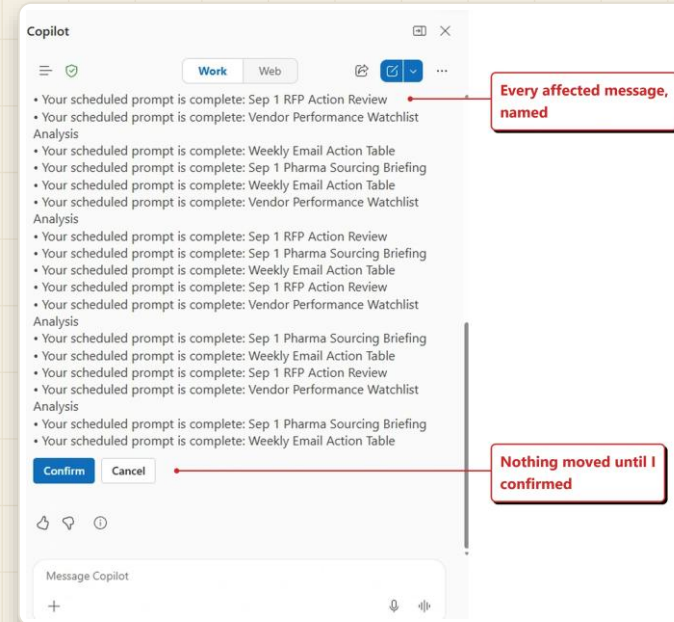
Plain-English instructions in Outlook

Rolled out August

Copilot can organise messages, apply categories and manage calendar entries from a plain-language instruction, instead of you clicking through the rules interface.

Why it matters

Outlook rules are powerful, and in my experience they are one of the most under-used things in the product, because the interface asks you to think like a database. Describing what you want in a sentence is a much lower bar.



*My own tenant, 14 September 2026. Every affected message named, before anything moved.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.*

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Scheduling reached classic Outlook

Scheduling through Copilot chat is available in **classic Outlook for Windows**, not only the new client.

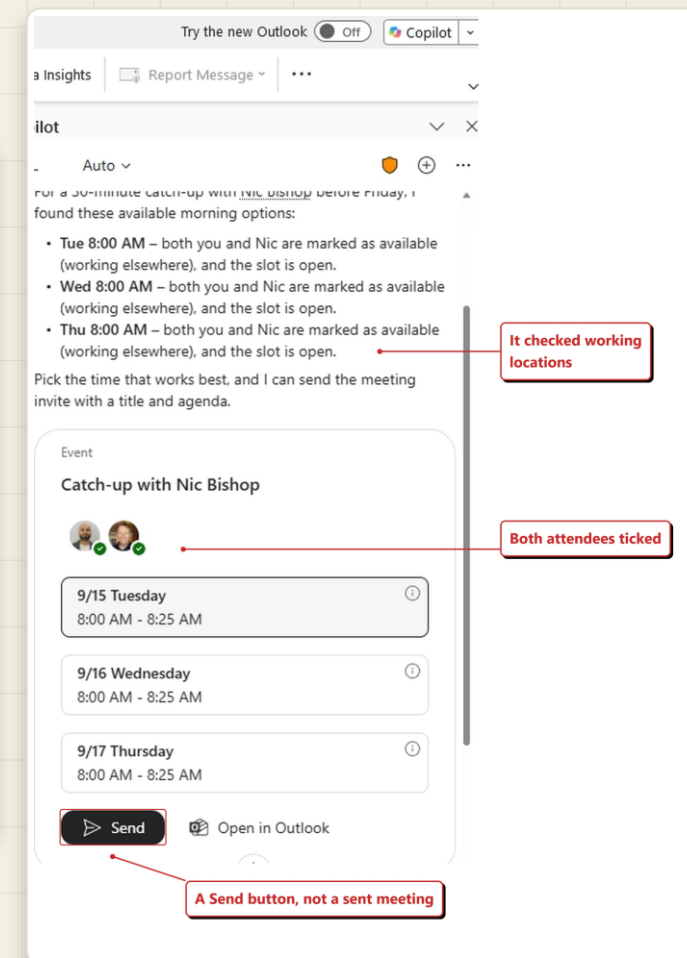
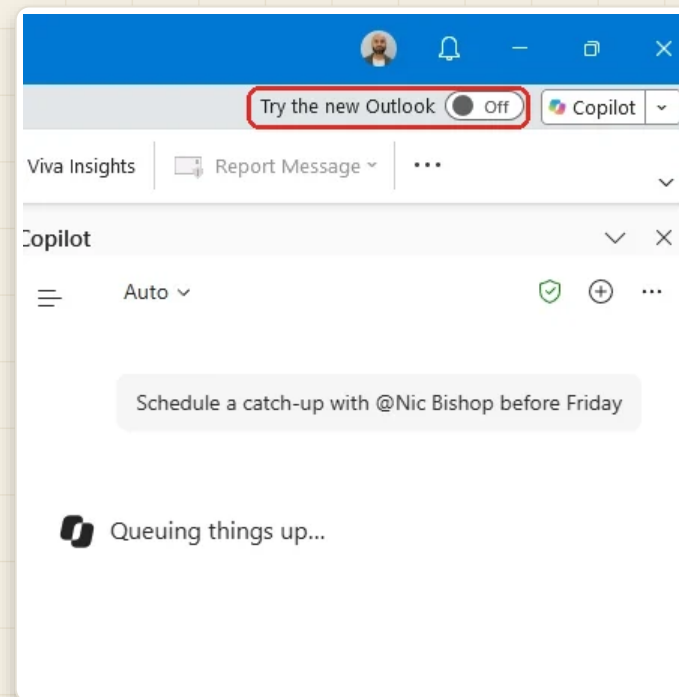
Why it matters

A lot of large organisations are still on classic Outlook and will be for a while. Every feature that crosses over is one fewer reason for those users to feel like they are on the wrong side of a migration.

[AI at Work Roadmap 542185 →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

GA 25 August



My own tenant, 14 September 2026. The "Try the new Outlook — Off" toggle is the proof this is the classic client.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

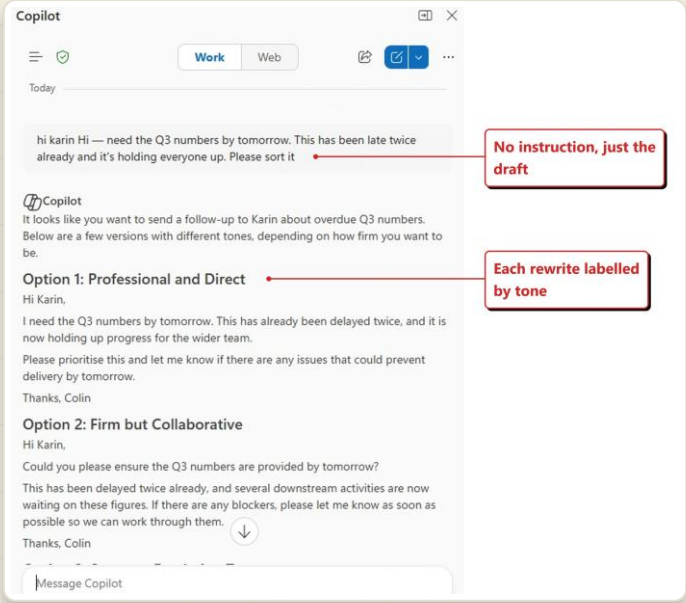
Outlook coaches your writing as you draft

GA 11 August

Copilot offers **coaching feedback in chat** while you draft, edit and format an email — tone, clarity and structure, as you write rather than after you send.

Why it matters

Coaching existed before as a thing you asked for once the email was written, which is exactly when nobody wants to hear it. Moving it into the drafting flow makes it advice rather than criticism.



Writing Improvements	
Area	Improvement
Tone	Made the message firm and professional rather than sounding frustrated.
Clarity	Specified the impact of the delay on the wider team and downstream activities.
Action	Included a clear request for delivery and, where appropriate, confirmation of timing or blockers.
Professionalism	Maintained accountability while avoiding language that could be perceived as confrontational.

My own tenant, 14 September 2026. Three tones from a draft, with no instruction attached to it.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

Meeting prep reached classic Outlook

Prepare for meetings — the summary of relevant files, emails and context ahead of a meeting — is available in classic Outlook for Windows.

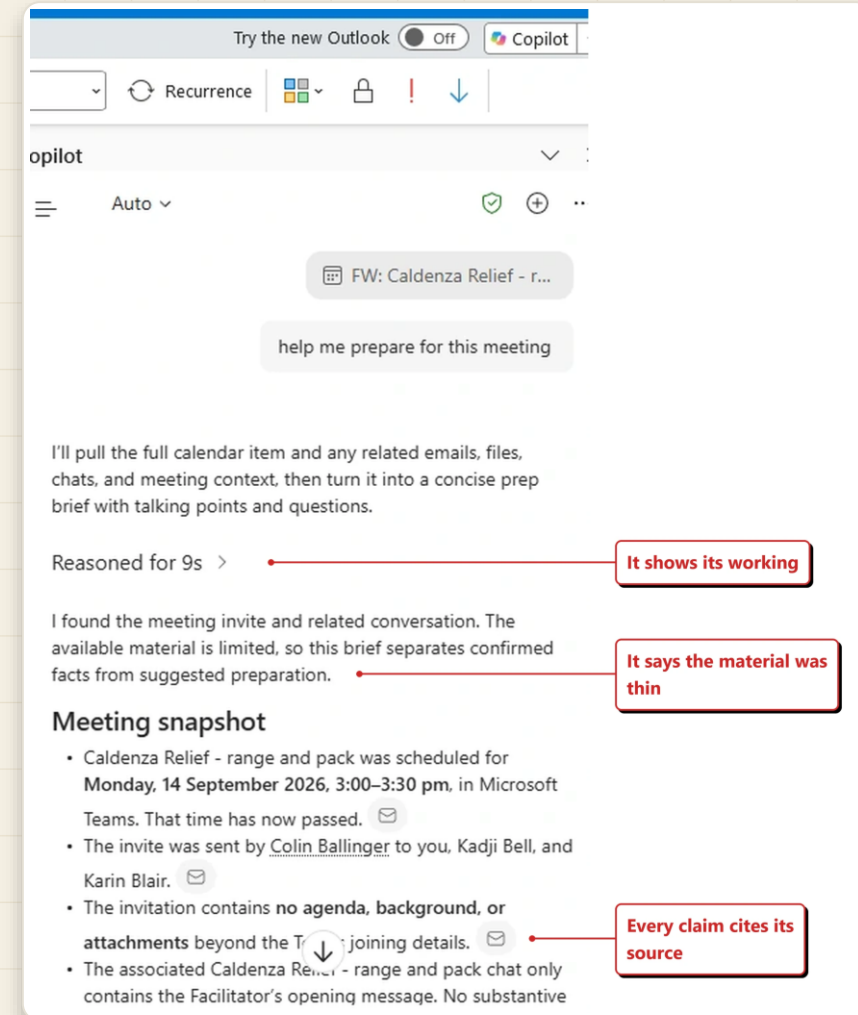
Why it matters

The five minutes before a meeting is when preparation actually happens. Having the material gathered in the client where the invite already lives removes the step where you go looking and run out of time.

[AI at Work Roadmap 542186 →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

GA 11 August



*My own tenant, 14 September 2026. A prep brief that admits there was very little to prepare from.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.*

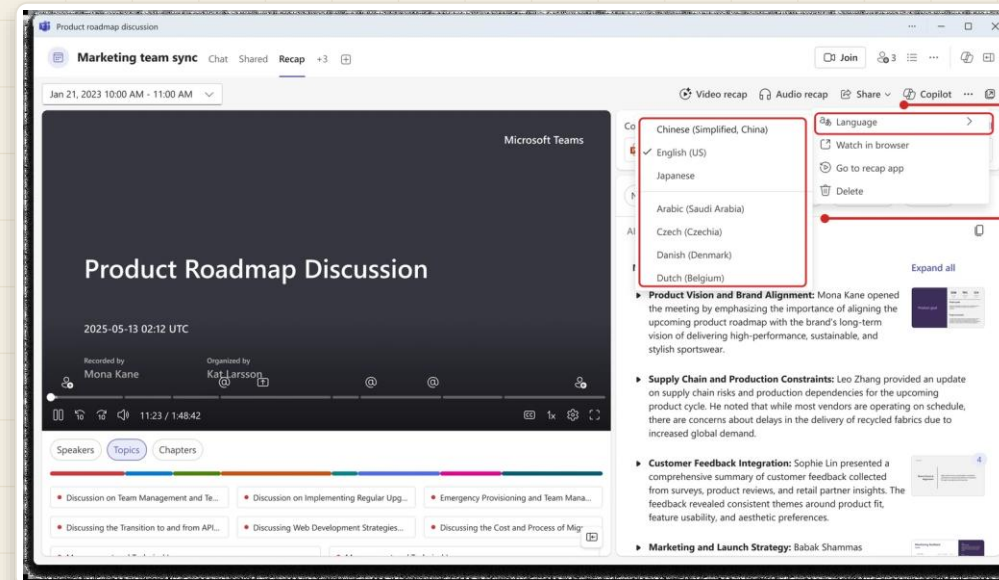
Translate a meeting recap afterwards

Rolled out August

You can change the language of a meeting recap after it has been generated, using a translation button on the recap itself.

Why it matters

Recaps get forwarded to people who were not in the room, and often not in the same country. Translating after the fact means the recap does not have to be generated correctly the first time for someone else to use it.



A Language menu on the recap

And a list to pick from

Official Microsoft image from Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

The Planner Agent writes a status report

The Planner Agent can produce a **status report** covering progress, risks, overall status and next steps, with the tone and detail adjusted for the audience you name.

Availability: Microsoft Frontier Program.

Why it matters

Status reporting is the tax on project work — the information already exists in the plan, and someone rewrites it weekly for a different audience. This is a genuinely good fit for a model, because it is transformation rather than invention.

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Frontier · Aug

Create a status report for this plan for the last 14 days. Include a status overview, executive summary, risks and blockers, achievements, progress, upcoming commitments, and key milestones. Please do in depth analysis and insights for each section.

The prompt named the sections

💜 Planner Agent

Frontier preview · This status report is generated by an experimental capability available through the Frontier early access program.

Frontier preview, and it says so

Status report for Project Aurora

Date of report: July 28, 2026 | Reporting period: July 14, 2026 – July 28, 2026

Overall status

● At risk · 23% overdue (44 tasks)

A verdict with numbers behind it

*Official Microsoft image from Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.*

Create and query Planner tasks in Chat

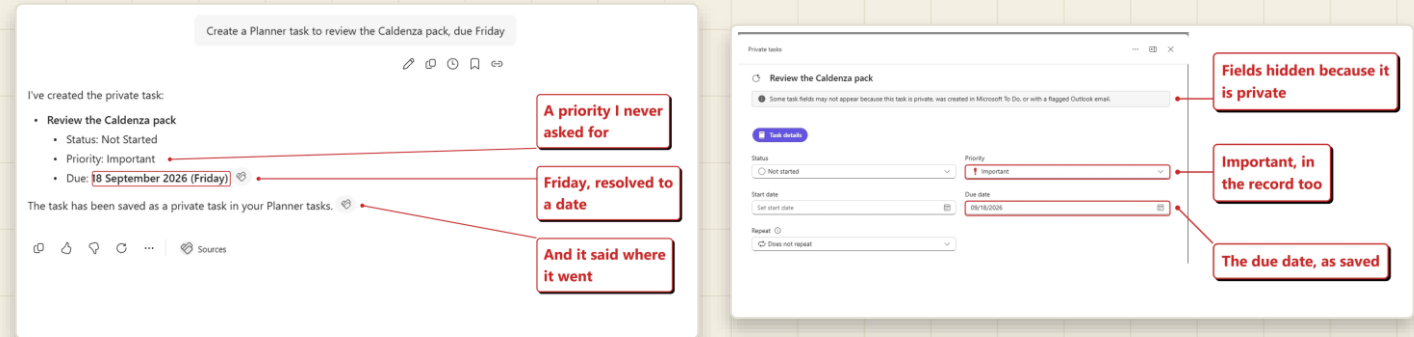
Copilot can create Planner tasks and answer questions about them without you opening Planner.

What I found on 14 September 2026. I asked for it the way you would say it out loud: *"Create a Planner task to review the Caldenza pack, due Friday."*

Why it matters

Tasks get lost in the gap between where they are agreed and where they are tracked. Closing that gap — capture the task in the conversation where it came up — is worth more than any feature inside the planning tool itself.

Rolling out September



My own tenant, 14 September 2026. "Friday" resolved to a date, and shown to me.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Planner Agent works in basic plans

The Planner Agent is available in **group-based basic plans**, widening it beyond the premium plan types.

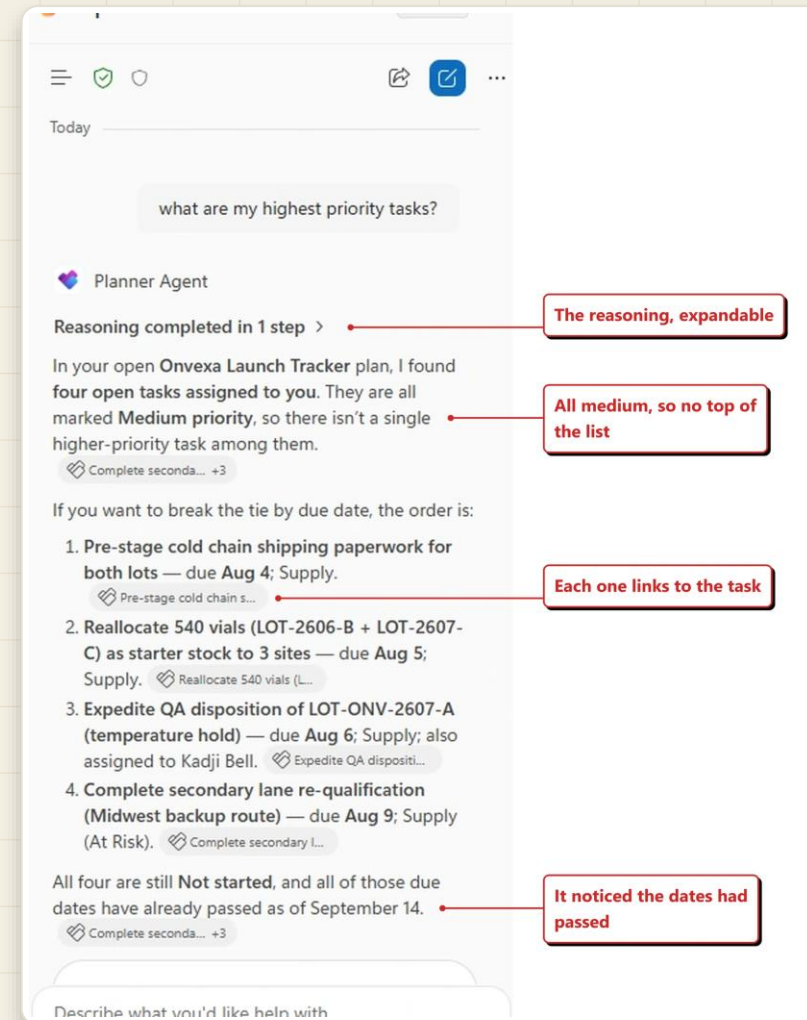
Why it matters

Most teams live in basic plans. A feature limited to premium project plans reaches the project managers, not the people doing the work.

[AI at Work Roadmap 511820](#) →

[Read the full update on the blog](#) →

GA 11 August



*My own tenant, 14 September 2026. The Planner Agent answering a question it could have faked.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.*

Add Teams meetings to a Notebook

Teams meetings can be added as a source in a Copilot Notebook, alongside the files, pages, links and Outlook emails already supported.

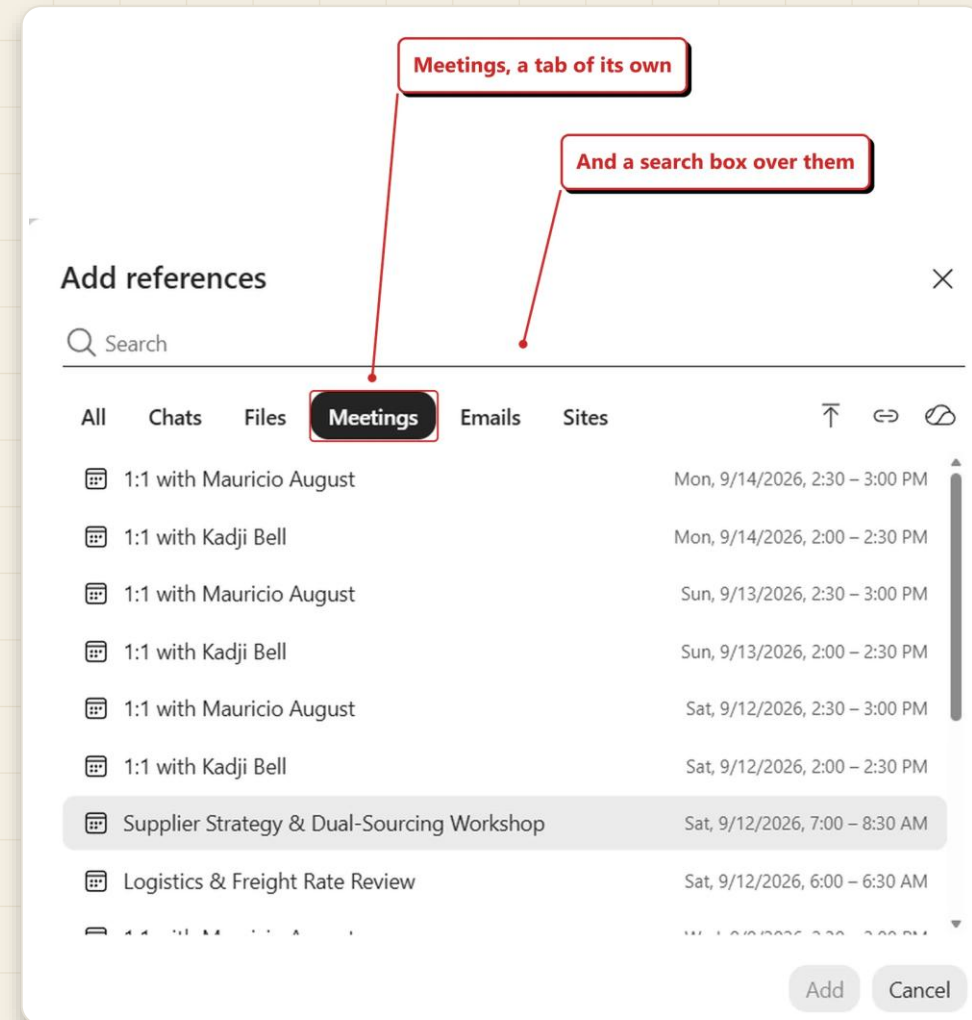
Why it matters

Notebooks work best when everything about a piece of work sits in one place. Meetings were the obvious missing input — most decisions get made in one and written down in none.

[AI at Work Roadmap 560706 →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

GA 25 August



*My own tenant, 14 September 2026. Meetings as a source type, not a workaround.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.*

OneDrive goes from files to finished work

From a chat in OneDrive you can find content, analyse files and data, and create summaries and drafts without leaving the file view.

Public preview now; Microsoft states worldwide December 2026.

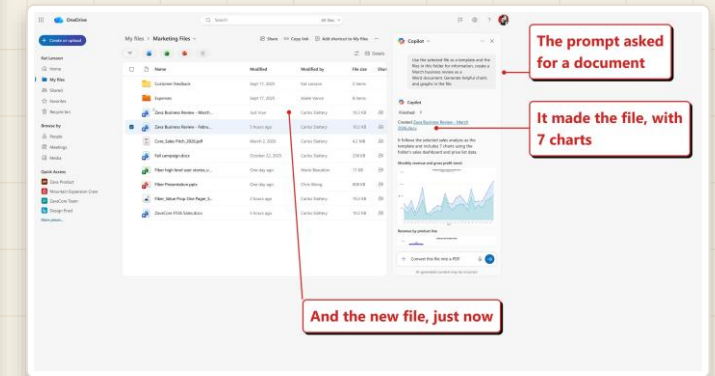
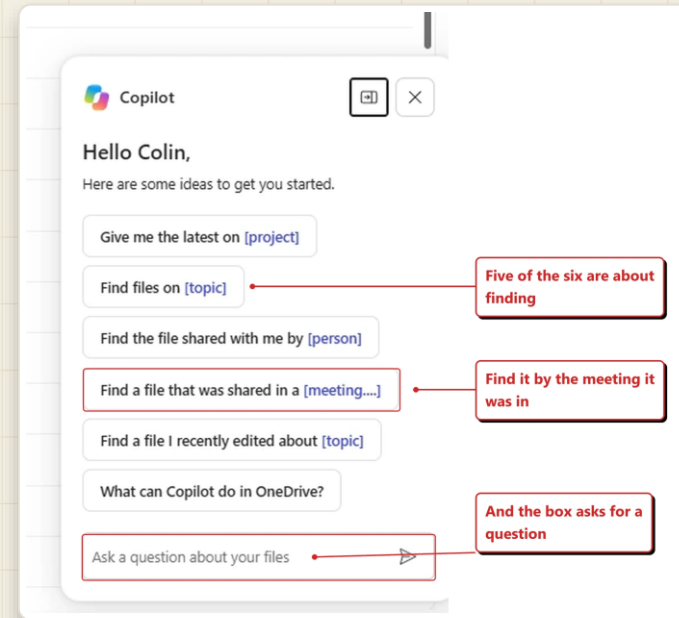
Why it matters

OneDrive is where the raw material sits, and until now it was a place you fetched things from. Turning it into a place where work gets done removes a round trip that most people make dozens of times a week.

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Public preview



*My own tenant, 14 September 2026. The front door to Copilot in OneDrive.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.*

Personal skills save to OneDrive

A personal skill in SharePoint is saved as a markdown file in your OneDrive, and works across all SharePoint sites rather than the one where you made it. The storage choice is worth noticing.

Public preview now; Microsoft states worldwide December 2026.

Why it matters

Skills stored as plain files can be read, edited, copied and shared like any other document. That is a much healthier foundation than a setting buried in a product, and it means a good skill can spread through a team by being sent to someone.

[Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Public preview

can you create a personal skill for creating a TODO tracker that looks at my meetings and emails and that I can update/query anytime. Tracker can be a word document

Copilot

Reasoning completed in 1 step >



create-skill

Copilot in SharePoint skill

A built-in skill makes your skill

I can. Please confirm these details:

- Name: personal-todo-tracker
- Does: builds/updates a Word-based TODO tracker from your meetings and emails
- Triggers: "create my TODO tracker", "update my TODO tracker", "what's on my TODO list?"
- Output: Word document with tasks, owners, dates, sources, and status
- Verifiable: yes — tasks should cite the meeting/email source

Reply yes to save it, or tell me what to change.



yes

Nothing saved until I said yes

Copilot

Reasoning completed in 1 step >



personal-todo-tracker

Your skill

And then it is yours

Creates, updates, and queries a Word-based personal TODO tracker grounded in the user's Microsoft 365 meetings and emails. Extracts action items with owners, due dates, sources, and status so the

*Official Microsoft image from Microsoft's August 2026 Copilot roundup.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.*

Mark SharePoint sites as authoritative

GA 11 August

Authoritative Sites lets an admin designate sites as official and trusted. Microsoft scopes the effect to **Copilot Search** experiences, which "*recognize its content as trusted*" — so read this as improving what Search surfaces rather than as a global reranking of every Copilot answer.

Why it matters

Most tenants contain several versions of the same policy, and the newest one is not always the one Copilot finds. Within Copilot Search, this is one low-cost mitigation for the most common complaint about Copilot answers — that it quoted something out of date. It raises trusted content; it does not guarantee a correct answer.

Admins can mark SharePoint sites as authoritative

SharePoint + Microsoft 365 Copilot · Admin · Generally available 11 August 2026 · illustrative, not a screenshot

THE GAP WORTH NAMING

It reads like a toggle sitting in a settings page. Microsoft's own page says: "In the current release, configure authoritative sites through **PowerShell and CSOM APIs.**"

LICENSING — BETTER THAN YOU WOULD EXPECT

Sits under SharePoint Advanced Management but needs **no paid add-on**. Unlocked when **one person** in the tenant holds a Copilot licence — and it need not be the administrator.

THE 72-HOUR WAIT

Up to **72 hours** before it shows up. Not a fix you apply the morning of a launch, and testing it is a two-sitting job.

THE REST OF THE SHAPE

100 sites per tenant · **whole sites only**, never personal sites or OneDrive · users see a "**From your organization**" label on results.

READ THE SCOPE CAREFULLY · Microsoft scopes the effect to **Copilot Search**. Read this as improving what Search surfaces rather than as a global reranking of every Copilot answer.

My own diagram of the whole shape of this one — not a screenshot. The 72-hour wait is the part to plan around.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[AI at Work Roadmap 561323 →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

SECTION 04

Copilot Studio

04

The GitHub Copilot harness is now GA

GA 3 August

After two months in preview, the capability got a name and a GA date: the GitHub Copilot harness in Copilot Studio.

Why it matters

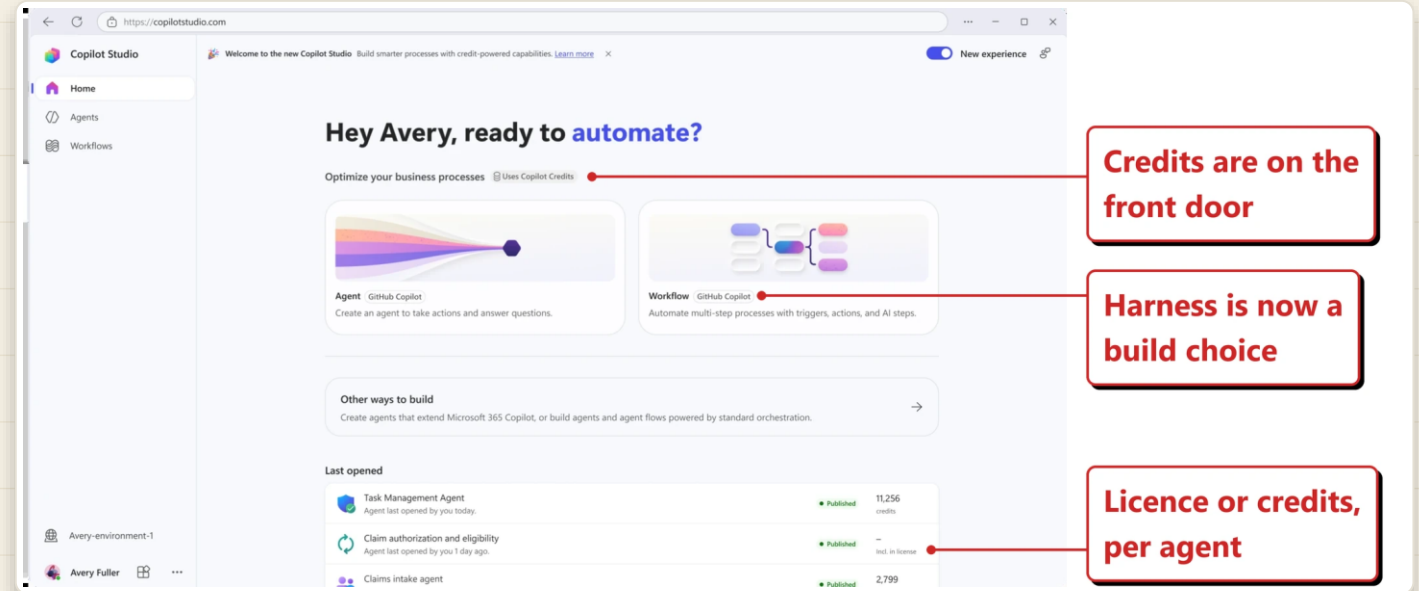
The phrase to hold onto is "long-horizon". Most agent platforms are good at a request and a response. The claim here is about work with many steps and no obvious right answer at each one — which is most real business process, and the reason so many agent pilots stall after the demo.

DO NEXT

Work out which harness your makers are building on.

[Introducing a new harness for Copilot Studio →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)



*Official Microsoft image from Microsoft's Copilot Studio announcement.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.*

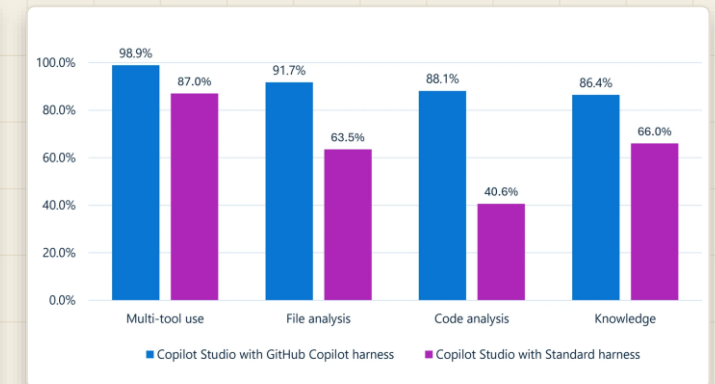
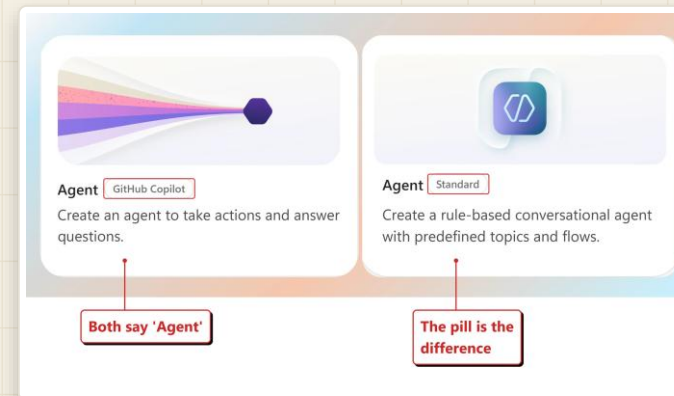
Three harnesses, and how to choose

September 2026

Adding a harness did not remove the old ones. Copilot Studio now supports three:

Why it matters

A vendor publishing a paper on how to choose between its own two options is a decent signal that the choice is consequential and not obvious. It is also the answer to "which one do we use?" — bounded and repeatable goes Standard, sprawling and judgement-heavy goes GitHub Copilot.



*Official Microsoft image from Microsoft's white paper on choosing a harness.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.*

[White paper: Choosing between the GitHub Co... →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Billed for all work, whatever the licence

This is the most important paragraph in the whole section, so here it is in Microsoft's words:

Applies regardless of Microsoft 365 Copilot licensing.

Why it matters

A lot of organisations have quietly assumed that buying Microsoft 365 Copilot licences covers agent usage. On this harness it does not, and the word "regardless" is doing real work in that sentence. If you are planning agent work for the rest of the financial year, this is the line that changes the model.

DO NEXT

Check who can spend credits — today, not this quarter.

[Introducing a new harness for Copilot Studio →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

GitHub Copilot harness in Copilot Studio

Light agent scenarios

Leverages a handful of knowledge sources for a light reasoning scenario like a summary, usually resulting in one short deliverable.

- Few sources
- Light reasoning
- 1 or fewer outputs

Prompt example

"Check [person's name] latest daily-ops email, verify the operations workbook has a Daily Logs table, and post a status summary to Ops-Support."

Est. Credits

100 – 300

Medium agent scenarios

References many sources over varying timeframes, uses structured reasoning, and produces multiple deliverables.

- Many sources
- Structured reasoning
- 2+ outputs

Prompt example

"Compile an end-of-day operations summary, total entries logged and any flagged items and post it to the Ops-Support channel."

Est. Credits

300 – 500

Heavy agent scenarios

Requires deep analysis and broad source aggregation over long time frames, generating many outputs.

- Broad aggregation
- Deep reasoning
- Many outputs

Prompt example

"Run a multi-year (2020–2025) water-compliance audit for Facility AQL: recompute daily withdrawal, flag every exceedance of the 150,000 GPD limit, correlate against NPDES permit conditions and pH/turbidity logs, then write a full audit report and distribute it via SharePoint, Teams, and email." (shorthand)

Est. Credits

> 500

Official Microsoft image from Microsoft Learn.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

Credits are spent while makers build

The part that is easiest to miss — and Microsoft has now put it beyond doubt. The billing overview says it in a heading: *"Billing starts when you start building: Unlike the standard harness, which starts billing after...*

Credits are consumed during building, previewing and evaluating — not only in production.

Why it matters

Every consumption control most organisations have designed so far assumes spending starts at go-live. Here it starts during the build. A pilot that never ships anything can still spend the budget — which is an odd sentence to write, and exactly why the next four sections exist.

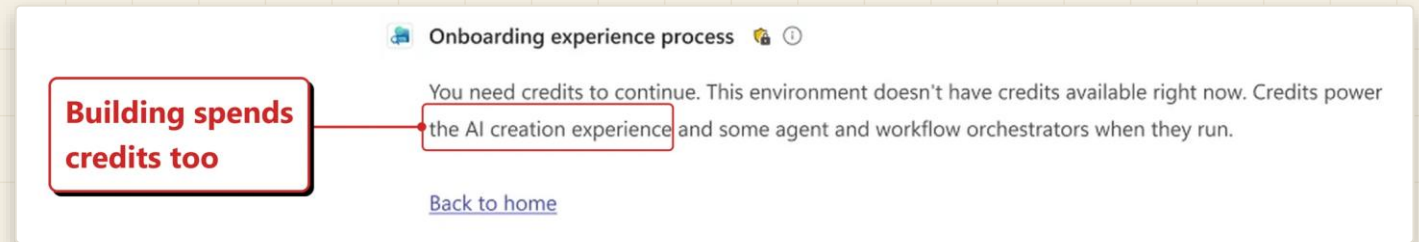
DO NEXT

Assume experimentation costs money, and budget for it.

[Copilot Credits billing overview →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

GA August



Official Microsoft image from Microsoft Learn.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

isCLIAgent tells you which agents are new

Available now

Before you can control anything you have to find it. The quickest route is now documented on Learn: the Power Platform admin center has a **Harness** column in the agent inventory (**Manage** > **Copilot Studio**), and filtering it to **GitHub Copilot** gives you the list. The column reads GitHub Copilot, Standard or Copilot Chat, and Learn notes it is a user-interface column only.

Why it matters

This is the difference between a governance policy and a governance process. "We should keep an eye on harness agents" is a wish; a query that returns every one of them with its owner and environment is something you can actually run monthly.

The property that finds harness agents

Admins · Power CAT · Available now · illustrative, not a screenshot

BEFORE YOU CAN CONTROL IT, YOU HAVE TO FIND IT

The **isCLIAgent** property identifies agents using the GitHub Copilot harness.

WHERE TO QUERY IT

The Power Platform Inventory API, against the **microsoft.copilotstudio/agents** resource type — returning each agent with its environment and owner.

SMALL ESTATE

The inventory view in the Power Platform admin center is enough.

AT SCALE

Power CAT points at Azure Resource Graph or the Inventory API, so the review is repeatable.

POLICY VS PROCESS "We should keep an eye on harness agents" is a wish. A query that returns every one of them with its owner is something you can run monthly.

My own diagram of how to find harness agents — not a screenshot.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[Manage costs for agents powered by the GitHub... →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Four enforcement rules per environment

In the Power Platform admin center, under Licensing > Copilot Studio > Manage Copilot Credits, you select an environment, allocate pre-paid capacity, and decide what happens when it runs out. Power CAT frames it as four decisions:

Why it matters

Note that alerting and denying are separate switches. Plenty of organisations will want alerts on and deny off in production — being warned is better than an agent stopping mid-process — and exactly the reverse in a maker sandbox.

Available now

The screenshot shows the 'Manage capacity' interface for a tenant named 'LB - FRE (Sandbox-US)' with an 'Environment type: Sandbox'. It contains three main sections: 'Allocate capacity', 'Capacity overages', and 'Overage notification'. Red lines connect specific UI elements to callout boxes on the right: a line from the 'Copilot Credits' input field points to 'Allocation, not a rule'; a line from the 'Draw from the available capacity in my tenant' checkbox points to 'TenantPool'; a line from the 'Bill to my pay-as-you-go-billing plan' checkbox points to 'PayGo'; and a line from the 'Send notification when nearing capacity usage' checkbox points to 'Alert'.

← Manage capacity ×

LB - FRE (Sandbox-US)
Environment type: Sandbox

Allocate capacity
Select how much capacity to allocate from what's available in the tenant.

Copilot Credits
31.85 consumed / 0 allocated

0

232236.84000000003 available to be allocated

Capacity overages
Select how you'd like to manage when capacity reaches zero in this environment.

☐ Draw from the available capacity in my tenant

☐ Bill to my pay-as-you-go-billing plan

No eligible billing plans

+ New billing plan

Overage notification

☐ Send notification when nearing capacity usage

Enter percent value

Percent value can only be between 50-100%.

Allocation, not a rule

TenantPool

PayGo

Alert

Official Microsoft image from Power CAT's 'Adopting the GitHub Copilot Harness: Cost Control and Governance'.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[Adopting the GitHub Copilot Harness: Cost C... →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

The credit setting is broader than it looks

Available now

This one is a genuine trap, and Power CAT flags it directly. The tenant's add-on capacity assignment setting controls who may allocate credits. Their warning:

The setting grants tenant-wide reach, not per-environment scope.

Why it matters

The setting reads like it scopes an admin to their own environments. It does not. That is the kind of gap that is invisible until the month someone reallocates capacity they were never meant to reach — and it costs nothing to go and check how yours is set.

DO NEXT

Re-read the setting before you grant it to anyone.

[Adopting the GitHub Copilot Harness: Cost C... →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

The credit allocation setting is broader than it looks

Admins · Power CAT · Available now · illustrative, not a screenshot

POWER CAT'S WARNING, IN THEIR WORDS

"Allowing environment administrators to manage allocations doesn't restrict them to environments they administer; it gives them **allocation control across all environments in the tenant.**"

WHAT THE SETTING READS LIKE

An environment administrator can allocate credits **in the environments they administer.**

WHAT IT ACTUALLY GRANTS

Allocation control across **every environment in the tenant.**

A SECOND DRIFT RISK New environments can appear with tenant-pool draw already enabled, and an environment's configuration can drift from what was approved for it.

My own diagram of the scope trap — not a screenshot. The gap is between what the setting reads like and what it grants, and a picture of the setting cannot show that.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

Limits can be set on a single agent

Environment-level control is not always tight enough — one experimental agent can consume what an entire environment was allocated. Power CAT's process ends with applying agent-level limits where an individual agent needs a tighter boundary than its environment, alongside notifying the agent's owner what that boundary is and how to ask for more.

Why it matters

The "and tell the owner" half is the part that usually gets skipped, and it is what turns a limit from an outage into a guardrail. A maker who knows the ceiling and the process for raising it will work within it. One who discovers it by hitting it will just file a ticket.

DO NEXT

Set a per-agent limit on anything experimental.

[Adopting the GitHub Copilot Harness: Cost C... →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Available now

The screenshot shows the 'Zava Studios Makers Assistant' interface. At the top, it says 'Adjust usage limits and notification threshold for this agent running in environment: LB - Dev (Sandbox-UK) Pay-as-you-go'. The main section is titled 'Capacity limit' and includes the instruction 'Set the message limit for your agent.' Below this is a progress bar for 'Copilot Credits' showing '0 Copilot Credits currently used'. A text input field contains the value '25000'. To the right of this field is a red callout box that says 'Says 'message limit'' and 'but the field is credits'. Below the capacity limit section is the 'Notification and throttling thresholds' section. It has a sub-section 'Stop Usage' with a checkbox 'Turn off agent when consumption reaches 100%' and an information icon. A red callout box points to this checkbox saying 'The per-agent hard stop'. Below that is the 'Overage notification' section with a checked checkbox 'Send notification when nearing capacity usage' and a dropdown menu set to '80%'. A note below the dropdown says 'Percent value can only be between 50-100%'.

Official Microsoft image from Power CAT's 'Adopting the GitHub Copilot Harness: Cost Control and Governance'.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

A tenant-wide view of credit spend

Power CAT followed the governance post with one on building a tenant-wide view of Copilot Credit consumption, pulling the data through the Power Platform API into Dataverse and reporting on it.

Why it matters

Controls tell you what is allowed. This tells you what actually happened, and which agents and environments are responsible — which is the report you will be asked for the first time someone questions the bill.

[Where are your Copilot Credits going? →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Published 25 August

A tenant-wide view of where credits are going

Admins · Power CAT · Published 25 August 2026, updated 26 August · illustrative, not a screenshot

WHAT POWER CAT PUBLISHED

How to build a **tenant-wide view of Copilot Credit consumption** — and report on it.

1. PULL

The data comes through the **Power Platform API**.

2. LAND

It lands in **Dataverse**.

3. REPORT

Reporting runs on top of that, by agent and environment.

CONTROLS VS CONSUMPTION Controls tell you what is allowed. This tells you what actually happened — the report you will be asked for the first time someone questions the bill.

My own diagram of the flow Power CAT describes — not a screenshot. I have not built this report, so I am not showing you a different product's dashboard in its place.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

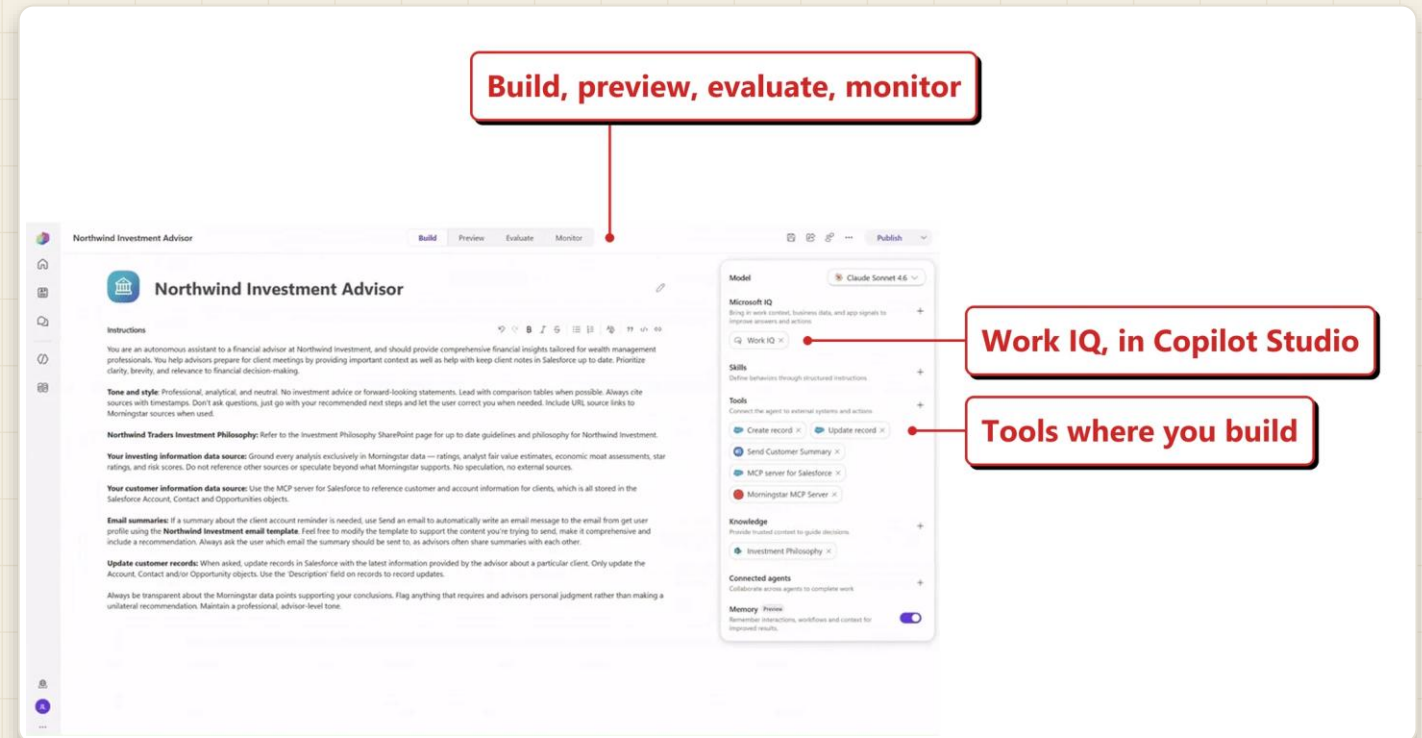
New designers for agents and workflows

August 2026

Alongside the harness, Microsoft shipped maker-side changes. The **agent designer** was reworked to put the most-used tools within reach while keeping full lifecycle management, and the **workflow designer** gives a visual canvas for understanding and editing workflows, including adding agent nodes and running workflow evaluations.

Why it matters

Evaluations on the canvas is the quiet one. Being able to run an eval where you built the workflow is what makes testing a normal part of building rather than a separate exercise nobody gets round to.



Official Microsoft image from Microsoft's Copilot Studio announcement.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[Introducing a new harness for Copilot Studio →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

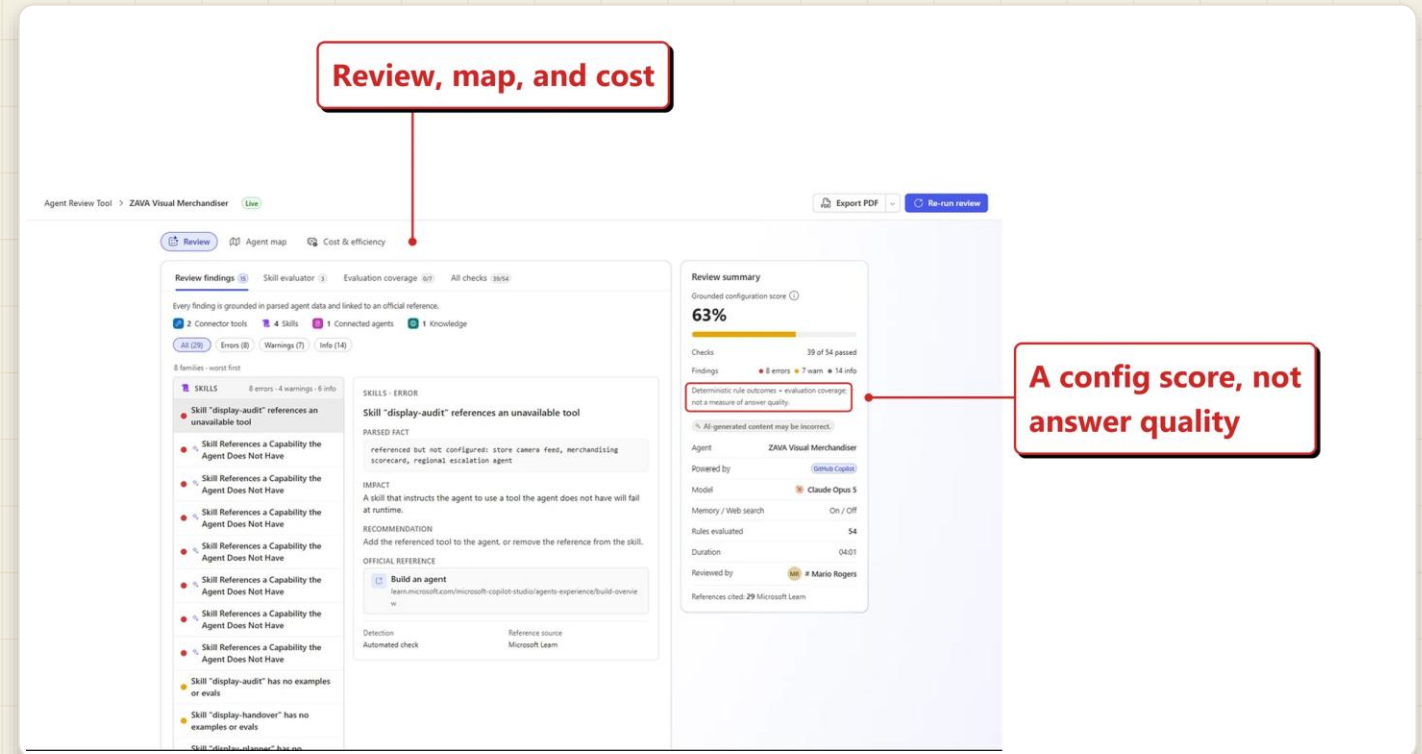
An Agent Review Tool before release

Public preview

Power CAT published guidance on using the **Agent Review Tool** to review Copilot Studio agents before they go out, including an agent map and a skill evaluator that produce grounded findings against the agent as built.

Why it matters

Agent review has mostly meant one person reading the instructions and hoping. A structured pass that maps what the agent can reach is a real step up — as long as nobody reads a clean report as a sign-off. It tells you the configuration looks sane, not that the agent behaves.



Official Microsoft image from Power CAT's 'Review before release: using Agent Review Tool'.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[Review before release: using Agent Review T... →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

SharePoint metadata filtering for agents

Published 1 September

Power CAT's September post covers filtering SharePoint content by metadata in Copilot Studio, and the subtitle is the interesting part: *"from topic logic to agent decisions"* — letting the agent decide which documents are relevant from metadata, instead of hand-building the routing in topics.

Why it matters

Anyone who has built a document-grounded agent has written the branching logic that says "if they asked about policy, look in this library." Pushing that to the agent removes the most brittle, least interesting part of the build — and the part that silently rots as the document estate changes.

SharePoint metadata filtering is harness-specific

Copilot Studio · Power CAT · Published 1 September 2026, updated 2 September · illustrative, not a screenshot

THE SUBTITLE IS THE INTERESTING PART

"From topic logic to agent decisions" — letting the agent decide which documents are relevant from metadata, instead of hand-building the routing in topics.

STANDARD HARNESS

There was **"no simple, configurable path"** from a user's intent to SharePoint metadata and then to the URLs of matching documents."

GITHUB COPILOT HARNESS

Agents on this harness **"can now bridge that gap."** If your agents are on Standard, this is not available to you in the same form.

CAUTION IF YOU GO DEEP The built-in metadata and knowledge-search tools are "implementation details, not public APIs" — names, parameters and behavior can change without notice.

My own diagram of the harness difference — not a screenshot. The point is what the Standard harness cannot do, and an absence does not photograph.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[SharePoint metadata filtering in Copilot St... →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Work IQ: used, licensed and controlled

Power CAT also published a piece on Work IQ, the layer that gives agents access to organisational context — mail, calendar, files, Teams messages and people — covering not just what it does but how it is licensed and how access is controlled.

Why it matters

Work IQ is what makes an agent useful and it is also what makes an agent risky, because the whole point is reaching real organisational content. A single piece that covers capability, licensing and control together is more useful than three that cover one each.

Published 24 August

Work IQ — how it is used, licensed and controlled

Power CAT · Published 24 August 2026 · illustrative, not a screenshot

WHAT POWER CAT PUBLISHED

One piece covering capability, licensing and control **together** — rather than three that each cover one.

CAPABILITY

The layer that gives agents access to organisational context: mail, calendar, files, Teams messages and people.

LICENSING

How Work IQ is licensed.

CONTROL

How access to that context is controlled.

WHY BOTH HALVES MATTER Work IQ is what makes an agent useful and what makes an agent risky, because the whole point is reaching real organisational content.

My own diagram of what the piece covers — not a screenshot. It summarises an article rather than a product screen.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[Work IQ: how it's used, licensed and contro... →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Dataverse as a native knowledge source

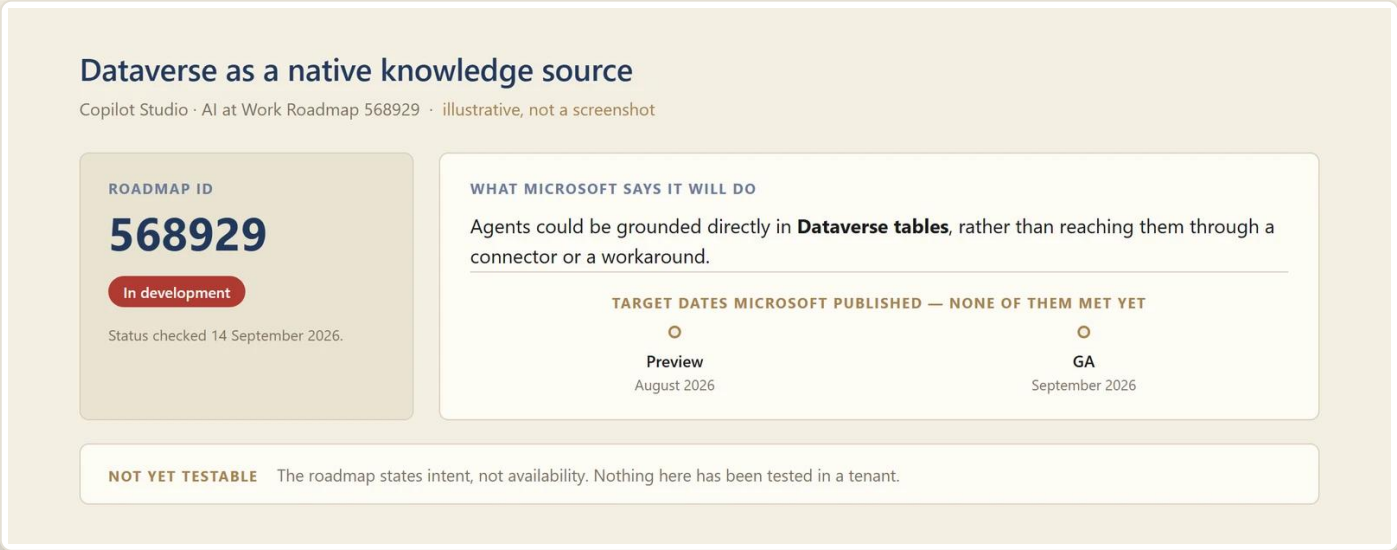
In development

Microsoft plans to make Dataverse a first-class knowledge source, so agents could be grounded directly in Dataverse tables rather than through a...

Roadmap plan — In development on 14 September 2026. Microsoft's stated timing: preview August 2026, GA September 2026.

Why it matters

Dataverse is where the structured business data already sits for most Power Platform customers. Native grounding is the difference between an agent that talks about your processes and one that answers from your actual records.



My own diagram of the roadmap entry — not a screenshot. The feature is still in development, so there is no product screen to photograph, and the dates shown are targets Microsoft published rather than milestones it has met.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

Azure SQL as a knowledge source

In development

The same idea pointed at Azure SQL. Worth a note on the name: Microsoft's roadmap entry is titled "SQL server Support in Microsoft Copilot Studio"...

Roadmap plan — In development on 14 September 2026. Microsoft's stated timing: preview August 2026, GA September 2026.

Why it matters

This is the one that reaches beyond the Microsoft 365 estate. A lot of line-of-business data lives in SQL, and grounding agents there through a standard knowledge source rather than a bespoke integration layer would remove a substantial prerequisite from those projects.

Azure SQL as a knowledge source

Copilot Studio · AI at Work Roadmap 568930 · illustrative, not a screenshot

ROADMAP ID

568930

In development

Status checked 14 September 2026.

WHAT MICROSOFT SAYS IT WILL DO

Agents could be grounded in data **stored in Azure SQL**. Microsoft titles the entry "SQL server Support", but the description underneath refers to the Azure SQL Knowledge Source throughout.

TARGET DATES MICROSOFT PUBLISHED — NONE OF THEM MET YET



Preview
August 2026



GA
September 2026

NOT YET TESTABLE The roadmap states intent, not availability. The text does not support reading this as on-premises SQL Server.

My own diagram of the roadmap entry — not a screenshot. The feature is still in development, so there is no product screen to photograph, and the dates shown are targets Microsoft published rather than milestones it has met.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[AI at Work Roadmap 568930 →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

SharePoint lists as a knowledge source

Microsoft plans to let agents ground in structured SharePoint list data, as distinct from documents in libraries.

Roadmap plan — In development on 14 September 2026. Microsoft's stated timing: preview July 2026, GA September 2026.

Why it matters

Lists are the quiet workhorse of most SharePoint estates — registers, trackers, request queues. They are structured data that never made it to a database, and until now agents have been much better at reading the documents next to them than the lists themselves.

In development

SharePoint lists as a knowledge source

Copilot Studio · AI at Work Roadmap 566859 · illustrative, not a screenshot

ROADMAP ID

566859

In development

Status checked 14 September 2026.

WHAT MICROSOFT SAYS IT WILL DO

Agents could ground in **structured SharePoint list data**, as distinct from documents sitting in a library.

TARGET DATES MICROSOFT PUBLISHED — NONE OF THEM MET YET



Preview
July 2026



GA
September 2026

NOT YET TESTABLE The roadmap states intent, not availability. Nothing here has been tested in a tenant.

My own diagram of the roadmap entry — not a screenshot. The feature is still in development, so there is no product screen to photograph, and the dates shown are targets Microsoft published rather than milestones it has met.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[AI at Work Roadmap 566859 →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Invoking agents as workflow steps

In development

Microsoft plans an **agent node** that would let a workflow call an agent as a single step — reasoning over data, calling tools and returning a response inline.

Roadmap plan — In development on 14 September 2026. Microsoft's stated timing: preview April 2026, GA September 2026.

Why it matters

This is the join between deterministic automation and judgement. A workflow handles the steps that must happen the same way every time and hands the ambiguous one to an agent — which is a far more honest architecture than asking an agent to run the whole process.

Invoking agents as workflow steps

Copilot Studio · AI at Work Roadmap 562222 · illustrative, not a screenshot

ROADMAP ID

562222

In development

Status checked 14 September 2026.

WHAT MICROSOFT SAYS IT WILL DO

An **agent node** would let a workflow call an agent as a single step — reasoning over data, calling tools and returning a response inline.

TARGET DATES MICROSOFT PUBLISHED — NONE OF THEM MET YET



Preview
April 2026



GA
September 2026

NOT YET TESTABLE The roadmap states intent, not availability. This item appears twice under two different IDs with identical titles and dates; the lower one is linked.

My own diagram of the roadmap entry — not a screenshot. The feature is still in development, so there is no product screen to photograph, and the dates shown are targets Microsoft published rather than milestones it has met.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[AI at Work Roadmap 562222 →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Human approval for tool calls

Microsoft plans a per-tool, per-agent toggle that would pause the agent and raise an approval request before a tool call goes ahead.

Roadmap plan — In development on 14 September 2026. Microsoft's stated timing: GA September 2026.

Why it matters

Per-tool rather than per-agent is the right granularity, and it is what makes autonomy negotiable. An agent can read freely and still need a human before it sends, pays or deletes — which is usually the actual objection, not autonomy itself.

In development

Requiring human approval for tool calls

Governance · AI at Work Roadmap 570434 · illustrative, not a screenshot

ROADMAP ID

570434

In development

Status checked 14 September 2026.

WHAT MICROSOFT SAYS IT WILL DO

A **per-tool, per-agent toggle** would pause the agent and raise an approval request before a tool call goes ahead.

TARGET DATES MICROSOFT PUBLISHED — NONE OF THEM MET YET

○

GA

September 2026

NOT YET TESTABLE The roadmap states intent, not availability. Nothing here has been tested in a tenant.

My own diagram of the roadmap entry — not a screenshot. The feature is still in development, so there is no product screen to photograph, and the dates shown are targets Microsoft published rather than milestones it has met.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[AI at Work Roadmap 570434 →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Detecting credential oversharing

In development

Microsoft plans to block the sharing of agents and flows that rely on unsafe identities, rather than leaving the problem to be discovered afterwards.

Roadmap plan — In development on 14 September 2026. Microsoft's stated timing: preview July 2026, GA September 2026.

Why it matters

Oversharing in Copilot has mostly been discussed as a documents problem. This is the same failure through a different door — an agent shared with people who then inherit reach they were never granted directly.

Detecting credential oversharing

Admins · AI at Work Roadmap 566873 · illustrative, not a screenshot

ROADMAP ID

566873

In development

Status checked 14 September 2026.

WHAT MICROSOFT SAYS IT WILL DO

Sharing of agents and flows that rely on **unsafe identities** would be blocked up front, rather than discovered afterwards.

TARGET DATES MICROSOFT PUBLISHED — NONE OF THEM MET YET



Preview
July 2026



GA
September 2026

NOT YET TESTABLE The roadmap states intent, not availability. Nothing here has been tested in a tenant.

My own diagram of the roadmap entry — not a screenshot. The feature is still in development, so there is no product screen to photograph, and the dates shown are targets Microsoft published rather than milestones it has met.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[AI at Work Roadmap 566873 →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Maker-provided credentials, blocked

Microsoft plans to stop AI agents authenticating with credentials supplied by the maker who built them.

Roadmap plan — In development on 14 September 2026. Microsoft's stated timing: GA August 2026.

Why it matters

A maker's own credentials are the classic shortcut — it works immediately and quietly gives the agent everything that person can reach, then breaks when they change role or leave. Blocking it at platform level closes the shortcut rather than asking people not to take it.

In development

Blocking maker-provided credentials

Admins · AI at Work Roadmap 566997 · illustrative, not a screenshot

ROADMAP ID

566997

In development

Status checked 14 September 2026. The August target has passed with the entry still in development.

WHAT MICROSOFT SAYS IT WILL DO

AI agents would be stopped from authenticating with **credentials supplied by the maker** who built them.

TARGET DATES MICROSOFT PUBLISHED — NONE OF THEM MET YET

○

GA

August 2026

NOT YET TESTABLE The roadmap states intent, not availability. Nothing here has been tested in a tenant.

My own diagram of the roadmap entry — not a screenshot. This is the one whose published target has already passed while the entry still reads In development.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[AI at Work Roadmap 566997 →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Agent Readiness

In development

Microsoft plans an always-visible **Review** health indicator in the build experience, surfacing policy restrictions, missing evaluations, blocked capabilities and other publish risks as you work. The roadmap entry says blocked capabilities would be greyed out up front with a reason, so a maker does not configure something that was never going to work.

Roadmap plan — In development on 14 September 2026. Microsoft's stated timing: GA September 2026.

Why it matters

Problems that surface at publish time are problems you find at the worst moment. Putting the indicator in front of the maker while they build is the same move as a linter in an editor, and it works for the same reason.

Agent Readiness

Copilot Studio · AI at Work Roadmap 568762 · illustrative, not a screenshot

ROADMAP ID

568762

In development

Status checked 14 September 2026.

WHAT MICROSOFT SAYS IT WILL DO

An always-visible **Review** health indicator in the build experience, surfacing policy restrictions, missing evaluations and blocked capabilities as you work — with blocked capabilities greyed out up front, and a reason given.

TARGET DATES MICROSOFT PUBLISHED — NONE OF THEM MET YET

○

GA

September 2026

NOT YET TESTABLE The roadmap states intent, not availability. Nothing here has been tested in a tenant.

My own diagram of the roadmap entry — not a screenshot. The feature is still in development, so there is no product screen to photograph, and the dates shown are targets Microsoft published rather than milestones it has met.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[AI at Work Roadmap 568762 →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Better explanations in evaluations

Microsoft plans richer explanations in evaluation results, including the agent's reasoning traces.

Roadmap plan — In development on 14 September 2026. Microsoft's stated timing: GA September 2026.

Why it matters

A score tells you an agent failed. A reasoning trace tells you where it went wrong, which is the only version you can act on. This is the difference between evaluation as a gate and evaluation as a debugging tool.

In development

Better explanations in agent evaluations

Copilot Studio · AI at Work Roadmap 569607 · illustrative, not a screenshot

ROADMAP ID

569607

In development

Status checked 14 September 2026.

WHAT MICROSOFT SAYS IT WILL DO

Richer explanations in evaluation results, **including the agent's reasoning traces.**

TARGET DATES MICROSOFT PUBLISHED — NONE OF THEM MET YET

○

GA

September 2026

NOT YET TESTABLE The roadmap states intent, not availability. Nothing here has been tested in a tenant.

My own diagram of the roadmap entry — not a screenshot. The feature is still in development, so there is no product screen to photograph, and the dates shown are targets Microsoft published rather than milestones it has met.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

Setting up connectors by conversation

Microsoft plans to let you sign in to and configure a connector inside the chat, instead of being sent out to a full settings experience.

Roadmap plan — In development on 14 September 2026. Microsoft's stated timing: GA September 2026.

Why it matters

Connector setup is where a lot of first-time makers quietly give up — the moment the friendly conversation hands you to a configuration screen. Keeping it in the chat keeps people in the flow they started in.

In development

Setting up connectors by conversation

Copilot Studio · AI at Work Roadmap 569930 · illustrative, not a screenshot

ROADMAP ID

569930

In development

Status checked 14 September 2026.

WHAT MICROSOFT SAYS IT WILL DO

Signing in to and configuring a connector **inside the chat**, instead of being sent out to a full settings experience.

TARGET DATES MICROSOFT PUBLISHED — NONE OF THEM MET YET

○

GA

September 2026

NOT YET TESTABLE The roadmap states intent, not availability. Nothing here has been tested in a tenant.

My own diagram of the roadmap entry — not a screenshot. The feature is still in development, so there is no product screen to photograph, and the dates shown are targets Microsoft published rather than milestones it has met.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[AI at Work Roadmap 569930 →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

SECTION 05

Power Platform

05

There is no release wave 2

The twice-yearly release wave model for Dynamics 365, Power Platform and Dataverse has been retired. Microsoft's own FAQ answers it about as bluntly as a FAQ can:

> Q. Will there be a September 2026 release wave 2 announcement or release wave 2 release plan? > **A. No.**

Why it matters

For years, wave planning has been a fixed point in a lot of organisations' calendars — the twice-yearly read of the release notes, the list of things to test. That ritual no longer has a document to hang off.

[Release Planner migration notes →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Announced August

There is no September 2026 release wave 2

Announced August 2026 · illustrative, not a screenshot

MICROSOFT'S OWN FAQ

Q. Will there be a September 2026 release wave 2 announcement or release wave 2 release plan?

A. **No.**

WHAT WAS RETIRED

The twice-yearly release wave model for Dynamics 365, Power Platform and Dataverse has been retired.

WHAT REPLACES IT

That content moves onto the AI at Work Roadmap and is published continuously, as things are ready, rather than in two large drops a year.

My own diagram of the FAQ answer — not a screenshot. The change here is an absence, and an absence cannot be photographed.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

Release Planner retires 15 November

Microsoft's timeline is specific: by 15 November 2026, *"the transition completes and Release Planner retires."* The FAQ on the same post is just as clear about Learn: *"Beginning in September 2026, new release plans will no longer be published to Release Plans on Learn."* Existing plans stay up for historical reference.

Why it matters

If Release Planner links are embedded in your internal planning pages, runbooks or governance documents, they have a stated expiry date. That is a small, concrete piece of housekeeping with a deadline on it — the kind that is easy now and annoying in November.

DO NEXT

Diary the retirement and export anything you rely on.

[Release Planner migration notes →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Announced August

Release Planner has a stated expiry date

Announced August 2026 · illustrative, not a screenshot

AUGUST 2026

Microsoft announces the retirement.

FROM SEPTEMBER 2026

Release plans are no longer published to Release Planner.

BY 15 NOVEMBER 2026

Release Planner retires.

WHAT YOU KEEP

Roadmap content continues, in its new home.

WHAT YOU LOSE

Any Release Planner link embedded in runbooks, planning pages or governance docs stops working.

My own timeline of the retirement — not a screenshot. A stated expiry date is a fact about the future, which no screen can show.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

Saved views will not carry over

November 2026

Personalised **My Release Plans** saved views do not transfer to the new experience.

Why it matters

This is the detail that will catch people, because saved views are exactly the sort of thing you only notice the absence of when you go looking for them. If someone on your team has curated views they rely on, export what they need now rather than after the deadline.

DO NEXT

Re-create saved views elsewhere before 15 November.

[Release Planner migration notes →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Saved views in My Release Plans will not carry over

Release Planner users · before 15 November 2026 · illustrative, not a screenshot

TRANSFERS TO THE NEW EXPERIENCE

Roadmap content itself, in its new home on the AI at Work Roadmap.

DOES NOT TRANSFER

Personalised **My Release Plans** saved views.

BEFORE 15 NOVEMBER 2026 If a saved view is doing real work in your planning routine, capture what is in it while Release Planner is still up.

My own diagram of what survives the migration — not a screenshot. What is lost is precisely what cannot be shown.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

Where the content is going, and when

September 2026

Content with a preview or general availability date of **1 June 2026 or later** transitions to the new home across September to November 2026. From September, Dynamics 365, Power Platform and Dataverse content joins the AI at Work Roadmap — the same roadmap this series already cites for Microsoft 365 Copilot.

Why it matters

One roadmap for Microsoft 365 Copilot, Copilot Studio, Power Platform and Dynamics 365 is genuinely simpler than four places to look. Worth knowing during the transition, though, that older content stays behind — so for anything dated before June 2026 you are still looking in the old place.

Where the content is going, and when

Planners and admins · September to November 2026 · illustrative, not a screenshot

FROM SEPTEMBER 2026

Dynamics 365, Power Platform and Dataverse content joins the AI at Work Roadmap.

SEPTEMBER TO NOVEMBER 2026

Content with a preview or general availability date of 1 June 2026 or later transitions to the new home.

BY 15 NOVEMBER 2026

Release Planner retires.

WHAT YOU KEEP

The destination is the same roadmap this series already cites for Microsoft 365 Copilot.

WHAT YOU LOSE

Content dated before 1 June 2026 is not described as transitioning.

My own timeline of the migration — not a screenshot. The dates come from Microsoft's Release Planner migration notes.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[Release Planner migration notes →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Dataverse data in Microsoft 365 Copilot

In development

Searching and querying Dataverse business data from inside Microsoft 365 Copilot.

Roadmap plan — In development on 14 September 2026. Microsoft's stated timing: preview June 2026, GA September 2026.

Why it matters

This is the Power Platform item that most directly reaches ordinary Copilot users. Dataverse holds the records behind a lot of internal applications, and answering from them in Copilot Chat — rather than making someone open the app and search — is where the value of a shared roadmap starts to show.



My own diagram of the roadmap entry — not a screenshot. The feature is still in development, so there is no product screen to photograph, and the dates shown are targets Microsoft published rather than milestones it has met.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

SECTION 06

Admin, analytics & governance

06

Domain exclusion is back

September's headline, and the reason is as much about how it happened as what it does.

Domain exclusion lets an administrator name external domains that Microsoft Copilot, Copilot Chat and Cowork should not draw on when grounding answers in public web content.

Why it matters

Every organisation that has been asked "can we stop Copilot grounding answers in that scraper site with our old product data on it, or the forum thread full of out-of-date advice?" has had no good answer. This is the closest thing to one, and 1,000 domains is a real allowance rather than a token one.

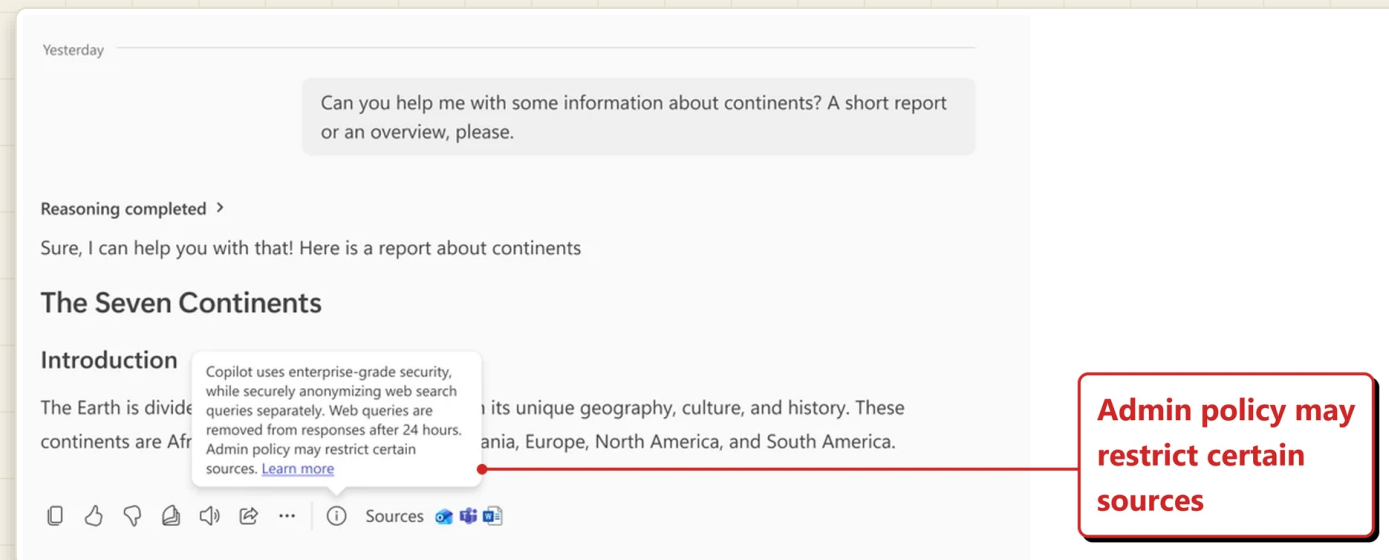
DO NEXT

Pick the plan back up — and read the three limits first.

[Update: Domain Exclusion for Microsoft 365... →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Back 9 September



*Official Microsoft image from Microsoft's domain exclusion announcement.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.*

Grok models arrive, off by default

Microsoft added **Grok models from SpaceXAI** to Copilot's model choice. The administrative detail matters more than the model:

Not available in the EU, EFTA or the UK, on government clouds, or on sovereign clouds.

Why it matters

A new subprocessor is a compliance event, not a feature. Whoever maintains your data protection impact assessments and your subprocessor register should know about this even if you never turn it on — and “disabled by default” means nobody has to rush.

DO NEXT

Treat it as a legal review, not a feature toggle.

[Expanding model choice in Copilot with Grok →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Grok models — two routes, two sets of terms

Admins and Frontier Program tenants · Announced 12 September 2026 · Available 18 September 2026 · illustrative, not a screenshot

WHAT WAS ADDED

Grok models from SpaceXAI, through the Microsoft Frontier Program, in **Word, Excel and PowerPoint** via the model selector — behind a dedicated admin setting that is **disabled by default**.

IN WORD, EXCEL AND POWERPOINT

SpaceXAI acts as a **subprocessor**. Microsoft's **Product Terms, DPA** and **Customer Copyright Commitment** apply, and use is covered by **Enterprise Data Protection**.

IN COPILOT STUDIO

A different route. SpaceXAI acts as an **independent processor**: the Product Terms and DPA **don't apply**, and the **xAI Enterprise Terms of Service** and **xAI Data Processing Addendum** govern instead.

NOT AVAILABLE

Frontier customers in the **EU, EFTA and the UK**, on **government clouds** (GCC, GCC High, DoD), or on **sovereign clouds**.

EXCLUSIONS THAT STILL APPLY Even as a subprocessor: SpaceXAI maintains its own certifications, the models are **not FedRAMP High authorized**, and they are excluded from **in-country processing** commitments. Enabling needs an AI Administrator or Global Administrator.

My own diagram of the two contractual routes — not a screenshot. These are terms rather than interface, and they are the part of this release that matters most.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

Cowork measured in hours, not prompts

The Consumption Dashboard in Insights now reports **Cowork assisted hours and value** — an estimate of the time Cowork returns to people, rather than a count of how many times they prompted it.

A deliberately conservative proxy, not a finance number.

Why it matters

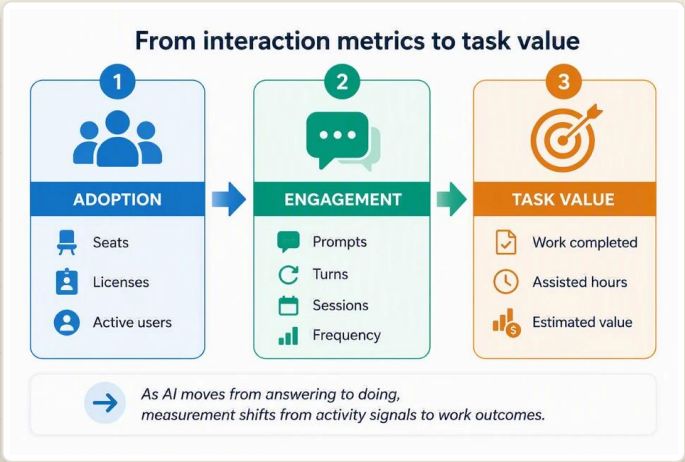
Usage numbers have never answered the question leaders actually ask. Counting prompts told you people were using it, which is not the same as it being worth the money — and Microsoft says so directly here: costs now vary with usage, so the old proxies do not hold.

DO NEXT

Agree it is an estimate before it lands in a finance deck.

[Measuring the value of Cowork →](#)
[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

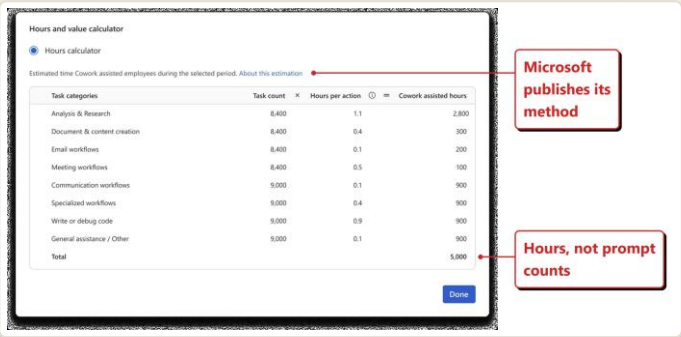
Announced 9 September



All 8 categories at-a-glance
Low / Typical / High time values

TASK CATEGORY	LOW	TYPICAL	HIGH
1 Analysis & Research ~6.7 min / analysis run (Standard WB basket mean)	30	67	92
2 Document & content creation ~6.1 min / Word activity instance	12	24	42
3 Email workflows ~7 min / email-reply instance	3	7	12
4 Meeting workflows ~3.1 min / missed-meeting recap	12	31	45
5 Communication workflows ~2 min / non-email comma instance	2	4	11
6 Specialized workflows ~10 min / workflow-step instance	10	25	40
7 Write or debug code ~15-20 min / coding instance	30	56	96
8 General assistance / Other 2-8 min / single-instance assist	2	5	8

Note: Each "Mid/Typical" value is calculated as the sum of per-instance metrics for the specific activities that make up a task, based on a given study. For more details see methodology links.

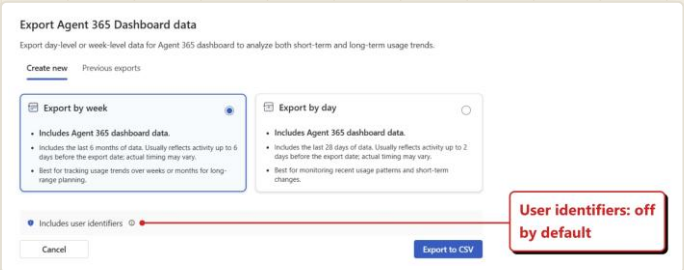
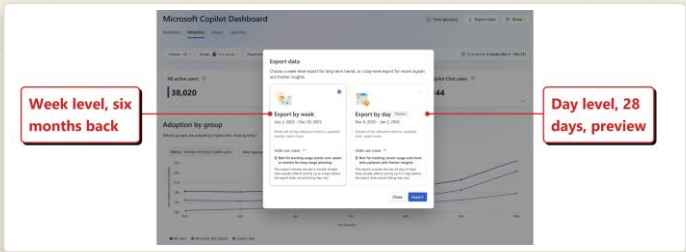


Official Microsoft image from Microsoft's post on measuring the value of Cowork.
Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

Data export from the dashboards

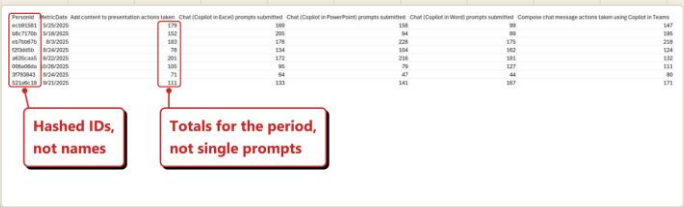
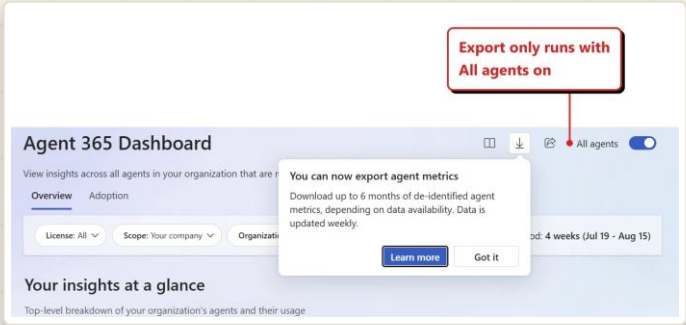
Public preview

These are **two separate exports**, and the difference matters if you are planning reporting.



Why it matters

Built-in dashboards answer the questions the vendor anticipated; an export answers yours. But do not write "the export is anonymous" into a privacy assessment — identifiable export is an administrator switch, and whether it is on is a question worth asking before the data leaves the tenant.



DO NEXT

Settle identifiable export before anyone writes "anonymous".

Official Microsoft image from Microsoft Learn.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

[Export Copilot metrics →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

GitHub Copilot credits in the dashboard

The Viva Insights consumption dashboard added a **GitHub Copilot** page covering AI credit usage, so developer consumption sits alongside the rest of your Copilot spend.

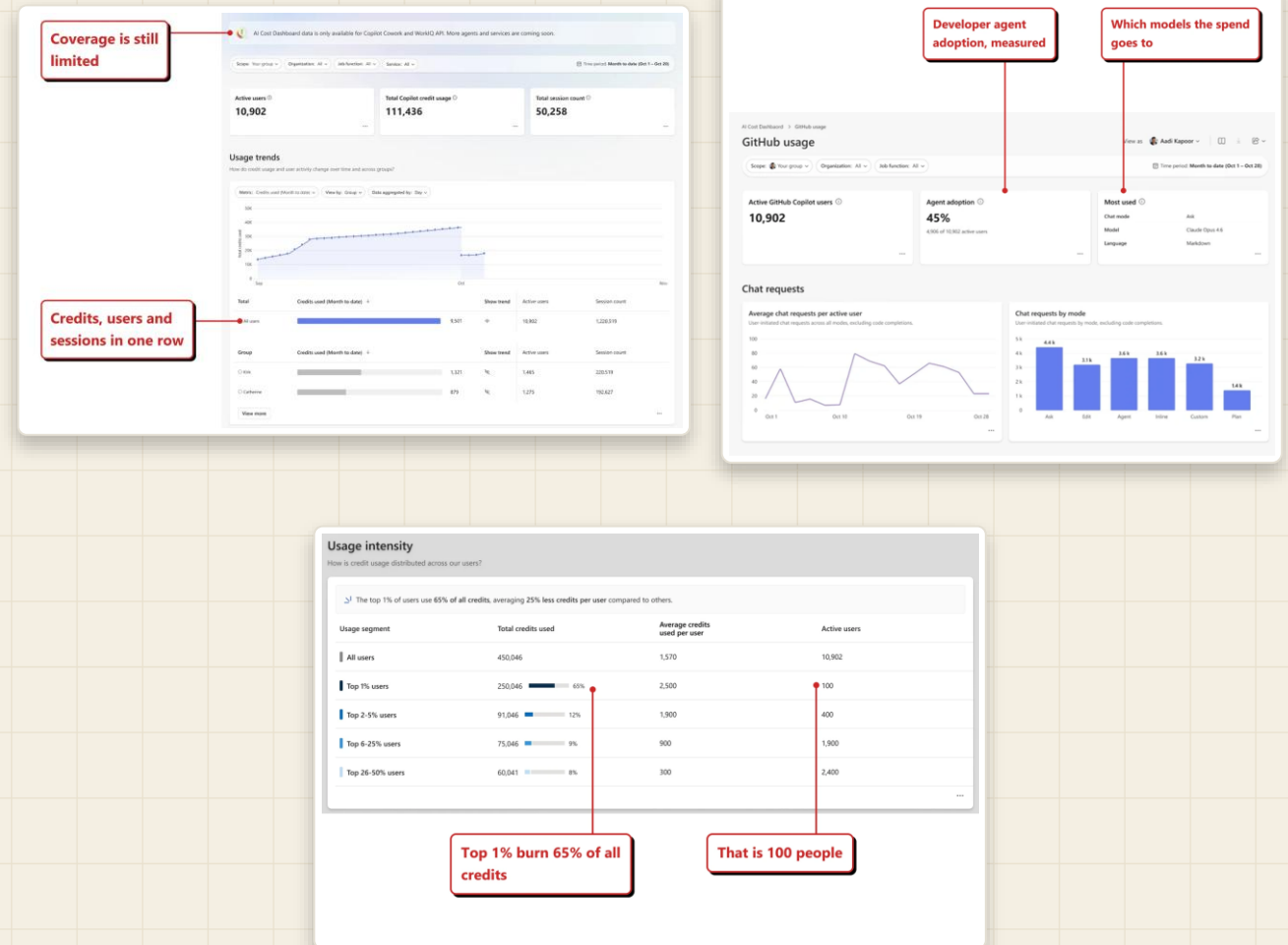
Why it matters

This is a catch-up item from July, included because it completes a picture the rest of this issue keeps circling. Between this, the Cowork value metric and the Copilot Studio credit reporting, Microsoft is steadily pulling every Copilot spend into one consumption view — which is the only way the usage-based model becomes manageable.

[Consumption Dashboard →](#)

[Read the full update on the blog →](#)

Public preview



Official Microsoft image from Microsoft Learn.

Demo tenant or official Microsoft imagery · UI and availability may vary by tenant and rollout.

SECTION 07

On the horizon

07

Three to watch

Three things are worth keeping an eye on rather than planning around. Each one is either a Microsoft statement without a date, or a change whose full effect is not visible yet.

Why it matters

I would rather list these as things to watch than give them a status I cannot stand behind. As each one is confirmed, it gets a proper numbered section in a later issue.

[Read more on the blog →](#)

Copilot Studio becomes a billing conversation

- The harness decision now changes what a Microsoft 365 Copilot tenant is billed. Expect this to reach finance and procurement, not just makers.

watch

The series was quietly renamed

- Microsoft's roundup is now What's New in Microsoft Copilot, published on a renamed blog. Worth knowing if you have bookmarks or alerts pointed at the old one.

renamed

Release waves are gone

- No September release wave 2, and Release Planner retires by 15 November. Anything that planned against the twice-yearly rhythm needs a new rhythm.

retiring

See you in October

Watch next month: how tenants react to usage-based billing in Copilot Studio, whether the eleven In development items actually ship, and what replaces the release-wave rhythm.

missed an issue?

Every edition of this pack — past, present and future — lives in one place, free to download. No sign-up, no email required.

— Sush

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[Read the full September recap →](#)

[All monthly recaps →](#)



Read this issue

The full September recap on the blog



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A note on this pack

These are my own notes and opinions — **not Microsoft's**, and not an official Microsoft publication.

Almost everything here is pulled together from **publicly available information**. The screenshots are from **my demo tenants or official Microsoft product imagery** — not real customer data. Your tenant may look different because rollout timing and the interface change frequently.

I share this widely, so I'm never quite sure how it reaches you. If something looks off or needs a correction, I'd genuinely like to hear it.

— Sush

Spotted something? Let's fix it together

A colleague at Microsoft, or a customer I work with? Ping me on Teams, or just reply wherever you found this.

Everyone else — because this travels far and wide, leave a quick note on my blog and I'll come back to you:

aguidetocloud.com/feedback →